



PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

THIRD MEETING, 2025

Tuesday, 2nd December, 2025

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 1:30 p.m.*

[THE SPEAKER, RT HON ALBAN
SUMANA KINGSFORD BAGBIN,
IN THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

The Speaker: Hon Members, because of the programmes of the Public Engagement Department, I direct that we always acknowledge early enough, the presence of our visitors. Usually, they are taken through some processes after their appearance at the Public Gallery.

Table Office, kindly note, in spite of whatever our Standing Orders might have stated, we need to be acknowledging them early. Sometimes, some of them are compelled to leave, to attend to the programme without being acknowledged.

So, I want us to acknowledge the presence of those who are present now. I know some more would come in later. We have, present at the Public Gallery, students from three institutions.

The first is from M' Salem School Complex Civic Education Club. They are 48 in number and are led by Mr Jones

Nana Ketu from the NCCE. They are from the Kpone-Katamanso Constituency.

[Pupils of M' Salem School Complex Civic Education were acknowledged.]

The Speaker: We also have students from the JEI-River International School led by the headmaster of the school, Mr Gabriel Owusu and they are 205 in number; one of the largest since we started this process. They are from the Awutu Senya East Constituency

[Pupils of JEI-River International School were acknowledged.]

The Speaker: The third group is from St. Thomas Roman Catholic Junior High School led by the school Secretary, Martha Awuah. They are 63 in number and are from Obuasi West Constituency.

[Pupils of St. Thomas Roman Catholic Junior High School were acknowledged.]

The Speaker: Hon Members, on your behalf, I warmly welcome all of them to their own Parliament House and encourage them to keep coming. Because, this would give them the opportunity to experience, see and hear what we do here. I am sure they would be caught up early to start building the culture of democracy in our country. When we leave and they take over, our expectations are that, they would perform better than us. So, they are warmly welcome; they should keep on coming.

The Speaker: We now take the item numbered 6 on the *Order Paper*—

Correction of *Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*.

VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND THE OFFICIAL REPORT

The Speaker: We would start with the *Votes and Proceedings* of Friday, 28th November, 2025.

Page 1...12— Yes Hon Member?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, may I thank you for your magnanimity and kindly invite you to the item numbered (xi), the institution's name, "African Centre for Development Affairs" is supposed to "African Centre for Parliamentary Affairs". So, if the Clerks could kindly delete the word "Development" and insert "Parliamentary" Affairs.

Mr Speaker, again, the item numbered (xv), "Mr Paulina Sarvilahti", if I got the pronunciation well. I think "Paulina" is naturally supposed to be a female name, so the title does not reflect the name. If the Table Office could take note and do the needful.

Thank you.

1:40 p.m.

The Speaker: Please, Table Office, kindly check on the issues he has raised because I do not know the person under the item numbered xi very well. I do not know whether he is from African Centre for Parliamentary Affairs (ACEPA) or if it is Centre for African Developmental

Affairs (CADA). So, kindly cross-check it and the item numbered xv. Even the spelling of the name, whether it is a single or double "i". Gender matters these days are tricky. So, check and make sure the right thing is done.

Yes, Hon Member, did you want to say something?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, no. I was just confirming; the emphasis is on the title.

The Speaker: Yes, I know. That is why I said with gender matters, I do not know so they should cross-check.

Hon Members, page 13.

Hon Members, in the absence of any further corrections, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Friday, 28th November 2025, as corrected, are adopted as a true record of proceedings.

We have some copies of the *Official Report*. They were presented to us some time ago. I think, due to oversight, we did not do the formal corrections. So, I would take you through them, and we do them properly. If later any Member has something on any of them, you could approach the Table Office or the *Hansard* office and get it rectified.

We have Friday, 14th November, 2025; Tuesday, 18th November 2025; Wednesday, 19th November 2025; and Thursday, 20th November 2025. They were presented to us earlier on. My attention has been drawn to the fact that we have not formally corrected them.

So, I present them together and draw the attention of Hon Members. If you have not, please do so and submit the necessary corrections to the Office of Chamber Reporting. So, I take it that we have corrected and adopted them accordingly.

In that case, I will read that in the absence of any corrections, the *Official Reports*, as stated earlier, are hereby adopted as a true record of proceedings.

I do not know the pleasure of Leaders, because what we have on the Order Paper now is the item numbered 7 — Questions, and whether they want us to proceed to Questions or to go to Public Business. We also have some Statements and we would start with the Questions.

Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor): Mr Speaker, we want to pray you to vary the order of Business humbly so that instead of Questions, we go to the item numbered 9(a). There are a number of Papers to be laid, so we pray that we do so quickly with your leave. From 9(a) i to vii.

Mr Speaker, I respectfully pray.

The Speaker: Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): Mr Speaker, we have no objection to that, but the Majority Chief Whip should also know that we have in our possession *Order*

Paper Addendum, and I know after that he will want to visit the *Order Paper Addendum*. I am just reminding him that the Ministers must be in the House. I have seen Hon Kwame Govere Agbodza here. He is punctual. The Ministers for Transport and Works, Housing and Water Resources are not here, and this is their Budget. They cannot sit at their Ministries and expect us to approve their Budget. So, please, take measures and get the other Ministers here. When we get to the *Order Paper Addendum*, do not say that I am not cooperating.

Mr Speaker, on that score, we can go ahead. He forgot, he should further pray the Speaker for him to do the laying.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, having heard from the Minority Chief Whip, may I seek your leave to lay the Papers under item 9(a) i to vii in whole.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Members, the item numbered 9 — Presentation of Papers.

The following Papers in 9(a) i to vii to be presented by the Chairperson of the Committee. This could be done with a single bow, and then the Clerks-at-the-Table will definitely read them and they will be captured by the *Official Report*.

So, Chairperson of the Committee?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the Chairperson has just stepped out. So, if I may pray you to do this on his behalf.

Mr Annoh-Dompreeh: Mr Speaker, we will cooperate and I hope he would acknowledge our cooperation level.

The Speaker: Yes, Majority Chief Whip, I am sure you have acknowledged it.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the level of cooperation is duly noted.

PAPERS

By the Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee —

- (i) Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on the 2024 Budget Performance Report of the Audit Service.
- (ii) Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on the 2024 Budget Performance Report of the Electoral Commission (EC).
- (iii) Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on the 2024 Budget Performance Report of the National Commission for Civic Education (NCCE).
- (iv) Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on the 2024 Audit Committee Report of the National Commission for Civic Education (NCCE).

(v) Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on the Annual Budget Estimates of the Audit Service for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

(vi) Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on the Annual Budget Estimates of the Electoral Commission for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

(vii) Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on the Annual Budget Estimates of the National Media Commission for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

1:50 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, these Reports from the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies are accordingly presented to the House and are for distribution to all Members of Parliament.

We will now take the item numbered 9(b) by the Chairperson of the Committee.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, my information is that the item numbered 9(b) is not ready, so we will take the items numbered 9(c), (d), (e), (f), (g), (h), (i), (j), (k) and (l) accordingly.

The Speaker: Hon Members, we will proceed to defer the item numbered 9(b) and take the item numbered 9(c) by the Chairperson of the Committee.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may I seek your leave to do this on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we have no objection to that.

By the Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee —

Report of the Committee on Parliamentary Affairs on the Annual Budget Estimates of the Parliament and Parliamentary Service of Ghana for the Year Ending 31st December, 2026.

The Speaker: Hon Members, the Report of the Committee is accordingly presented to the House and is for distribution to all Members of Parliament.

The item numbered 9(d), by the Chairperson of the Committee.

By the Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee —

- (i) Report of the Committee on Roads and Transportation on the Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Roads and Highways for the Year Ending 31st December, 2026.

- (ii) Report of the Committee on Roads and Transportation on the Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Transport for the Year Ending 31st December, 2026.

The Speaker: Hon Members, the two Reports are accordingly presented to the House and are for distribution to all Members of Parliament.

Hon Members, the item numbered 9(e), by the Chairperson of the Committee.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the Chairperson of the Committee on Works and Housing is not in the House, so may I seek your leave to do this on his behalf?

The Speaker: Do I take it that you do not object?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we have no objection.

The Speaker: How about you do the rest so that we can move on if the Chairpersons are not there?

By the Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee —

Report of the Committee on Works and Housing on the Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water

Resources for the Year Ending 31st December 2026.

The Speaker: Hon Members, the Report is presented and is for distribution to all Members of Parliament.

Hon Members, the item numbered 9(f), by the Chairperson of the Committee.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may I seek your leave to do this on behalf of the Chairperson?

The Speaker: I have just been briefed that the item numbered 9(f) is not ready, so we will allow them some more time. We would defer the item numbered 9(f), and then we will take the item numbered 9(g)(i) and (ii).

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may I seek your leave to do this on behalf of the Chairperson?

The Speaker: Yes, we already got the decision from the Minority Side.

By the Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee —

- (i) Report of the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs on the Annual Budget Estimates of the Office of the Legal Aid Commission for the Year Ending 31st December 2026.

- (ii) Report of the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs on the Annual Budget Estimates of the Office of the Special Prosecutor for the Year Ending 31st December, 2026.

The Speaker: Hon Members, the two Reports are currently presented to the House and are for distribution to all Members of Parliament.

We now move to the item numbered 9(h), by the Chairperson of the Committee on Youth and Sports.

By the Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee —

Report of the Committee on Youth and Sports on the Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Sports and Recreation for the Year Ending 31st December, 2026.

The Speaker: Hon Members, the Report is presented accordingly and is for distribution to all Members of Parliament.

We move to the item numbered 9(i), by the Chairperson of the Committee on Employment, Labour Relations and Pensions.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we are cooperating, and the cooperation is going well. However, the Majority Chief Whip is not bowing well. The last time I saw him attempting to bow—he should bow properly. His Chairpersons are not here; we are cooperating with him, but at least he should be seen to be bowing.

The Speaker: Yes. Kindly take note.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, noted, but I wish he would have demonstrated how to properly do this.

The Speaker: Hon Members, I have just been told that the items numbered 9(i), (j) and (k) are not ready. It is only the item numbered 9(l) that is ready. So, we would take the item numbered 9(l), by the Chairperson of the Committee

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the indication is that the item numbered 9(j) is not ready, but the items numbered 9(k) and 9(l) are ready. So, we can take them.

The Speaker: I am told the item numbered 9(i), is also not ready. So, if you say the item numbered 9(k) and (l) are ready, we will take them.

Mr Dafeamekpor: That is so, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: All right. The Chairperson of the Committee on Defence and Interior, and then Committee on Health.

By the Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee —

Report of the Committee on Defence and Interior on the Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Defence for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

By the Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee —

Report of the Committee on Health on the Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Health for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

2:00 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, we will move to the item numbered 10. Is that the case?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that is so. We will take items numbered 10(a), (b), (c), (d) and (e).

The Speaker: Hon Members, we will first start with the item numbered 10(a). Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, ordinarily I would not object, but a while ago, I saw the Minister for Education around. When it matters most, he is not in the Chamber, so is it the case that the Minister is not ready to lay his Bill? If he is not ready, let us move on to the next item. The Minister is not here. The Hon Majority Chief Whip can lay it but he should let the Minister do the needful; this is Parliament. Mr Speaker, he should seek your leave because I can see other Ministers here.

The Speaker: Hon Members, these are key Bills that are new. I had the opportunity of admitting them. But it is important that, at least, those going to present them to the House should say a few words on those Bills so that Members can get the gist and also for the country to know what is going to happen concerning these sectoral areas, particularly a Bill like the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025, Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025 and the Governance Advisory Council Bill, 2025. We need to get some explanatory words from the Ministers. These are quite novel, and it is important to give notice to the public on them.

So, we will start with the item numbered 10(a).

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, you would have noted that the sector Minister

was in the House. Because we gave the indication that we were going to take the *Votes and Proceedings*, he rushed to the Committee hearing. But I can speak to the brief explanatory memorandum under Order 97(3), I believe. I have my copies of the Bills and the memorandums are attached. So, I believe that we should be able to present these Papers so that we take them off and go to other Businesses. I do not have any difficulty speaking to the explanatory memorandum.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, our new Orders allow a Member to lay Papers. But it is not just about complying with Order 97(3). He needs to make an application to the Speaker for him to be permitted. I want to suggest to him to get the Minister for us, because as the Speaker said, these are very important Bills and we are taking them for the First Reading. If the Minister is at a Committee engagement, he should get him to prioritise the laying of this Bill. They have their 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025 here, and the Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025 which has huge public interest. It is just appropriate that he gets the Minister. He is the Majority Chief Whip so he should call the Minister for Education to be here. I do not doubt that he can comply to Order 97(3), but we are not just interested in him giving a short explanation. He should get the Minister here.

In the meantime, I advise him there are other Businesses that we can do. We have assured him that in the interest of the Ghanaian, we will help them to pass

the Appropriation Bill, and these are the Motions we are going through to pass the Appropriation Bill. Look at how the Minister for Roads and Highways is staring at me, meanwhile, he will not do my road. They can step these ones down and then we can move on to the *Order Paper Addendum* and start taking the Motion on the estimate.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I will not litigate this matter at all. I will endeavour to get the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice to come, and the Minister for Education to also return to the Chamber. So, in the meantime, I pray that we go to the *Order Paper Addendum* to take Motions numbered 1, 2 and 3.

The Speaker: Hon Members, the Hon Second Deputy Speaker to take the Chair.

2:06 p.m. — [HON SECOND DEPUTY SPEAKER, MR ANDREW ASIAMA AMOAKO, IN THE CHAIR]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we had agreed that we will disengage in respect of laying the items numbered 10(a), (b), (c), (d), (e), and pray that we move to the *Order Paper Addendum* and take Motions numbered 1, 2 and 3. Humbly submitted.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: He is too much in a hurry. Let us move chronologically. He cannot put all the three Motions together. What is that? We

should start from the Minister for Roads and Highways, then afterwards, depending on the availability of the Ministers, we can take a decision either to stand them down or get somebody to move instead. But he should finish with the Minister for Roads and Highways.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I only made a prayer and indicated the number of Motions that we will take on the *Order Paper Addendum*. If my Brother agrees, then we can all further agree that we will take them sequentially. I am not making an omnibus prayer.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: It has been wonderful, so he should not raise the temperature unnecessarily. I am simply advising him that he should start from Motion numbered 1. When we are done with the Motion numbered 1, we will look around, and if the Minister is here, we can firm up whether to take that Motion or not.

So, Mr Speaker, we can proceed.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. So, Hon Members, let me invite you to the *Order Paper Addendum*. We will take the Motion numbered 1. But by the way, is it by chance that we always take the Ministry of Roads and Highways as the first item whenever we come to Annual Estimates? Last year, last two years and last three years, we did the same.

Mr Dafeamekpor: I am happy you have taken parliamentary notice of that.

ANNUAL ESTIMATES, 2026

MINISTRY OF ROADS AND HIGHWAYS

**Minister for Roads and Highways
(Mr Kwame Govers Agbodza) (MP):**
Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That this honourable House approves the sum of GH¢5,378,458,359.00 for the services of the Ministry of Roads and Highways for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Chairman of the Committee (Mr Isaac Adjei Mensah): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion, and in doing so, I respectfully present the Report of your Committee.

The Committee met in respect of the budget estimates for the Ministry of Roads and Highways, as referred to it. The Committee noted a lot of issues and we request that the *Hansard* takes the entirety of the Report while I concentrate on some key areas and get them presented accordingly.

2:10 p.m.

Mr Speaker, the Committee noted that, given the importance of the road sector, staffing continues to be an issue. There is inadequate staffing for the four or five agencies: the Department of Feeder Roads, the Department of Urban Roads, the Ghana Highways Authority, the Road Fund Secretariat *et cetera*. They lack staff. We realised that in the

Budget, they want to engage reasonable numbers accordingly. Therefore, it is a good idea to support the recruitment of about 137 staff to augment the staffing situation —

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: I tried to bring it to the notification of the Majority Chief Whip. I think there is a problem with the procedure. A while ago, we laid a Paper, and we are taking a substantive Motion. We laid the Report. So, what we should be doing is to start off from a procedural Motion. This is not harmful; we can do it. Mr Speaker, have they seen how we help them? The Minority is helpful.

Mr Speaker, this is not injurious. They should simply go back and get the procedural Motion moved, and then the House takes a decision on the procedural Motion before we come to the substantive Motion.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we would have to take the procedural Motion before we move the substantive Motion.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Where is the procedural Motion?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the procedural Motion has not been advertised. So, we would have to step it down and generate an *Order Paper Addendum* to do so. Then it can be done.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we on this Side of the House are minded to help them to navigate. So, they should not confuse themselves; I know they are

very good with procedure, but this one— So they should get closer to the Table Office. I am surprised this was not done. I am totally surprised. There are other businesses; they said they want to do 24-Hour Economy. They should show us other businesses that are ready while we wait for the *Order Paper Addendum* that would advertise the procedural Motion. Please, be quick.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may I pray that we go back to the Motion numbered 10. We would lay the Bills, first laying of Bills, particularly the Motion numbered 10(b), (c), and (e), in the meantime. The request is that the Minister for Education should come and speak to the items numbered 10(a) and (d), especially. I can speak to items number 10(b), (c), and (e).

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, they had earlier called 10(b), (c), and (e). We would allow him to lay the Bills for the Minister for Education. But, that of the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice, we would insist that either the Attorney-General himself or his Deputy must be here. So, the Minority Chief Whip can go ahead; he does not even have to comply with Order 97(3). He should just go ahead and lay it.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, in that case, we would lay item numbered 10(a) and (e) so that we leave the items numbered 10(b) and (c), and (d).

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: But I think the 10(e) is also under the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Yes, but he has waived that requirement.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: He should do that of the Minister for Education.

Mr Dafeamekpor: All right. Mr Speaker, I pray that we move the item numbered 10(a).

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Majority Chief Whip, my principal advisors are telling me that the item numbered 10(a) is not even ready. So, if anything, we can lay the rest, but it should be done by the Minister.

Mr Dafeamekpor: All right.

Mr Speaker, there was an earlier issue regarding the fact that we inadvertently missed moving the procedural Motion in respect of the Motion numbered 1 on the *Order Paper Addendum*. I believe the procedure is that in respect of reports concerning the financial Bills, we do not require a procedural Motion, so we may proceed. This is Article 108 of the 1992 Constitution Bill. So, we do not require a substantive Motion.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: That is true. We can proceed.

Before then, a while ago, we were told that the item numbered 10(a) was not ready. If we are going by our Orders, which state:

“Procedure for presentation of Papers

97. (1) Whenever sufficient copies of a Paper have been received in the Office of the Clerk for distribution to Members, notice of the presentation of that Paper may be placed on the Order Paper and when the Speaker announces “Presentation of Papers,” the person laying the Paper shall rise and bow to the Chair and the Clerk shall read the title of the Paper and the Paper shall be considered to have been laid on the Table.”

Mr Speaker, if we are going by the provision of this Order, to the extent that the Paper has been advertised in the *Order Paper*, it can reasonably be assumed that the Paper is ready. So, if it is not ready, the Clerk’s office should not be advertising these Papers on the *Order Paper*.

Mr Speaker, we are only thinking aloud, based on the provision of Order 97. On what basis were these notifications put on the *Order Paper*? Now, we are being told that it is not ready. What is that?

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Leader, do you consider a Bill as a Paper?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, it is the laying of Paper, so they should just watch it. Having said that, we can proceed and take the Motion on the *Order Paper Addendum*. We can proceed.

2:20 p.m.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the Minority Chief Whip knows that when the Table Office says a Bill is not ready for the purposes of the long title to be read—

I suspect that they are making sufficient copies to be distributed to Members. I am sure when that is done, we will do that. Yes, I am doing my Business, but do not antagonise the Table Office.

Mr Patrick Yaw Boamah: Mr Speaker, the Hon Majority Chief Whip is a very experienced MP. His second home should be the Table Office, the Office of Chamber Reporting, and the printing room. I do not remember the last time he went there, and he expects them to be doing business with him. What has he been doing? He has to be going there. He knows, and that is why his Motion was not taken. If he cares to know.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I was there this dawn. They were working overnight. But let us make progress. Mr Speaker, we will go back to the *Order Paper Addendum*, Motion numbered 1.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. So, we take the Motion numbered 1. I must confess that my position will have been to go with the normal procedure, but my Chief Advisor says we should consider this as a financial Bill, so we can move on. Chairman of the Committee, you may second the Motion and present the Report of the Committee.

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Isaac Adjei Mensah): Thank you, Mr Speaker. I rise to second the Motion, and in so doing, present the Report of the Committee.

Mr Speaker, as I mentioned initially, the Committee had the referral following the delivery of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy, and so we met, discussed, and deliberated on a number of issues. The Committee noted a couple of issues, and I will respectfully request that *Hansard* captures the entirety of the Report while I concentrate on some key areas.

Introduction

The Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Forson Baah presented the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the 2025 Financial Year to Parliament on Thursday, 13th November, 2025 in accordance with Article 179(1) of the 1992 Constitution and Orders 193 and 195 of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

The Estimates of the Ministry of Roads and Highways were subsequently referred to the Select Committee on Roads and Transportation for consideration and report, in accordance with Order 195(4) and Order 253 of the Standing Orders of the House.

Deliberations

To examine the referral, the Committee met with the Hon Minister for Roads and Highways, Mr Govers

Kwame Agbodza and officials of the Ministries of Roads & Highways and Finance and hereby submits this Report.

The Committee is grateful to the Hon Minister and officials of the two Ministries for their useful submissions.

Reference Documents

The Committee was guided by the following legal documents, reports and other relevant materials in its deliberations:

- a. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;
- b. The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana;
- c. Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921);
- d. Medium Term Expenditure Framework (MTEF) for 2025-2028;
- e. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 financial year; and
- f. The Report of the Committee on Roads and Transport on the Annual Estimates of the Ministry of Roads and Highways for the 2025 financial year.

The Budget for 2026 covers the Ministry of Roads and Highways Headquarters and its agencies:

- Ghana Highways Authority
- Department of Urban Roads
- Department of Feeder Roads
- Ghana Road Fund Secretariat
- Koforidua Training Centre

Background of the Ministry of Roads and Highways

The Ministry of Roads and Highways is the Government agency responsible for the development, maintenance, and management of Ghana's road infrastructure. Established to ensure a safe, efficient, and sustainable road network, the Ministry plays a critical role in facilitating economic growth, trade, and national integration.

Mission and Vision of the Ministry of Roads and Highways

The Mission of the Ministry of Roads and Highways is to provide an integrated, and well-maintained road infrastructure and other related services that meet national requirements and international standards on a sustainable basis.

The Ministry's long-term goal and vision is to play a lead role in providing integrated, efficient, cost-effective and sustainable transportation system responsive to the needs of society, supporting growth and poverty reduction and capable of establishing and maintaining

Ghana as a transportation hub of West Africa.

Policy Objectives

The underlisted constitute the policy objectives of the Ministry of Roads and Highways:

- i. Improve efficiency and effectiveness of road transport infrastructure and services.
- ii. Create an accessible, affordable, reliable, safe and secure transport system for all users.
- iii. Establish Ghana as a transport hub within the West African sub-region.
- iv. Increase private sector investment and improve utilisation of public financing.
- v. Create an integrated and harmonised transport planning framework.
- vi. Develop adequately skilled human resources for executing all aspects of the transport sector mandate.
- vii. Apply new and appropriate technology and innovations to transport infrastructure and service delivery.
- viii. Ensure safety and security for all categories of road users.
- ix. Provide transport infrastructure and services without compromising the

integrity of society, environment, health and the climate.

2025 Performance Review

Operational Performance

During the year under-review, the Ministry of Roads and Highways successfully recorded the following:

- i. Conduct monitoring of over 112 projects in five regions.
- ii. Carried out routine, and periodic maintenance activities including minor rehabilitation activities to protect the huge investment made by Government in the provision of road infrastructure.
- iii. Carried out routine maintenance activities comprising grading, pothole patching, shoulder maintenance, and vegetation control on 26,316 km of trunk road network, 6,661 km of the feeder road, and 1,595 km of the urban road network respectively.
- iv. Carried out periodic maintenance activities, comprising regravelling/spot improvement, resealing works on 39 km, 252 km and 76 km of the trunk, feeder and urban road networks respectively.
- v. Carried out minor rehabilitation works covering minor upgrading and the construction of culverts and drainage structures on 297 km of trunk roads, 382 km of feeder and 74 km of urban road network, respectively.
- vi. Undertook the design and construction. Tema-Aflao Phase 1 (17 km) (Interchange & Service Roads) is progressing at 29 per cent as at the end of September 2025.
- vii. Improved works on selected roads in Sekondi and Takoradi Phase 1 at 85 per cent progress as at the end of August 2025. Including upgrades to Axim, Shippers Council and Harbour roads in Takoradi, and widening of Sekondi road between Paa Grant Roundabout and Effia Nkwanta Hospital, the Adiembra Roads between Effia Nkwanta Hospital and Regional Coordinating Council.
- viii. Carried out the construction of local roads component of the Suame Interchange Project (Phase 2 at 72 per cent completion and the construction of 3 bypasses at Abusuakruwa, New Road, and Anomangye, widening of a 3-kilometre stretches of the Offinso Road; and the improvement of 15 kilometres of complementary roads.
- ix. Dualisation and improvement of safety on major trunk roads in the country, including the construction of 4 by-passes on the Accra-Kumasi Highway at Osino, Anyinam, Enyiresi and Konongo.

The physical progress is as follows:

LOT	ROAD NAME	LENGTH (KM)	STATUS (SEP 2025)
1	Osino South Bound Carriageway	11.55	77%
2	Osino North Bound Carriageway	11.55	70%
3	Anyinam South Bound Carriageway	6.10	62%
4	Anyinam North Bound Carriageway	6.10	100%
5	Enyiresi South Bound Carriageway	9.10	65%
6	Enyiresi North Bound Carriageway	9.10	64%
7	Konongo South Bound Carriageway	13.60	66%
8	Konongo South Bound Carriageway	13.60	62%

x. Dualisation of Nsawam - Ofankor Road (33.4 km) achieved a physical progress of 75 per cent which includes widening of the road to 10-lanes with a 6-lane expressway and 4-lane service road with interchanges at Amasaman, Pobiman, Medie and Nsawam Junction.

xii. Design and construction of bridge over the Black Volta Buie (240 m span), bridge over the White Volta at Yapei (240 m) span, bridge over the white Volta at Daboya and Nawuni Bridge is at 33 per cent progress.

xi. Ongoing construction works on the Dome Kitase Road (22 km) at 27 per cent progress, while, the design, supply and installation of 50 No. Steel Composite Czech Bridges has achieved progress at 87 per cent as at September 2025.

Reconstruction and upgrade of several trunk roads have achieved the following progresses:

LOT	SECTION NAME	LENGTH (KM)	STATUS (SEP 2025)
1	Rehabilitation and upgrading of Akoti Junction – Winneba Roundabout (km 0.00 -12.00) – Lot 1	12	65%
1A	Construction of Interchanges at Sapato (km 1+500), Budumburam (km 3+200), Awutu Breku (km 7+200), Akoti (km 9+800) and 3no. Footbridges		71%
2	Rehabilitation and upgrading of Akoti Junction – Winneba Roundabout (km 12.00 – 30.00) – Lot 2	18	58%
2A	Construction of Interchanges at km 15+900 (Onion market); km 18+900 (Potsin); Twin River Bridge at km 22+900 (Okyerko); and 3no. Footbridges		75%

xiii. Dualisation of Adenta - Dodowa Road (22 km) to improve travel time along the corridor especially for commuters traveling from Adenta, Amrahia, Oyibi to Dodowa among others. The physical progress is 49 per cent.

xiv. Dualisation of Takoradi - Agona kwanta (23 km), includes reconstruction and widening of 3 bridges along the road between

Takoradi and Agona at 63 per cent progress.

xv. Construction of Dufor - Asikuma Junction (39.2 km) as well as Asutuare - Aveyime Road (24 km) + 2 Grade Separated Interchanges is progressing at 25 per cent as at September 2025.

xvi. Design and construction of Accra - Tema Motorway and Extension Project (27.7 km) -Section 1: Tema

Roundabout to Tetteh Quarshie Interchange (19.5 km), including the reconstruction of the Accra - Tema Motorway into a 4-lane expressway with a 3-lane service road in both directions and interchanges at Old Lashibi (Ashaiman under-bridge), Community 18 and Teshie Link and remodeling of the Tetteh Quarshie Interchange with works ongoing, at 29 per cent progress.

xvii. Pursued the implementation of the Law on Axle Load Limit as stipulated in the Road Traffic Regulation LI 2180.

xviii. Undertook the construction of fourteen (14) footbridges at hazardous locations in Accra, Kumasi and Cape Coast as follows:

LOT	ROAD NAME	STATUS
1	Tetegu	100% - Opened to Traffic
2	Abeka Lapaz	96% - Bridge Launched
3	Presec Legon	87% - Bridge Launched
4	Kanda Mosque	83% - Ongoing
5	GBC Zebra Crossing	62% - Ongoing
6	Labone Junction	60% - Ongoing
7	N1-Block Factory, Aplaku Junction	Contractor mobilised to site
8	Opoku Ware	72% - Ongoing
9	Yaa Asantewaa	66% - Ongoing
10	Appiah Minkah	62% - Ongoing
11	Abuakwa Market	54% - Ongoing
12	UCC Southern Gate	95% - Bridge Launched
13	Assin Fosu	71% - Ongoing
14	Adisadel College, 2 nd Gate	52% - Ongoing

Financial Performance

The Ministry of Roads and Highways and its Agencies was appropriated a total budgetary amount of three billion, two hundred and forty-four million, nine hundred and seventy-nine thousand,

seven hundred and one Ghana Cedis and two pesewas (GH¢3,244,979,701.02) for the implementation of its activities in 2025. The allocation was disbursed among the three cost centres of the Ministry as follows:

Compensation	-	GHC126,872,669.00
Goods and Services	-	GHC53,099,470.02
Capital Expenditure	-	GHC3,065,007,562.00
Total	-	GHC3,244,979,701.02

Out of this, GHC2,405,698,194 was from GoG, GHC54,762,507.02 was IGF, and an amount of GHC784,519,000 was Foreign Loans and Grants.

Appropriation was released to the Ministry for its operations. The actual expenditure for the same period however stood at GHC1,397,827,033.60.

As at the end of September 2025, a sum of GHC3,269,730,252.60 representing 100.77 per cent of the total

The 2025 budget performance of the Ministry is presented in the table below:

Table 1: 2025 Budget Performance of the Ministry of Roads and Highways

Economic Classification	2025 Appropriation (A) (GHC)	2025 Releases as 30/09/2025 (B) (GHC)	Actual Expenditure 30/09/2025 (C) (GHC)	Variance (A-B) (GHC)	Per cent released
Compensation of Employees	126,872,669.00	95,549,399.80	95,549,399.80	31,323,269.20	75.31
Goods and Services	53,099,470.02	52,100,755.3	51,688,171.30	998,714.72	98.12
Capital Expenditure	3,065,007,562.00	3,122,080,097.50	1,250,589,462.50	(57,072,535.50)	101.86
Total	3,244,979,701.02	3,269,730,252.60	1,397,827,033.60	(24,750,551.58)	100.76

Sources: Presentation on the Annual Estimate of the Ministry of Roads and Highways

The GoG appropriation of GH¢2,405,698,194 was disbursed in furtherance of the objectives of the Ministry. Details of the release of GoG allocation is as follows:

Table 2: 2025 GoG Budget Performance as at 30/09/2025

Economic Classification	2025 Appropriation (A) (GH¢)	2025 Releases (B) (GH¢)	Actual Expenditure (GH¢)	Variance (A-B) (GH¢)	Per cent released
Compensation	126,872,669.00	95,549,399.80	95,549,399.80	31,323,269.20	75.31
Good and Services	3,693,419.00	1,361,678.00	949,094.00	2,331,741.00	36.86
Capital Expenditure	2,275,132,106.00	1,960,625,656.00	89,135,021.00	314,506,450.00	86.18
Total	2,405,698,194.00	2,057,536,733.80	185,633,514.80	348,161,460.20	85.53

Sources: Ministry of Roads and Highways 2025 Annual Estimates Performance Report

The IGF appropriation of GH¢54,762,507.02 was disbursed in furtherance of the objectives of the Ministry. Details of the release of IGF allocation is as follows:

Table 3: 2025 IGF Budget Performance as at 30/09/2025

Economic Classification	2025 Appropriation (A) (GH¢)	2025 Releases (B) (GH¢)	Actual Expenditure (GH¢)	Variance (A-B) (GH¢)	Per cent released
Good and Services	49,406,051.02	50,739,077.30	50,739,077.30	(1,333,026.28)	102.7
Capital Expenditure	5,356,456.00	5,364,702.56	5,364,702.56	(8,246.56)	100.2
Total	54,762,507.02	56,103,779.86	56,103,779.86	(1,341,272.84)	102.5

Sources: Ministry of Roads and Highways 2025 Annual Estimates Performance Report

In pursuit of its objectives for the 2025 financial year, an amount of GH¢784,519,000 was also released from the Development Partners Fund to

support the capital expenditure of the Ministry of Roads and Highways in the year under review. The Development Partner Budget performance is as follows:

Table 4: 2025 Development Partners Fund Budget Performance as at the end of September 2025

Economic Classification	2025 Appropriation (A) (GHC)	2025 Releases (B) (GHC)	Actual Expenditure (GHC)	Variance (A-B) (GHC)	Per cent released
Capital Expenditure	784,519,000.00	1,156,089,738.94	1,156,089,738.94	(371,570,738.94)	147.4
Total	784,519,000.00	1,156,089,738.94	1,156,089,738.94	(371,570,738.94)	147.4

Sources: Ministry of Roads and Highways 2025 Annual Estimates Performance Report

Outlook for 2026

In the 2026 financial year, the Ministry of Roads and Highways intends to undertake the following projects under the thematic areas below:

Management and Administration

- Replace 137 staff; and
- Train 214 technical staff and 312 non-technical staff.

Road Construction

- Construct 200 km of trunk roads and 20 km of urban roads; and
- Construct 6, 5, and 5 bridges on the trunk, feeder and urban road network respectively.

Road Rehabilitation and Maintenance

- Undertake 17,695 km, 15,000 km and 3,500 km of routine maintenance activities (grading, pothole patching, shoulder maintenance, vegetation control) on trunk, feeder and urban road networks respectively.
- Undertake 1,750 km, 500 km, 300 km (under unconstrained conditions) of periodic maintenance activities (Spot Improvement, Re-gravelling, Resealing, Asphaltic Overlay, Partial Reconstruction, Maintenance of Bridges) on trunk, feeder and urban roads respectively.
- Undertake minor rehabilitation works on 1,678 km of trunk roads, 500 km of feeder roads and 30 km of urban roads (under unconstrained conditions).

Road Safety and Environment

- Install 10 traffic signals.
- Maintain 404 signalised junctions.
- Treat 50 road safety hazard sites.
- Improve junction location of 100 locations.
- Construct 20 km of walkway.
- Keep percent overloading below 5 per cent.

Budgetary Allocation for the 2026 Fiscal Year

For the 2026 financial year, the sum of five billion, three hundred and

seventy-eight million, four hundred and fifty-eight thousand, three hundred and fifty-nine Ghana Cedis (GH¢5,378,458,359.00) has been allocated to the Ministry of Roads and Highways for the implementation of its activities in the 2026 financial year. Out of this allocation, four billion, four hundred and forty-seven million, four hundred and twenty-five thousand, four hundred and forty-nine Ghana Cedis (GH¢4,447,425,449.00) is from GoG sources, twenty million, two hundred and thirty-two thousand, nine hundred and ten Ghana Cedis (GH¢20,232,910.00) is from IGF source and the remaining nine hundred and ten million, eight hundred thousand Ghana Cedis (GH¢910,800,000.00) is expected to be received from Development partners.

The 2026 allocation will be disbursed among the three main economic classifications as follows:

Table 5: 2026 Budgetary Allocation by Economic Classification

No.	Expenditure item	GoG Allocation (GH¢)	IGF	DP Funds (GH¢)	Total (GH¢)
1.	Compensation of Employees	142,687,104		-	142,687,104
2.	Goods and Services	3,693,419	14,097,586	41,400,000	59,191,005
3.	Capex	4,301,044,926	6,135,324	869,400,000	5,176,580,250
	Total	4,447,425,449	20,232,910	910,800,000	5,378,458,359

Source: Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year.

Observations and Recommendations

The Committee, having examined the Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Roads and Highways for the 2026 financial year, makes the following observations and recommendations:

Increased Release and Expenditure of Development Partners Funds 2025

The Committee in its deliberation, observes that an amount of GH¢784,519,000.00 was appropriated to the Ministry of Roads and Highways under the Development Partners' Fund Source in 2025. However, the Ministry expended an amount of GH¢1,156,089,738.94, resulting in an over-expenditure of GH¢371,570,738.94. This represents a 47.37 per cent over the 2025 appropriation.

After the successful debt restructuring with the country's bilateral and multilateral partners, additional resources were freed to finance and support the payment of IPCs for capital projects by these debt partners. While acknowledging the need to honour IPCs to avoid cost overruns and interest accumulation, the Committee noted that the Ministry incurred expenditure significantly above the appropriated amount without prior parliamentary approval, contrary to the requirements of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921).

The Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance ensures strict compliance with the appropriation process

by seeking parliamentary approval whenever Development Partners' inflows are expected to exceed the appropriated amount. The Committee is of the view that improved coordination, timely communication, and strengthened expenditure planning will help safeguard Parliament's oversight role and promote fiscal discipline in accordance with Act 921.

Big Push Allocation Criteria

The Committee noted that an amount of GH¢30 billion has been allocated in the 2026 Budget to improve the country's road network. The Committee further noted that there are no clear criteria for the selection of roads to be financed under the Big Push programme. The Minister explained that the project aims to easing severe traffic congestion on major urban arterial corridors. This has led to perceptions of inequality and limited visibility of the programme's benefits in areas that may fall within the high-traffic zones targeted by the initiative.

The Committee therefore recommends to the Ministry to maintain the core technical criteria for selecting Big Push projects but complement it with transparent communication strategy that explains the national economic rationale and expected wider benefits including reduced travel times, improved logistics, and spill over effects for surrounding districts.

The Committee urges the Ministry to explore other funding options outside the

Big Push for routine maintenance and the construction of other road networks.

See attached Appendix A for Big Push Projects.

Suspension of Projects due to Debt Restructuring Programme

The Committee learnt during the Ministry's Budget submission that, the suspension of several ongoing and planned road infrastructure project resulting from the ongoing debt-restructuring programme, has led to delays, cost overruns and deterioration of partially completed works. Accordingly, this has weakened overall implementation performance and reduced service delivery across key roads in the country.

The Committee therefore recommends to the Ministry to prioritise essential projects and secure protected or transitional funding to minimise further deterioration and ensure continuity during the debt-restructuring period. The Committee contends that, alternative financing options and stronger contract management should also be pursued to stabilise implementation timelines.

Inadequate Staffing Levels across the three Agencies under the Ministry

The Committee further noted that, staffing levels across the Department of Feeder Roads, Ghana Highways Authority and Department of Urban Roads remain inadequate to support nationwide operations. These Agencies face shortages

in critical technical and supervisory roles, resulting in over-stretched personnel, limited field supervision, and reduced capacity for effective project management, monitoring and quality assurance.

The Committee noted that, as part of efforts to enhance staff capacity and operational efficiency, the Ministry intends to replace one hundred and thirty-seven (137) staff. The Ministry will also train two hundred and fourteen (214) technical staff and three hundred and twelve (312) non-technical staff respectively to augment their staff strength among these three Agencies.

The Committee recommends that, to address staffing constraints, a comprehensive manpower assessment should be conducted across the three Agencies to identify gaps and guide targeted recruitment and capacity building efforts. Furthermore, the Ministry should also invest in digital tools and streamline processes to enhance operational efficiency while advocating sustainable increases in budgetary allocations to support adequate staffing, improved supervision and effective nationwide service delivery.

Increased Outstanding Claims for 2024 and 2025 Financial Years

The Committee expressed serious concern over the rapid escalation of outstanding claims owed by the Ministry. The Committee noted that the outstanding claims increased from GH¢11,993,940,919.66 to

GHC19,944,206,697.32 between December 2024 and September 2025, an increase of GHC7,950,265,777.66 (66.27 per cent). Additionally, the arrears on the Road Maintenance Trust Fund have also increased significantly by 46.99 per cent from GHC5,662,772,975.60 to GHC8,324,212,305.05 in 2025. The Committee noted that the substantial rise in outstanding commitment poses significant fiscal risks, affects project continuity, undermines financial planning, and reflects weak commitment control mechanisms.

The Minister explained that, the outstanding claims are not claims to new projects but instead, IPCs raised on old projects as contractors continue working and raising IPCs. He assured the Committee that there are enough funds in the Road Fund to offset most of the claims. The Committee urged the Ministry of Roads and Highways to strengthen its commitment control systems, enhance project cash flow planning, avoid entering into new contractual obligations without secured funding and speed up the constitution of the Road Maintenance Trust Fund Board.

Additionally, the Ministry of Finance should priorities a clear arrears clearance strategy to prevent the accumulation of unsustainable liabilities and ensure the orderly execution of road sector project.

Overall Budget Allocation for 2026

The Committee observed that a total amount of GHC5,378,458,359.00 has

been allocated to the Ministry for the 2026 financial year. This allocation, the Committee noted, is heavily skewed towards Capital Expenditure, which amounts to GHC5,176,580,250.00, representing 96.25 per cent of the total allocation. Out of this amount, GHC4,447,425,449.00 is from GoG sources, GHC20,232,910.00 from Internally Generated Funds (IGF), and GHC910,800,000.00 is expected from Development Partners. The Committee's view is that the 2026 allocation is aligned with Government's broader infrastructure development agenda, particularly with ongoing interventions in trunk, feeder, and urban road networks.

The Committee commends the emphasis on capital investment but urges the Ministry to ensure that adequate funding is made available for Goods and Services to support effective operations, supervision, and maintenance of capital projects as well as intensify efforts to mobilise and improve expenditure efficiency to ensure that essential operational activities are not hampered.

Additionally, the Committee urges the Ministry to enhance monitoring of contractors, ensure value for money, and strengthen maintenance practices to safeguard investments made in the road sector.

The Committee also recommends that, the Ministry of Finance ensures the timely release of funds and strengthens engagement with Development Partners to secure the full complement of expected

inflows for effective implementation of planned programmes.

Road Condition Mix

The Committee noted that Ghana's road condition mix currently stands at 47 per cent good, 32 per cent fair, and 21 per cent poor with the Ministry of Roads and Highways aiming for 55 per cent good, 24 per cent fair, and 21 per cent poor by 2028. The Committee also noted that with the commencement of the Government Flagship Road Improvement Programme under the Big Push, the good road conditions are estimated to increase to 60 per cent by 2029.

The Committee acknowledged the Ministry's ongoing efforts to enhance the quality of the national road network but expressed its dissatisfaction at the lack of maintenance on the country's major trunk roads and the poor state of roads especially in rural areas.

The Committee urged the Ministry to take steps to ensure that issues that affect road construction including funding, delayed payments to contractors, stalled works, inadequate maintenance, and supervision are addressed to ensure improved road conditions.

Additionally, the Committee recommends to the Ministry to conduct an independent field verification exercise using standardised assessment tools and methods to confirm the accuracy of the reported road-condition

mix and ensure it accurately reflects the actual state of the road network.

In view of the ambition of the Ministry to achieve 60 per cent of good road network by 2029, the Committee urged the Ministry to strengthen the planning, implementation, monitoring and evaluation mechanisms, ensure timely validation of road condition, and accelerate interventions to achieve the projected improvements in the national road condition mix.

Conclusion

The road sector plays a critical role in ensuring an efficient transportation system in Ghana. The Ministry's mandate to provide a road transport network that meets the needs of society, supports accelerated economic growth, and its contribution to poverty reduction can only be fully achieved when it is adequately resourced. Sufficient funding is therefore essential to enable the Ministry to expand and maintain the country's road infrastructure network.

The Committee therefore recommends to the House to adopt its Report and approve the sum of five billion, three hundred and seventy-eight million, four hundred and fifty-eight thousand, three hundred and fifty-nine Ghana Cedis (GHC5,378,458,359.00) for the activities of the Ministry of Roads and Highways for the financial year ending 31st December, 2026.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

APPENDIX A**Big Push Programme Projects – Upper Corridor**

1. Rehabilitation of Wa - Han Road (Km 0- 54)
2. Upgrading of Tumu - Hamile Road (Km 40.00 - 55.00)
3. Upgrading of Tumu - Han - Lawra Road (Km 0-10)
4. Partial Reconstruction of Navrongo - Tumu Road (27km)

Big Push Programme Projects-Techiman –Wa

1. Rehabilitation of Wenchi- Sawla Road (Km 0+000-Km 25+000)
2. Rehabilitation of Wenchi-Sawla Road (Km 25+000 - Km 50+000)
3. Rehabilitation of Wenchi-Sawla Road (Km 50+000 - Km 75+000)
4. Rehabilitation of Wenchi- Sawla Road (Km 75+000 - Km 100+000) including Bamboi (3km) and Banda Nkwanta (2km) Town Roads
5. Rehabilitation of Wenchi - Sawla (Km 100+000 - 125+000) including Tinga Town Roads (3km)
6. Rehabilitation of Wenchi - Sawla (Km 125+000 - 150+000)
7. Rehabilitation of Wenchi - Sawla (Km 150+000 - 195+000) and others (7km)
8. Rehabilitation of Techiman - Nkonsia - Wenchi Road (32.6km)
9. Construction of Dambai Bridge.

Big Push Programme Projects – Ring Road

1. Construction of Sunyani Outer Ring Road (17km) - Lot 1
2. Construction of Sunyani Outer Ring Road (17km) - Lot 2
3. Construction of 3rd Ring Road, Tamale -Ph. (11km) - Lot 1
4. Construction of 3rd Ring Road, Tamale -Ph. 1(11km) - Lot 2
5. Construction of 3rd Ring Road, Tamale -Ph. 1(11km) - Lot 3
6. Construction of Kumasi Outer Ring Road Project (15km) - Lot 1
7. Construction of Kumasi Outer Ring Road Project (15km) - Lot 2
8. Construction of Kumasi Outer Ring Road Project (15km) - Lot 3

Big Push Programme Projects – Eastern Corridor

1. Rehabilitation of Gbintri - Nakpanduri Road (44km)
2. Rehabilitation of Dodo Pepesu - Nkwanta (46km)
3. Rehabilitation of Atimpoku - Asikuma Junction(0-26km)
4. Rehabilitation of Asikuma Junction - Anyirawasi (Km 26.0-49.4)

5. Reconstruction of Anyirawasi - Ho Tritrinu (Km 49.4 - 70.0). Ho (Guinness Deport) - Ho Airport 2nd Gate (Km 0-7.7)
6. Upgrading of Akosombo-Gyakiti-Kudikope Feeder Road
7. Upgrading of Asikuma to Kpalime Feeder Road
8. Upgrading of Akwamufie Feeder Road
9. Rehabilitation of Ho - Kpetoe Road (Km 7.70 - Km 27.60)
10. Rehabilitation of Kpetoe - Aveafiadenyigba Road (Km 27+600 - Km 62+600) including Ziope Towns Roads.
11. Rehabilitation of Afiadenyigba - Penyi Road (Km 62.60 - Km 85.0) including dualisation of Dzodze Town Road (3.5km) and Internal Link Roads within Dzodze and Penyi Township (3km)
12. Rehabilitation of Penyi - Aflao (Km 85+000 - 107+000)

Big Push Programme Projects – Winneba –Takoradi

1. Construction of Interchange at Winneba Roundabout Km 28+200); 10 No. Footbridges; and Dualization into Winneba and Swedru Towns (4.0km)
2. Dualisation of Winneba - Cape Coast Road (30 - 54 Km)
3. Dualisation of Winneba - Cape Coast Road (54 - 79 Km)
4. Dualisation of Cape Coast-Takoradi Road (114 - 139 Km)
5. Dualisation of Cape Coast- Takoradi Road (139 - 164 Km)
6. Dualisation of Cape Coast- Takoradi Road (164 - 187.6km)
7. Rehabilitation of Mankessim - Ajumako - Agona Swedru road and others total length = 111km.

Big Push Programme Projects – Greater Accra Corridor

1. Rehabilitation of Tema - Aflao Road (Km 1- 18.30)
2. Reconstruction of Dodowa - Afienva-Dawhenya Road (0-24.80km) & Selected Town Roads 3.0km
3. Upgrading of Oyibi-Appolonia-Afienva Road (21.0km)

Big Push Programme Projects – Western Corridor

1. Construction of Enchi- Elubo Road (71.25 Km)
2. Construction of Dadieso - Akontombra Road (Km 4.0 - Km 26.30)
3. Upgrading of Adwotua - Oseikojokrom Road (Km16-41)
4. Upgrading of Enchi - Kudjournu - Peki (Km 0.00 -Km30.00)
5. Upgrading of Enchi - Kudjournu - Peki (Km30.00 - Km 62.00)
6. Upgrading of Bediako Junction - Camp 15 - Sefwi Adabokrom (55km)
7. Upgrading of Bediako Junction - Camp 15 - Sefwi Adabokrom (9.5km)

Question proposed.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Let me now invite the Hon Ranking Member of the Committee.

Yes, Hon Member for Akim Swedru.

Mr Kennedy Nyarko Osei (NPP — Akim Swedru): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to make a few comments and observations on the Report.

Mr Speaker, your Committee met the Ministry and the various agencies under the Ministry to consider their Annual Budget Estimates for the financial year 2026. Some few observations were made during the meeting, and I want to draw the attention of the House and the Minister as well to them.

Mr Speaker, the Committee observed that in 2026, under the Big Push Project, an allocation of GH¢30 billion, which is equivalent to about US\$2.6 billion, has been allocated to the Ministry to execute over 50 critical projects. We drew the attention of the Hon Minister to the fact that this is a very big investment that we are putting into the road sector, and therefore, the Minister needs to ensure that those contractors that are going to be selected for the project, do a quality job, not a shoddy one. It is a single big investment that we are putting into the road sector. Therefore, it is important that the Minister assures the House that he will ensure that quality work is delivered.

Mr Speaker, we also observed that some key projects have been suspended for which we sought explanations from the Hon Minister. These projects were externally funded and because of the debt restructuring, some of these projects had to be suspended because they could not do any drawdowns or disbursement from the loans. So, we advised the Hon Minister that if there is any other alternative means to funds this project, he should do so to ensure the project continues, instead of allowing the work that has been done already to deteriorate. The Minister assured us that he will take a cue and ensure that it is also done.

Mr Speaker, we also observed that the outstanding claims has increased. If we look at the GoG claims in terms of interim payment certificates (IPCs) that have been submitted and waiting for payment on GOG and road fund—We are talking about 60 per cent increase. That is about an additional GH¢10 billion as to where it was handed over to this administration. I am not blaming the Government for such an increase. Once we are embarking on such projects, definitely, there is going to be IPCs that will be submitted and needed to be paid. The problem we have on our hands is that, there are no clear strategies as to how the Government intends to clear this debt that keeps on accumulating. So, we sought to draw the attention of the Minister to, as a matter of urgency, devise a strategy as to how they can work and clear off this debt that is accumulating so that the Ministry will not be saddled with huge debt which will

affect the progress of ongoing project. The Hon Minister has taken the advice.

2:30 p.m.

Mr Speaker, if we look at the total allocation from the various sources of funds that the Ministry is going to have for 2026, it is in excess of GH¢38.2 billion. This is about US\$3.3 billion; it is a huge money that is going to the road sector. We want to encourage the Minister to put this money to good use and fix the various bad roads, especially the critical ones, because this is a huge budget that we are giving to them.

Mr Speaker, the last observation is about the Road Fund. We realised that nothing has been released to the Road Fund.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: What do you mean by that? Is it in respect of 2025?

Mr Osei: Mr Speaker, for 2025, no single release was made to the Road Fund. I was hoping that the Minister for Finance would be in the Chamber so I could draw his attention to it that it is against the law. He cannot collect the levies and keep them without giving them to the Ministry to pay contractors. There are several contractors who have done several jobs for which the Ministry needs the money. So he cannot collect the Road Fund levies and keep them, and not release anything. As of September, he had not released even a penny to the Ministry of Roads and Highways.

I think it is important that I draw the attention of the Minister for Finance; he is breaching the law. He has to take a cue and ensure that he releases the money to the Ministry as early as possible, so that the Minister can pay those contractors who have worked under the Road Fund Project who need the money to continue with the project.

Mr Speaker, with these observations, I have no difficulty in supporting the approval of a budget of GH¢5.3 billion for the Ministry for the activities and programmes for the year 2026.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Yes, let me go to the Hon Member for Bolgatanga Central.

Mr Isaac Adongo (NDC—Bolgatanga): Mr Speaker, I rise to urge my Colleagues to support the approval of the estimates for the Ministry of Roads and Highways. Road infrastructure is very critical to the development of our country, and it costs a lot of money to build roads. While I agree with my Colleague on his call for the Ministry of Finance to have made resources available to the Road Fund, I want to draw our attention to the fact that the Minister for Finance, when he presented the 2025 Budget, indicated clearly that the Road Fund was going to go under some reforms and those reforms included introducing a new Road Maintenance Trust Fund, which was going to replace the old Road Fund. Therefore, it became clear that the Road Fund in its current form and stature was going to change.

That is the reason we did not see a lot of allocation to the Road Fund.

But Mr Speaker, this House has passed the new Road Maintenance Trust Fund, which will continue—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Isaac, hold on. Yes, Ranking Member?

Mr Osei: Mr Speaker, my Colleague, Hon Adongo, made a claim which I need to draw his attention to. He should understand that the Budget was passed long before the Road Trust Fund was passed in this House. So, he cannot claim that the delay in the release of the fund is due to the Act that was passed; it cannot be true. So, I just want to draw his attention to that.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. Yes, Hon Adongo?

Mr Adongo: Mr Speaker, I can see that my Colleague is very particular about the Road Fund. Fortunately, from 2026, he will not have to debate this issue again because we have passed a new law mandating the Government to set up a Road Maintenance Trust Fund. So, we hope that the resources that have been assigned to that Fund will be made available in 2026 so that a lot of work can happen.

But Mr Speaker, it is also instructive to know that beyond the amount being approved for the Ministry of Roads and Highways Estimate, there is the component of the “Big Push” which is

being catered for as a special project under the Government’s other obligations. Therefore, when we have the opportunity to consider other Government’s obligations under the Ministry of Finance, we would also see a line allocating money first to the Road Maintenance Trust Fund and also to the “Big Push”. And together, I believe that the Ministry of Roads and Highways would have enough resources to carry out the projects that have been listed in the Minister’s Budget.

So, on this basis, I wish to encourage all of us to support the Ministry’s estimate so that resources can be made available in 2026 to improve our road network.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, let me listen to the Hon Member for Okaikwei Central.

Mr Patrick Yaw Boamah (NPP—Okaikwei Central): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to contribute to the Motion on the floor, ably moved by the Chairman of the Committee.

Mr Speaker, it is instructive to note from the Report of the Committee under paragraph 9, an extensive table on the Accra-Kumasi dualisation Programme, which has become very topical in this country, especially when the new administration has decided to construct an expressway. If we look at the table under paragraph 9, it gives an indication of the extent of work done on the highway, which every Ghanaian knows

to be one of the most important roads in this country.

The Osino-South Carriageway, which is about 11.55 kilometres, is 77 per cent done as of September 2025. Osino-North is 70 per cent; Anyinam is 62 per cent; Anyinam-North is 100 per cent complete; Ngyiresi-South is 65 per cent; Ngyiresi-North is 64 per cent; Konongo-North is 66 per cent, and Konongo-South is 62 per cent. I am happy that the Ministry is taking a very serious look at this to ensure its completion. But if we look at paragraph 12, it also has the Kasoa-Winneba dualisation programme properly tabled. I am surprised I did not see the Winneba-Mankessim stretch that the Minister inaugurated for its construction. I was on that road last week. Something is being done. I do not know if, because he has not made budgetary provisions, he could not capture it in the report. I see it as a serious omission.

Mr Speaker, on page 16 of the report, it talks about the overall budget estimate for 2026, which is about GH¢5.378 billion. It would interest us to know that out of the said amount, about GH¢910 million is expected from development partners. Mr Speaker, we are still under an IMF programme, and if we are still going to rely on about a billion Ghana cedi from our development partners, I wonder whether the Ministry will be able to achieve all its objectives under this programme, especially when the Ministry is talking about a lot of huge projects like Wenchi to Wa and also the Dawhenya Corridor.

2:40 p.m.

My Colleague from Takoradi drew my attention to a module under paragraph 7, page 17 on the road condition mix. The Minister has had an opportunity to speak about the road condition mix, and has had some issues with it. I am surprised he is still adhering to the same model that we had some debates over on this Floor. During his winding up, I would expect him to explain to the House whether he still goes by this model or there has been a shift, especially when we are doing the actual computation or measuring of our roads in this country. All in all, it is a good Report, and we think the Budget is inadequate to support the entire road infrastructure programme of the Government. We ask for the adoption of the Report. I thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, can I put the Question?

Mr Dafeamekpor — *rose* —

Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah (NPP — Ofoase Ayirebi): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. May you live long. I think, as has been intimated by Colleagues, we will all support the adoption of this Report. However, there are a number of fundamental issues that I think need to be addressed before this Report requesting for about GH¢5 billion for 2026 is approved. In the Budget, the Minister for Finance has submitted a report on the utilisation of

funds for 2025, and there are major discrepancies in the reporting on how those funds, especially under the Big Push, have been utilised. If it is possible, my prayer would be that we step this down and correct those discrepancies. They are very significant, running into billions of cedis. When we are done with that, then we come to make new allocation. I am even of the view that the GH¢5 billion is not enough. It is important that we do a better allocation. But, the foundation on which we are building this new allocation is problematic.

First of all, if we go to Appendix 3C of the 2025 Budget, we will find that in the domestic capital expenditure allocation of about GH¢7 billion, there was no allocation as part of that for payment for the Big Push. In fact, the Big Push was set out separately from that GH¢7 billion. If we come and look at the Appendix 2C in the 2026 Budget, the numbers do not add up. Mr Speaker, if you give me just a bit of latitude, I want to draw the Minister's attention —

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Are you referring to the main Budget?

Mr Nkrumah Yes, I do have it here. This is the foundation on which we are mounting this new application for the GH¢5 billion. That is why I think it should be corrected as a matter of urgency.

First of all, in the 2026 Budget which reports on the 2025 allocation, the Ministry of Finance said that they had

allocated GH¢13 billion for the Big Push; GH¢8.8 coming from the Annual Budget Funding Amount (ABFA) and GH¢4.8 from the mineral royalties. As of the end of September, they had programmed that they would spend GH¢9.9 billion on the Big Push. The first challenge is that the Report claims that they have spent GH¢10 billion on the Big Push. Why that cannot be correct is that the Big Push was launched on 16th September, 2025. It cannot be possible that between 16th September, 2025, and the end of September 2025 as this Report is saying, GH¢10 billion worth of certificates of some sort had been presented, processed, and paid within that two-week period. Between when — **[An Hon Member: 24-Hour Economy]** — Hon Members, this is a very serious matter. Let us not play with it. It is not about 24-Hour Economy. We are trying to correct the data. Let us take it seriously.

Between 16th September, 2025, and the end of September, 2025, it is not possible that GH¢10 billion worth of construction work had been done, certificates issued, and paid for. Mr Speaker, if we go further, we will find that, as I mentioned earlier, in the original allocation of GH¢7 billion, there was no provision for old contractors to be paid under the Big Push, if we check the Appendix 3C in the 2025 Budget. In this new Budget, we are now being informed that GH¢3.3 billion of the GH¢7 billion that was supposed to be used for paying old contracts is going to be paid to old contractors under the

Big Push. Again, it becomes difficult to reconcile the two.

But my last point that is most worrying, again, is that, if we look at the data, Mr Speaker, as at the end of September, the Ministry of Finance reports that they have paid GHC5.1 billion from the Minerals Royalties Fund under the Big Push. They project that, by the end of December, they will collect GHC1 billion back from the contractors. It is not possible. Money that has been paid out cannot be taken back from those contractors. So, if we look at the Appendix 2C, it says that GHC5.1 billion, as at the end of quarter 3, but what they will record at the end of the year is GHC4.9 billion. If we look at the numbers that have been presented by the Ministry of Finance, it does not add up. Mr Speaker, there is a suspicion that old contractors are being paid, but it is being captured as though they are being paid for the Big Push programme. That would be very deceptive to people, because people's understanding is that contracts are being given, certificates are being presented, and they are being paid for.

Mr Speaker, respectfully, I am of the view, that before we approve this new GHC5 billion allocation—These are not small sums of money we are talking about. We should, as a matter of urgency, maybe stand this down and get these numbers corrected and aligned properly, so that when the new allocation is being done, we are sure that their reporting will align as well. I thank you, Mr Speaker. This is my contribution to the Report.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. Fortunately, the Minister is here, so the Minister can address all those things.

Yes, Minority Leader, do you want to speak?

Minority Leader, let us hear you.

Minority Leader (Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin): Mr Speaker, I want to align with the views expressed by the respected Member for Ofoase Ayirebi. Mr Speaker may recall that during the comments on this Budget Statement and Economic Policy, the Minority raised this serious issue of “cut and paste” Budget. No effort has been made to address this. Day in, day out, our Friends get exposed. We keep exposing them. The figures that the respected Hon Member for Ofoase Ayirebi just put out, it appears this Budget was never scrutinised and we are being called upon to approve.

If they say they have done some payment on the Big Push, look at when the Big Push announcement was made, the period, and then they are allocating figures in excess of GHC7 billion, claiming that they have made some payments. They launched the Big Push and they said they have made payment to contractors under Big Push in less than a month. This can be nothing less than a very lazily prepared Budget. Are they just putting out the numbers? Did they not do any due diligence? They come to this Parliament, and they did not scrutinise? Does it mean they did not

read their own Budget? We have told them time without number that their governance and its success will largely depend on the scrutiny that will come from our Side. It is the reason why we always want them to be a bit more tolerant, because with their number of 189, they did not even spot this. Figures are just being bandied around. This is the time I expect them to rise on a point of order. They should rise on a point of order, because these figures have become part of the records of this House.

2:50 p.m.

Mr Speaker, that said, I would move to the second leg of my observations. In this 2025, I want the Minister to seize this opportunity to tell us how much was released to him. He became literally redundant, because the funds were not released. If they want to rebut this, the record will have him on how much was released. Now they say we should approve this amount of GH¢5.378 billion. Are they sure the Minister is going to release these moneys for their operations?

Besides, they are almost a year into office. The Road Fund still has no board. How do they disburse funds to the road contractors? This is part of the inefficiencies they have introduced as part of their so-called resets. I will not use the word incompetence, but anybody reading this, would wonder why a government with the opportunity to put in place its governance structures have refused to set up the Road Fund Board.

They came here to amend the law. What is delaying the formation of the board? Contractors are suffering. Is it a sin to invest in the private sector? Ghanaian businesses who have gone to the banks to take loans are not being paid. Their workers are at home; they are unable to pay them. If you ask, the simple reason is that the Government for over 10 months has refused, neglected and for whatever internal politicking, is unable to set up a simple board. I thought they had the men; they had competent men and women. Some Members of Parliament (MPs) have no portfolio or are not on any board. Why are they not putting a lot of the qualified people in their Government?

They cannot set up a Road Fund Board. Have they failed the people of Ghana already or they are about failing them? They should explain to us why the Road Fund Board has not been set up. Because they claim that that is the reason they have not paid contractors. So, all the moneys that are being released to that Fund— What are they doing?

They have an administrator? They have a secretariat? Have they initiated the necessary reforms that they spoke about, to check these double payments? Look, they do not come into government with this fanfare and say reset, and then come into the Chamber to sing. It is not about the songs they sing but about how much they deliver. Ghanaians would judge them by their performance. They should set up the Road Fund Board and pay contractors.

Mr Speaker enough of this. This Side of the House would not let them have business as usual. We would not just come, and then when they mention Estimates, we will just say that because the Report is here, we have approved it, so Mr Speaker should put the Question. The Speaker would only put the Question after we have ensured proper scrutiny.

These are figures that they cannot run away with or attempt to do their usual rebuttal and a rise of point of order. Because figures do not lie. Data cannot be turned upside down. It is in their own Budget document and they say we should approve this? Well, we have told them what to do. It is their duty to be gracious enough to do the needful. If they decide that they want the records to remain the way they are, so be it. They would carry the consequences and they would be solely responsible for their inefficiencies. *[Interruption]*

Let the private sector know, that this Government is putting impediment in their way by refusing to pay them as a result of the Road Fund Board that is not in place. If there is nothing like a Road Fund anymore, then that nomenclature that exists for the purpose of disbursing funds to road contractors must be put in place. There must be a Board. He came here to amend the law. They were sworn in on 7th January, 2025. Today, we are in 2nd December, 2025 and they cannot constitute a simple Board. All they care to do is to rush Parliament through a certificate of urgency, so that we do not scrutinise them.

Mr Speaker, I rest my case.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Chief Whip? Let me invite the Minister to—

Mr Dafeamekpor: Normally, the Minister would conclude.

Let me thank you for giving me opportunity to add my voice to the call that the House adopts the Report of the Committee on Roads and Transportation for the approval of the sum of GH¢5,378,458,359.00 for the work of the Ministry for 2026.

Mr Speaker, it is shocking that the then Majority Leader, 12 months ago, here, launched programmes, ones that he had long started and expended public money on before he launched them. Planting for Food and Jobs; One Village, One Dam; One District, One Factory; they were begun and public expenditures were spent on them before they were launched.

Today, they tell us that they are surprised that Big Push has expended money on projects that had begun earlier this year; they have not had them before. Because the launch was done in September, to them, the expenditure on those projects could only occur after September. What a logic.

Mr Speaker, first of all, they should be thanking this Government that we are continuing with road projects that they could not complete. We are also launching

massive road projects, including areas like Winneba and Effutu. Instead of thanking this Government that we are even running dual carriageways from Winneba roundabout towards Swedru— They would not praise Government for it. They are here talking about figures. The Reports emanated from the Committee. The Committee consists of Members from this Side and the other Side. So, it can never be true that this Budget and the Report was not properly interrogated. All the agencies appeared before the Committee.

3:00 p.m.

Mr Speaker, by all means, we can debate on the matter. But let us get the facts right. We should rather encourage the Ministry to ensure that the funds that have been allocated for its work are effectively applied by the contractors so that there are no delays. So that next year, we can ask for more allocation to the Ministry so they can do more. Mr Speaker, for instance, when the Accra-Kumasi expressway is done, the number of jobs it will generate and the kind of transformation it will bring to this economy will be massive. They would not praise the Government for all these things.

Mr Speaker, people are dying on the Accra-Winneba Road, one of the most dangerous roads and we are making efforts to have it rehabilitated and improved and one of the major beneficiaries along that highway and what is he saying?

Mr Speaker, I want to commend the Minister for Roads and Highways for ensuring that all these roads that hitherto were abandoned, he is committed and slated for major attention. I want to urge the House to adopt the Report so the Minister and his Ministry can implement the programmes properly outlined in the Report contained in Appendix A, attached to the Report and it is comprehensively outlined, so that next year when we come, we would praise him and ask that he does more.

Mr Speaker, with these words, I thank you for the opportunity.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, this is a House of records. The unnumbered page, Appendix A, which contains Big Push programme projects, Winneba-Takoradi, are projects that feasibility studies had long been done. The National Democratic Congress (NDC) came to meet the Winneba project ongoing.

Mr Speaker, in my early days in practice, one thing I learnt, which he also learnt, was to deal with issues. The issues that we raised from this Side of the House were very clear. They have provided for the Big Push but at the time they launched the Big Push to the time they said that these monies had been disbursed was just about one month.

Mr Speaker, our Friend must address this. The issue of one district, one dam, one this, one that, he should deal with the relevant issues. We have a situation

where we are dealing with a cut-and-paste Budget and cut-and-paste figures. He should address them. He should not say that the Winneba-Swedru Road is a new initiative. Please, it is not a new initiative.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you, Minority Leader.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: His Constituency received a lot of outboard motors during Akufo-Addo's administration as never seen before and he attested to that. He knows that as a fact. Why is he not addressing it? Please, they should stop this thing about we did not do it and all that. I am drawing his attention that his constituency benefited from a lot of projects, even under Akufo-Addo's administration. Hon Dafeamekpor's Constituency was not abandoned. Indeed, I am telling him that this initiative is not new, and he knows that.

Mr Speaker, I have addressed my point.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, thank you.

Yes, Hon Minister?

Minister for Roads and Highways (Mr Kwame Govers Agbodza): Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity to make my final comments on the Report from the Committee on Roads and Transportation on the Annual Estimates for the 2026 Budget for the Ministry. I also want to thank the

Members of the Committee and the entire House for all the support given us in the course of the year.

Mr Speaker, I want to put on record where we started from. During the transition, we inherited a project portfolio of GHC110 billion. In 2024 alone, GHC24 billion of projects were awarded, majority of them without any commencement authorisation from the Ministry of Finance. Talk about recklessness and I would not even have to make any comment about that.

Mr Speaker, we also inherited unpaid bills of over GHC60 billion, if we compare GoG, Road Fund, and COCOBOD. In fact, as a result, the COCOBOD road project has totally collapsed, and the reforms are being carried out currently as we speak. Ninety per cent or more of the contractors on our roads were not on site. They stopped work because they raised certificates and were not been paid for a long period of time hence, they stopped work. Famous among those projects that contractors have stopped working on was the Ofankor road which had regular demonstrations from members of the public, and rightly so, drawing the attention of the State. Interestingly, the demonstrators were not paid any attention until 2025.

Mr Speaker, it was very simple. The contractor was owed almost US\$80 million for works done and unpaid for. President Mahama directed, and that was the first contractor that was paid. Almost

GHC800 million was paid to that contractor, and that is why that contractor is back to site today. So, when the Minority Leader says that contractors are not being paid, I do not know whether he is talking about this country or somewhere else. This is because a contractor they could not pay, of which the most important alignment on road traffic in our country, the Accra-Kumasi Road, was abandoned and the contractor was not working. Today, that contractor is working, and we are very hopeful that project will be completed.

Mr Speaker, talking about prudence and other things, the Minority Leader and his party, if I want to remind them, paid US\$29 million for an Indian contractor as mobilisation to build a road between Savelugu and Walewale, and the contractor took the money and walked away freely. US\$29 million. I am very sure that amount of money can pay a number of contractors who we owe even today. So, if the Minority Leader wanted to help, he would have asked the contractor to go back to site and work according to the US\$29 million dollars. I am calling upon their Side, since they were the ones who brought that Indian contractor and wrote a contract and paid them the US\$29 million, I am encouraging them to join hands with us to retrieve our US\$29 million from that contractor. Because one of the most dangerous roads still in our country is the road between Savelugu and Walewale. It is still dangerous.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, hold on.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, before I sit down, I would agree. But I noticed that when my Colleagues on this Side were making presentation, in fact, even the Minority Leader was encouraging us to take a point of order. We did not because we wanted it to flow. But today, just because I am speaking, he did his part and left and another person wants to interrupt.

Mr Speaker, I will yield.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Tiah Kabiru Mahama?

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama (NPP — Walewale): Mr Speaker, thank you very much. I want to state that we are not doing this lightly. We believe that a House of records must speak to the records and the facts as they are.

If the Minister for Roads and Highways informed this House that arrears were in excess of GHC60 billion, when the Controller and Accountant General had given us a clear sense of the areas of around GHC40 billion, that has to go to records. As a statement, the Minister for Finance, came back to this House and updated his records.

Mr Speaker, as a matter of fact, in the 2025 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, that particular inflation of the arrears gave us a false sense of fiscal deficits on commitment basis. We raised it, so the records must speak to the actual

3:10 p.m.

Mr Speaker, the other issue is that we are raising an issue of mistakes on the face of the Budget. It is that mistake that we expected him to respond to, and not to do other engagements, because the mistakes are so clear that when the Budget is presented —

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, when my Colleague, who is a good Friend, got up, I thought, since I mentioned his Constituency, of which a contractor was paid US\$29 million, I thought he was about to help me get that money, but let me help him.

Mr Speaker, I have already told them that when I say things in this House, they can take me on and check the facts. At transitions, they reported that the Growth Fund owed US\$5 billion; today, it is US\$8 billion. So, which record are they talking about? I came here —

Mr Speaker, Mr Oppong Nkrumah said things that I do not agree with, yet I kept quiet. It is not his turn to get up and speak. *[Interruption]* He said some things, and I will come back to those things.

Mr Speaker, I said earlier, when I was making my comment on the policy part of the Statement that it is not unusual to have certain figures at transition, especially with the Ministry of Roads and Highways, and it is not a static figure. It keeps changing because contractors keep bringing in certificates

on a daily basis. So, even with the US\$8 billion I talked about today, I could get to the Ministry and it could be US\$9 billion; it is not a crime.

Mr Speaker, Dr Mahama's point is that he knew of a figure, and thought that figure was static. That is not how it works; the figures keep changing, and that is the fact.

Mr Speaker, since the Hon Minority Leader brought in the issue of prudence, let me remind him again. They paid US\$40 million to buy armoured vehicles. We did not even get a tricycle out of that — *[Interruption]*— they want me to say what will make them happy. I will tell them what their record is. They would listen to me, whether they like it or not.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, it is your Budget that we are approving—

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, they will listen to me the same way I listened to them.

Mr Speaker—*[Interruption]*

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, they will listen to you. What I am saying is, it is your budget that we are approving. So please, restrict yourself to the Budget. If there are other extraneous issues, we can take them later. For now, just respond to the basic issues that they have raised, and then we will approve your Budget and move on. We have a lot of Estimates to consider.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I am also a Member of this House, and I can debate the way I like. It is because he talked about recklessness. This is a Side, that though our Military did not have equipment, they paid US\$40 million to a company for armoured vehicles, yet we did not even get a tricycle out of it.

Mr Speaker, let me go back—
[Interruption]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, just restrict yourself to the Budget.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I also heard in the debate that some of my Colleagues argued —[Interruption]

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we had agreed that we would not interrupt the debates. If there are issues, they should note it down.

Mr Nkrumah — *rose* —

Mr Dafeamekpor: Is he on his feet on a point of order? [**Some Hon Members:** Yes] So, he should wait to catch the attention of the Speaker.

Mr Speaker, Mr Assafuah cannot sit there and throw his hands. He should not do that. Let us have some sanity.

Mr Speaker, all I am saying is that the debate has begun. The Hon Minister sat here quietly and listened to all the issues, whether truthful or not, he noted them down and is responding to the issues one after the other. So, if anyone has an issue,

they should note it down and then, when they have an opportunity, then they speak to it. Therefore, with this process of everybody standing on their feet to heckle him, we may not end the process today. So, I am pleading with them to allow him to conclude. This is not the end of the debate. There are a lot of reports to be taken, and issues can be raised.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, I beg of you, just focus on your budget. With these extraneous matters, you will just invite unnecessary attention. Please, restrict yourself, and let us conclude on that.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I will take your humble advice. I sat here quietly, and my Colleagues said things that I am about to respond to. In fact, we heard him asking us to take a point of order on him; we never did, for obvious reasons. So, if anyone has a contrary view, they are free to bring it up —

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, just focus on your Budget, and no other matters from other Ministries.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I have also heard my Colleagues talk about the kind of jobs that we are creating under the Big Push. There are certain professions in this country that do not have permanent jobs, and they move from job to job. I am an architect, and few architects get jobs that take them from the day of employment to retirement. So, if we say the Big Push will create 480,000 jobs, I also heard

somebody say 490,000 jobs, and then they said these are temporary jobs. Someone even said they were menial jobs.

Mr Speaker, we are creating jobs for Civil Engineers, Quantity Surveyors, Bankers, and other professionals. These are high-level professionals in our country. If we create 500,000 jobs for Civil Engineers and other professions for two years, who knows what will happen after the next two years? So, these are not just menial jobs.

Mr Speaker, let me give Hon Members an example, assuming the Big Push projects on site currently are GH¢68 billion, a bond on performance of one percent, which is what we are supposed to do, is GH¢600 million going to insurance companies already. It is a heavy investment in the economy. It is not merely building of roads. These are serious jobs that are being created across the spectrum of the country, and I want my Colleagues to pay attention to that. We are not only talking about the supply chain of raw materials and other things. They should not trivialise this. This is not a matter of creating menial jobs.

Mr Speaker, Colleagues have made some statements that I think are vital that we need to deal with. We have serious problems with abandoned projects, especially the ones we have approved in this House in terms of supplies, credit and other things, and many of them have stalled, creating very challenging situations. For instance, Dome Kitase is one of them. It is a very critical road that was

started under the previous government, unfortunately, by a curative fund, the debt situation means that the contractors are off-site. What have we done? President Mahama directed that since we are not too sure of the cost to complete, based on the loan agreement approved in this House, we put it under the Big Push project. Today, if you go to Dome Kitase, the contractor is back on-site and working. The motorway to Central University, Tranch 1 by DHM, is stalled; the contractor is not fully back on-site. The Tranch 2, which is supposed to be the main carriageway, is now under the Big Push, being done. First Sky Group is on-site currently, and that would also be completed. So, when Colleagues talk about the fact that we do have serious challenges, I agree with them, and I appreciate the support we get from the entire House.

Mr Speaker, let us come to the issue about the allocation in the 2026 Budget and then the expenditure. Even in the case of supply — where one can just say I want a car, and get the car, so one should be paid; road projects or works-related projects are not like that. We started a journey on the Big Push more than eight months ago, with feasibility studies, costing and then the tendering process. I reported in this House that there are Big Push contractors who have done 30 per cent of the work already.

3:20 p.m.

With the ceremonial inauguration of a project, it was President Mahama who

decided that instead of contractors moving to site for him to do inauguration on the day the contractor brought an excavator to site, contractors must show commitment and be on site and be working. So, what we saw in September was not the beginning of Big Push project. The Big Push project has been in progress all along. So, they should not mistake with the fact that a date in September was the beginning of the Big Push project; that is not the case.

They talked about the allocation that has been made and how we are going to spend it. The Big Push contractors are currently preparing certificates and for the volume of work they are doing, GH¢13 billion might sound like a lot of money and it is indeed a lot of money. But the size of the projects they are doing — some projects are in excess of GH¢2 billion. If we were dealing with, maybe, buying of items and selling, it would be a different matter, because their certificates are heavy. So, they should not be surprised that the GH¢13 billion they are talking about, that it is money not spent according to them, by 31st December this year, that money might not be there as GH¢13 billion. The true picture of how the GH¢13 billion was allocated and spent can only be apparent in the Mid-Year Budget Review in 2026, and nobody is going anywhere. God willing, we will all be here and they would see those details. So, they should not worry about that. Indeed, that money, as far as I am concerned, is not that much in terms of the size of things we are doing.

The GH¢30 billion is not a licence to go and award new projects. If we have GH¢60 billion worth of projects on site and we have allocated GH¢13 billion, it is a fraction of the value of the project on site alone. So, even if we add the two, we have not even finished paying for the first phase of the Big Push projects we are embarking on. So, they should not misconstrue that.

Then thirdly, indeed, I agree with Colleagues, the GH¢5 billion that has been allocated is not enough. Though it may sound like one of the biggest allocations, it is not enough at all. I already said that we have GH¢110 billion worth of projects already on site. So even if we allocate GH¢5 billion, it is just a tiny fraction of what we will be able to pay.

Mr Speaker, indeed, we owe a lot of money. Contractors have been paid. By the last check — and I am saying this cautiously because the real figure will come out in the Mid-Year Budget Review — contractors have been paid already close to GH¢6 billion based on arrears, not Big Push. On what the Minority Leader talked about, which is the money allocated for a Road Maintenance Trust Fund, it is out of prudence that we decided to do the right thing. Indeed, when the Auditor-General carried out validation of the certificates we came to meet, they discounted many of them. We saw a situation where one certificate was almost recycled between Road Fund and Government of Ghana. It is just important that we do these things.

So, as we speak, this week will be the end of the validation of the Road Fund certificate. The projection is that before the end of this month, the allocation made to Road Fund under the 2025 Budget will be disbursed to road contractors. So, Mr Speaker, there is no mixed presentation in terms of those things.

I heard somebody say that some of the projects were already on site. Mr Speaker, as a matter of fact, the interchange at Winneba roundabout, which is now Winneba Interchange, was not part of it. But guess what? That project is ongoing. The project between Winneba and Mankessim is a new project, and the contractor is currently on site if we use that alignment we see.

Mr Speaker, despite all the politics, I am very grateful to Colleagues for all the support they have given my Ministry in the pursuit of improving the road network wherever we live. Every Member of this House is under pressure to improve the road network in their area. And as long as we have the resources, we are committed to making sure that at least, the time in which we are in that Ministry, we will make sure the road network in the country improves. I want to take the opportunity to encourage Colleagues to support this allocation so that we can carry out the necessary works to improve the roads in the country. Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

Mr Nkrumah — rose —

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Kojo Oppong Nkrumah, I beg of you. I will put the Question—

Mr Nkrumah: I beg of you, Mr Speaker. He mentioned my name.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: No, he was just addressing issues. Hon Nkrumah, I beg of you.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House approved the sum of GHC5,378,458,359.00 for the services of the Ministry of Roads and Highways for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Let me acknowledge our guests at the Public Gallery before we come to the nursery.

So, we have Zion ‘A’ and ‘B’ Civic Education Club. They are being led by Sena Bosson who is the leader, and from the National Commission for Civic Education (NCCE), and they are coming from the Effutu Constituency. That is the Minority Leader’s constituency.

[Pupils from the Zion ‘A’ and ‘B’ Civic Education Club were acknowledged.]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: The second one is Unipra North J.H.S. They are also being led by the same person, Sena Bosson, who is the leader, and the school is also from Winneba. You are welcome.

[Pupils from Unipra North J.H.S. were acknowledged.]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Amankwah Manu?

Mr Kofi Amankwah-Manu: Thank you for the opportunity to correct an impression created by the Hon Minister for Roads and Highways, that some amount of money in the sum of US\$40 million was paid, for which this country received nothing with regard to the purchase of APCs by the Ministry of Defence. Mr Speaker, that is erroneous.

First of all, every purchase is guided by contract. I would want to know from the Hon Minister whether he has read the contract for the purchase of those APCs. The contract was such that we were supposed to pay a certain amount of money before the APCs will be given to this country – about 19 of them. Yes, we paid the US\$40 million, but we did not finish paying the money. So, until we finish paying the money, we will not be given the 19 APCs.

So, to create the impression as if we sat and folded our arms and not do anything for even *aboboyaa* to be given to this country is very wrong and palpable falsehood. I believe this House is a House of records, so the records must capture the right thing.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Let us make progress. Yes, Leader, let me hear you.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may I pray that we take the Motion numbered 3 on the *Order Paper Addendum*.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. Do we have the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources here?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: The Minister is not here; I cannot see the Minister.

3:30 p.m.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I called the Minister, but he is in a meeting that he cannot leave.

He asked the Deputy to come so that we can take the Report, then she can note down the issues and also respond to matters arising from the Report. The Deputy is here, so let me pray that the Deputy Minister does this on his behalf.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, that does not find favour with us. We are totally opposed. Yes, the Deputy Minister is one of our own, but this is the Budget of the Minister. We are opposed because of the reasons he premised his application, “he is in a meeting, somewhere engaged”, and the Minister does not consider his Budget as important, as coming to engage with Parliament. We cannot accept this. It is totally unacceptable.

In any case, the Minister for Transport is ready. If the Minister for Works and Housing is not ready, the Minister for Transport is ready. The

Minister for Transport knows the importance of his Budget being passed; that is why he is here. Minister for Transport is here; Minister for Roads and Highways; why is the Minister for Works and Housing not here? Majority Chief Whip, go and find him; the Deputy Minister can stand in his stead. Move out of the Chamber, and call the Minister. He thinks we are going to treat him with kid gloves? Go and bring your Ministers.

Mr Speaker, that would not be acceptable to us. What is he going to say?

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: He is going to beg you.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I do not know why my brother, the Minority Chief Whip, my alter ego on the other Side, likes to litigate this matter. Mr Speaker, under article 295(1) of the 1992 Constitution states: “‘Minister’ means a Minister appointed under article 78 or 256 of this Constitution”. Technically speaking, a Deputy — in fact, that is why they are called Deputy Ministers, they deputise for their substantive. So, for purposes of this matter, the Deputy is qualified enough within the meaning of the 1992 Constitution to step in for the boss and listen to matters that arise.

I am pleading with my brother, Frank; that is his sister, so allow her to do her duty so we do this.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Mr Dafeamekpor, we would share with you,

but the reason you assigned for the Minister’s absence, for me, was also not —

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, it is not as if I did not speak with the Minister. He is in such a situation that if we want to abide by his coming, then we may not be able to take the Report at all. That is why he detailed the Deputy to come here. My Brother, Frank, we would do the needful. I appreciate your cooperation, and the level at which you are cooperating with us is noted. So, we would do the needful.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well, I know Mr Annoh-Dompreh has agreed.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I have to consult my king-makers. Let us finish with the Ministry of Transport while we are consulting. Mrs Gizella A. Tetteh-Agbotui is a Friend. Mr Speaker, let it go on record that when it is difficult, we compromise. I hope when it matters, they would also compromise for us. Mrs Tetteh-Agbotui, there is a very popular bridge at Ofoase Ayirebi, Okaikwei, Nsawam/Adoagyiri zongo, take notice. Mr Speaker, and your good self, there are a number of bridges in your Constituency. So, hesitantly, we would allow her to do it, but she should be brief.

Mr Dafeamekpor: On that note of hesitation, thank you.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well, Hon Deputy Minister, you may do us the honours.

ANNUAL ESTIMATES, 2026

MINISTRY OF WORKS, HOUSING AND WATER RESOURCES

Deputy Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources (Mrs Gizella A. Tetteh-Agbotui) (MP): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That this Honourable House approves the sum of GH¢1,460,906,354.00 for the services of the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Vincent Oppong Asamoah): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion, and in so doing, present your Committee's Report.

Introduction

The Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, presented the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the 2026 Financial year to Parliament on Thursday, 13th November, 2025, in accordance with article 179 of the 1992 Constitution and Section 21(3) of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921).

The Rt Hon Speaker referred the 2026 Estimates of the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources to the joint Committee on Works and Housing and Sanitation and Water Resources for consideration and report,

in accordance with Orders 242 and 259 of the Standing Orders of the House.

To examine the referral, the Committee met with the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources, Hon Kenneth Gilbert Adjei, the Deputy Minister, Gizella Tetteh-Agbotui and officials of the Ministries of Works, Housing and Water Resources and Finance as well as Agencies under the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources and hereby submits this report in accordance with Order 215 of the Standing Orders of the House.

The Committee expresses its heartfelt gratitude to the Minister and the other officials for their assistance.

Reference Documents

The Committee was guided by the following documents, reports, and other relevant materials in its deliberations:

- a. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;
- b. The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana; Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921);
- c. National Medium-Term Development Policy Framework (NMTDPF) in achieving Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) for 2024 – 2027;

- d. Medium Term Expenditure Framework (MTEF) for 2024 – 2027;
- e. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 financial year; and
- f. The Report of the Committee on Works and Housing on the Annual Estimates of the Ministry of Works and Housing for the 2023 financial year.

Core Mandate

In line with Sections 11 and 13 of the Civil Service Act of 1993 (PNDCL 327) and by Executive Instrument (E.I) 1, 2025, the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources is mandated to initiate and formulate policies for the Works, Housing and Water sectors of the economy, as well as coordinate, monitor and evaluate the implementation of plans, programmes, and performance of the sector for national development.

Vision

The Ministry's vision is to ensure sustainable development and management of Public Works, Housing and Water Resources for all.

Goal

In pursuit of its core mandate and vision the Ministry set out three (3) broad sectoral goals in line with its realigned mandate:

- i. To sustainably manage available resources to improve access to safe, secure, decent, and affordable housing to reduce the high housing deficit;
- ii. To ensure the sustainable development of infrastructure facilities in the area of flood control systems, drainage, coastal protection works, and operational hydrology; and
- iii. To contribute to improvement in the living standards of Ghanaians through increased access to, and use of safe water and sustainable management of water resources.

Core Functions

As the state agency mandated to improve access to affordable housing, development of infrastructure for flood control systems, drainage management, coastal protection, increase access to safe water and sustainable management of water resources, the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources is mandated to undertake the following functions.

- i. Initiate and formulate works, housing and water policies considering the needs and aspirations of people;
- ii. Collaborate with Ministries, Departments and Agencies (MDA's) to effectively disseminate information about government policies, programmes and activities

of the works, housing and water resources sector;

- iii. Coordinate, monitor and evaluate the efficiency and effectiveness of the performance of the sector;
- iv. Develop appropriate regulations to stimulate competition in the sector;
- v. Develop policies to build capacity for the sector;
- vi. Create an enabling environment to support government business and public-private partnerships within the sector;
- vii. Promote innovation, research and development, training, and investment in the sector;
- viii. Support creative and innovative research in the production and use of local building materials;
- ix. Promote optimum peaceful co-existence of Landlords and Tenants through education and reconciliation; and
- x. Monitor and evaluate the implementation of policies and the performance of the sector.

- i. Public Works Department (PWD);
- ii. Ghana Hydrological Authority (GHA);
- iii. Engineering Council (EC);
- iv. Architectural and Engineering Services Limited (AESL);
- v. Rent Control Department (RCD);
- vi. Department of Rural Housing (DRH);
- vii. Public Servant Housing Loan Scheme Board (PSHLSB);
- viii. State Housing Company (SHC);
- ix. TDC Ghana Limited (TGL);
- x. Architect Registration Council (ARC);
- xi. Real Estate Agency Council (REAC);
- xii. Water Resources Commission (WRC); and
- xiii. Community Water and Sanitation Agency (CWSA).

Agencies Under the Ministry

To effectively execute its mandate, the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources achieves its mandate through the under-listed Agencies.

2025 Performance Review

The Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources during the year under review undertook the following activities in pursuit of its mission and vision to create a sustainable public housing and works sector, and to ensure that Ghanaians have safe, decent, and affordable housing:

Operational Performance

As at the end of October, 2025, the Ministry among others achieved the following:

1. Continued work on 10,000 affordable housing units across Greater Accra, Ashanti, and Northern Regions under the Revised National Affordable Housing Programme.
2. Completed the redesign and completion of the Saglemi Affordable Housing Project through a public-private partnership model.
3. To promote inclusive access, the Rent-to-Own Scheme was expanded, benefiting over 3,500 low and middle-income earners;
4. The Coastal Protection Works programme continued in all ten coastal districts, reducing erosion and flood risks. The Aboadze-Shama, Dansoman, and Anlo Beach projects are at varying stages of completion, with overall progress at 67 percent;
5. Drainage interventions were implemented in flood-prone areas, including Kaneshie, Sakaman, and Adabraka;
6. Over 40 kilometres of primary and secondary drains were desilted, benefitting 2.5 million residents;
7. The Greater Accra Resilient and Integrated Development (GARID) Project continued drain works in Odaw Basin communities, with the Akweteyman and Alajo drains now at 62 percent completion;
8. Increased national rural water coverage to 78 percent, and urban water supply stood at 93 percent by end of September 2025;
9. Through the Community Water and Sanitation Agency, 410 new boreholes were drilled, and 37 small-town water systems completed.
10. The Ghana Water Company Limited produced 351 million gallons of water per day nationwide, supported by rehabilitation of the Kpong and Weija Treatment Plants; and
11. Under the National Sanitation Campaign, 24,000 household toilets were constructed, reducing open defecation in beneficiary districts by 12 percent.

Financial Performance for 2025

The Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources was appropriated an amount of nine hundred and eighteen million, ninety-three thousand, one hundred and forty-eight Ghana Cedis (GH¢918,093,148.00) for the implementation of its activities in the 2025 financial year.

Out of this allocation, seven hundred and twenty-seven million, one hundred and eight thousand and fifteen Ghana cedis (GH¢727,108,015.00) was from the Government of Ghana (GoG) sources, one hundred and twenty-seven million, nine hundred and fifty-five thousand Ghana cedis (GH¢127,955,000) from Foreign Loans and Grants (FLG), and sixty-three million, thirty thousand, one hundred and thirty-three Ghana Cedis (GH¢63,030,133.00) is from Internally Generated Funds (IGF). The allocation was disbursed among the three cost centers of the Ministry as follows:

Compensation	-	GH¢67,363,021.00
Goods and Services	-	GH¢60,071,099.00
Capital Expenditure	-	GH¢790,659,028.00
Total	-	GH¢918,093,148.00

The 2025 allocation was disbursed among the departments and agencies under the Ministry as follows:

Table 1: 2025 Budget Allocation by Department and Agencies

S/N	Cost Center	2025 Allocation (GH¢)
1	Ministry of Works& Housing (Headquarters)	387,876,023
2	Architect Registration Council	15,966,280
3	Department of Rural Housing	36,554,354
4	Engineering Council	2,783,446
5	Ghana Hydrological Authority	5,248,789
6	Public Servants Housing Loans Scheme Board	5,887,255
7	Public Works Department	319,450,910
8	Rent Control Department	1,385,920
9	Real Estate Agency Council	1,735,843
10	Community Water and Sanitation Agency	57,850,181
11	Water Resources Commission	83,354,147
TOTAL		918,093,148

At the end of 31st October, 2025, a sum of GH¢360,262,939 representing 36.41 per cent of the total Appropriation was released to the Ministry for its operations, leaving a balance of GH¢557,830,209. The 2025 cost center budget performance of the Ministry is presented in the table 2:

Table 2: 2025 cost center Budget Performance of the Works and Housing Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources

Economic Classification	2025 Allocation (A) (GH¢)	2025 Releases as 30/10/2025 (B) (GH¢)	Actual Expenditure 31/10/2025 (C) (GH¢)	Variance (A-B) (GH¢)	% Released
Compensation of employees	67,363,021	52,136,788	52,136,799	15,226,233	77.39
Good and Service	60,071,099	50,970,855	50,970,855	34,926,748	41.86
Capital Expenditure	790,659,028	257,155,296	191,077,811	533,632,928	32.51
Total	918,093,148	360,262,393	294,184,454	583,785,909	36.41

Source: Presentation on the Budget Estimate of the Ministry

An amount of GH¢211,177,706 has been released from the GoG allocation of GH¢727,108,015 as of October, 2025. The release was disbursed in furtherance of the objectives of the Ministry. Details of the GoG budget performance is as follows:

Table 2: 2025 GoG Budget releases as at October, 2025

Economic Classification	2025 Allocation (A) (GH¢)	2025 Releases (B) (GH¢)	Actual Expenditure (GH¢)	Variance (A-B) (GH¢)	% Released
Compensation of employees	67,363,021	52,136,788	52,136,799	15,226,233	77.39
Good and Services	8,244,994	3,423,094	3,423,094	4,821,900	41.52
Capital Expenditure	651,500,000	155,617,824	89,540,339	495,882,176	23.88
Total	727,108,015	211,177,706	145,100,232	515,930,309	29.04

Source: Ministry Presentation on the 2026 Budget Estimates

In 2025, the Ministry and its Agencies were programmed to collect total revenue of GH¢90,125,400 and retain the sum of GH¢63,030,133 to support their activities. As at October, 2025 a total of GH¢99,535,966.82

representing 110.4 per cent has been collected. The details of the IGF projections and actual collections by the Ministry and its Agencies is presented in table 3:

Table 3: 2025 IGF projections and actual collections

S/N	Cost Center	Planned Collection (GH¢)	Actual Collection (GH¢)	% Collection
1	Ministry of Works& Housing (Headquarters)	4,224,910	5,364,870	126.98
2	Architect Registration Council	888,300	791,989	89.19
3	Department of Rural Housing	57,270	-	0.00
4	Engineering Council	312,000	226,100	72.47
5	Ghana Hydrological Authority	117,000	80,241	68.58
6	Public Servants Housing Loans Scheme Board	850,000	219,372	25.81
7	Public Works Department	624,030	766,896.36	122.89
8	Rent Control Department	450,000	460,196.58	102.27
9	Real Estate Agency Council	51,300	292,800.67	570.76
10	Community Water and Sanitation Agency	58,107,690	61,379,191	105.63
11	Water Resources Commission	24,442,900	29,954,310	122.55
TOTAL		90,125,400	99,535,967	110.44

The Ministry and its Agencies were appropriated a total amount of GH¢63,030,133 as IGF retention in 2025 fiscal year. The 2025 IGF allocation was disbursed to finance the capital expenditure and operational needs of the Ministry and its Agencies. Details of the 2025 IGF expenditure returns is as follows:

Table 4: 2025 IGF Budget releases as at the end of October, 2025

Economic Classification	2025 Allocation (A) (GH¢)	2025 IGF Retention (B) (GH¢)	Actual Expenditure (GH¢)	Variance (A-B) (GH¢)	% Released
Good and Service	49,381,105	21,721,257	21,721,257	27,659,848	43.99
Capital Expenditure	13,649,028	6,573,360	6,573,360	7,075,668	48.16
Total	63,030,133	28,294,617	28,294,617	34,735,516	44.89

In pursuit of its objectives for the 2025 financial year, an amount of GH¢127,955,000 was allocated from Foreign Loans and Grants (FLG) to support the Goods and Services, and

Capital Expenditure needs of the Ministry. As of October 2025, a total of GH¢94,834,916 (74.12 per cent) was released to finance the capital expenditure programs of the Ministry.

Outlook for 2026

In the 2026 fiscal year, the Ministry intends to continue with the implementation of activities aimed at delivering on its core mandate of providing adequate, safe, secure, quality, and affordable housing to stimulate economic growth, create jobs and to promote social equity. Specifically, the Ministry intends to implement, among others, the following activities:

1. Complete the first phase of the Saglemi Affordable Housing Project by delivering a total of 8,000 units by the end of 2026;
2. Scale up the Rent-to-Own scheme to cover 10,000 additional beneficiaries through the introduction of a new digital application systems to ensure transparency;
3. The Ministry will commence work on the District Housing scheme to decentralise housing development and address the national housing deficit by building affordable homes across the districts;
4. Continue work on the Akosombo Dam spillage resettlement program aimed at constructing 2,225 decent housing units for Akosombo Dam spillage victims;
5. Continue the Construction of storm drains, sand traps, bridges and detention ponds under the GARID project;
6. Continue work on the Sekondi-Takoradi, Wenchi, Keta and Sunyani Water Supply Projects, targeting an additional 1.2 million beneficiaries and Commence work on the Tamale water supply expansion project;
7. Complete work and submit the reviewed Rent Act, the Rent Control Law and develop legislative Instrument to operationalise the Real Estate Agency Act, 2020 (Act 1047);
8. The Ministry will also complete work on the Damango, Bawku, and Yendi water systems to ensure the supply of potable water to these communities; and
9. Commence work on emergency water supply system for 10 districts in the Central Region.

Budgetary Allocation for 2026

An amount of one billion, four hundred and sixty million, nine hundred and six thousand, three hundred and fifty-four Ghana cedis (GHC1,460,906,354.00) has been allocated to the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources for the implementation of its activities in the 2026 financial year. Out of this allocation, nine hundred and forty-three million, three hundred and eight thousand, one hundred and seventy-one Ghana cedis (GHC943,308,171.00) is from Government of Ghana (GoG) sources, four hundred and nine million,

three hundred and seventy-nine thousand, seven hundred and sixty Ghana cedis (GHC409,379,760.00) from Foreign Loans and Grants (FLG), and one hundred and eight million, two hundred and eighteen

thousand, four hundred and twenty-three Ghana cedis (GHC108,218,423.00) is expected to be received from Internally Generated Funds (IGF).

The 2025 allocation will be disbursed among the three main economic classifications as follows:

Table 5: 2026 allocation to the Ministry of Work, Housing and Water Resources by Economic classification

Expenditure Item	GoG Allocation (GHC)	Foreign Funds Allocation (GHC)		IGF Allocation (GHC)	Total (GHC)
		Loans	Grants		
Compensation of Employees	73,563,177	-	-	-	73,563,177
Goods and Services	8,244,994	8,038,500	32,581,800	81,384,677	130,249,971
Capex	861,500,000	165,600,000	203,159,460	26,833,746	1,257,093,206
Total	943,308,171	173,638,500	235,741,260	108,218,423	1,460,906,354

The 2026 allocation to the Ministry will be disbursed among the four programs of the Ministry as follows:

Management and administration	-	GHC204,912,766
Water Management	-	GHC422,125,827
Human Settlement and Development	-	GHC208,785,591
Infrastructure Management	-	GHC625,082,170
Total	-	GHC1,460,906,354

The 2026 allocation to the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources will be disbursed among the Agencies of the Ministry as follow:

Table 6: 2026 Allocation by Cost Center

S/N	Cost Center	2026 Allocation (GHC)	% of Total Allocation
1	Ministry of Works & Housing (Headquarters)	946,134,348	64.76
2	Architect Registration Council	2,897,478	0.19
3	Department of Rural Housing	3,747,996	0.26
4	Engineering Council	1,954,414	0.13
5	Ghana Hydrological Authority	272,083,891	18.62
6	Public Servants Housing Loans Scheme Board	4,167,951	0.29
7	Public Works Department	24,778,782	1.71
8	Rent Control Department	18,208,341	1.25
9	Real Estate Agency Council	1,644,921	0.11
10	Community Water and Sanitation Agency	139,227,001	9.53
11	Water Resources Commission	46,061,233	3.15
TOTAL		1,460,906,356	100

Committee Observations and Recommendations

The Committee, having carefully examined the 2026 estimates of the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water resources made the following observations:

Non-release of 2025 Allocation

The Committee noted that funds appropriated by Parliament to finance the operations and activities of the Ministry and its agencies were not disbursed, leading to operational difficulties and hindering progress on a number of planned activities of the

Ministry. As of October 2025, only GHC360,262,393, representing 39.24 per cent of the 2025 appropriation of GHC918,093,148 was released to the Ministry and its agencies. Officials of the Ministry explained that the non-release of the capital expenditure allocation heavily impacted the ability of the Ministry to implement critical capital projects programmed for 2025. They added that in addition to the releases, the Ministry has obtained Commitment Authorisation for the release of an amount of GHC375,022,619.76 to finance some critical projects in the 2025 Budget. The Commitment Authorisation is in respect of the following projects:

a) Capital projects in the Headquarters and Agencies	-	GHC60,294,653
b) Phase 2 of the Blekusu Coastal Protection Project	-	GHC200,000,000
c) Implementation of the District Housing Programme	-	GHC61,978,604.80
d) Rehabilitation of Damako-Kpasa Water Systems	-	GHC37,086,644.96
e) Reconstruction of Water Systems for Anyako and Seva	-	GHC9,962,717
f) Public Servants Housing Loan Fund	-	GHC3,000,000
Total	-	GHC375,022,619.76

Officials from the Ministry of Finance attributed the non-release to administrative delays on the part of Ministries, Departments and Agencies due to the enforcement of the Commitment Authorisation regime by the Ministry of Finance. They assured the Committee that, all the bottlenecks have been addressed and MDAs would speed up the process of seeking authorisation for their investment activities once they become familiar with the process.

The Committee urged the Ministry of Finance to ensure the release of the committed funds to finance critical projects including the Blekusu Coastal Protection Project to protect communities, safeguard ecosystem from coastal erosion and flooding, expand access to potable water and provide affordable housing to Ghanaians.

Rent Control

The Committee noted that an amount of GHC18,208,341 has been allocated to

the Rent Control Office for the implementation of its activities for the 2026 financial year. The amount will be expended on a number of activities, including the review of the Rent Act 1960 (Act220) and the Rent Control Law, 1986 (PNDCL 138). The Committee expressed its displeasure at the inability of the Rent Control Department to regulate the rental space, resulting in the exploitation of both tenants and landlords. The lack of enforcement of existing rental laws has left the rental space largely unregulated, leading to the widespread charging of illegal rent advance by many property owners and the incapacitation of many landlords from repossessing their properties from recalcitrant tenants. The Committee expressed optimism that the review of the legal regime will properly empower the Rent Control Department to enforce the rent laws and make it more responsive to the realities of the rent market.

The Ministry attributed the challenges in the rental market partly to the under

supply of housing units which resulted in demand outstripping supply thereby pushing up prices and provides limited options for prospective home seekers. The Ministry is hopeful that the successful roll out of Governments housing programmes including the District Housing Scheme, expansion of affordable housing and other housing schemes will increase access to affordable housing and reduce pressure on private rental properties.

The Committee urged the Ministry to accelerate its Affordable and District Housing programmes to provide public housing across the country. The Committee further urged the Ministry to ensure that the revised legislation strengthens enforcement and protect the interest of tenants without compromising the need to make the rental market attractive to private investors.

Affordable Housing Development

The Committee expressed dissatisfaction at the slow progress of ongoing government intervention to supply housing across the country. The progress on a number of government housing schemes remains slow, with several Government-led housing projects still at various stages of completion, some of which have stalled for years. The Committee noted that the challenge is largely as a result of funding limitation and lack of clear policy framework for state housing programmes. Other challenges include high infrastructure servicing costs and difficulties in securing litigation-free land.

Officials of the Ministry informed the Committee that, the Ministry intends to speed up public housing delivery through Public Private Partnerships (PPPs) to attract more capital into the space. He informed the Committee that progress is however slow due to regulatory bottlenecks, lack of enabling infrastructure, and prolonged negotiations with private developers. As a result, the nation's housing deficit remains significant, and the supply of affordable units continues to lag behind rapidly increasing demand.

The Committee urged the Ministry to collaborate with the private sector for the delivery of housing units across the country.

The Committee recommended that the Ministry prioritises the completion of existing affordable housing projects before undertaking new ones and urged the Ministry to streamline its PPP processes by developing clearer risk-sharing frameworks, standardised contracts, and expedited land acquisition mechanisms to reduce the housing units delivered under these Agreements.

Increasing Menace of Unoccupied Housing Units

The Committee expressed deep concern over the acute shortage of low-end rental units in the midst of rapidly increasing number of unoccupied luxury housing units across the country, particularly urban areas. The Committee observed that the rental charges for many of these high-end apartments remain far beyond the reach of the average

Ghanaian. As a result, a significant proportion of these units remain vacant, even as construction activity continues to intensify nationwide.

The Committee noted that the paradox of rising construction amid widening housing deficit is largely attributable to inadequate regulation of the housing sector. In the absence of strong policy direction and regulatory mechanisms, developers continue to prioritise high-end housing that yields higher returns but provides little value in addressing Ghana's core housing needs.

The Committee further cautioned that this growing stock of unoccupied properties has, in recent times, attracted negative public discourse. Concerns have emerged regarding the potential use of such properties as safe havens for illicit financial flows, including corruption proceeds, money laundering activities, and speculative investments by segments of the diaspora community. The Committee underscored the urgent need to reverse this trend before it deteriorates into a systemic national risk.

To address the challenge, the Committee urged the Ministry to leverage the Government's Rent Assistance Scheme, which is currently making positive strides in supporting citizens to access some of the unoccupied rental units. A structured partnership between the Scheme and property developers, particularly those controlling large stocks of unoccupied units, could create a guaranteed rental market to incentivise developers to

refocus efforts on the development of low-cost properties and property owners to adjust rental prices to improve affordability.

With such market assurance, the Committee is confident that developers would be more inclined to make reasonable concessions on pricing, thereby making their units more accessible to ordinary rent-seekers.

Overall, the Committee maintained that a well-coordinated, market-sensitive regulatory framework backed by strong enforcement will be critical to curbing this growing menace and aligning private sector investments with the nation's broader housing objectives.

Slow Progress of Resettlement Housing for Akosombo Dam Spillage Victims

The Committee expressed grave concern about the slow progress of construction of the resettlement housing units for victims of the Akosombo Dam spillage. The Committee observed that construction works were only marginally above foundation level, despite the prolonged displacement of affected communities. The Ministry explained that delays in land acquisition and compensation processes accounted for the slow progress.

The Committee urged the Ministry to fast-track the construction and completion of the housing units, noting that the victims have been in a state of uncertainty for an unacceptably long period.

Drainage Systems and Flood Control

The Committee observed that urban flooding remains a major national challenge, with many communities experiencing recurrent flooding due to inadequate drainage systems, silted channels, poor solid waste management practices, and uncontrolled development along waterways. It also noted that budget allocations to the Ghana Hydrological Authority, the state agency responsible for flood control and drainage infrastructure, remain limited relative to the scale of the national flooding problem. Several drainage projects initiated in previous years are ongoing, but progress remains slow.

Given the magnitude of investment required to address stormwater challenges in the major cities the Committee recommended a significant scale-up in funding for drainage improvement and flood control infrastructure in flood prone areas in major urban centers. The Ghana Hydrological Authority should be resourced to undertake systematic desilting of major drains and construct new engineered stormwater systems in high-risk communities.

Water Supply Infrastructure and Service Delivery

The Committee noted that while the Ministry has made progress in expanding potable water coverage, access gaps remain particularly acute in rural and peri-urban communities. Key water supply projects across the country are

progressing slowly due to funding delays, foreign exchange constraints, and procurement bottlenecks. Additionally, the Ghana Water Company Limited continues to grapple with high non-revenue water (NRW) levels, primarily due to aged infrastructure, leakages, illegal connections, and inadequate metering systems. These inefficiencies undermine revenue mobilisation and the sustainability of the water supply system.

The Committee noted that an amount of GHC48,900,000 has been allocated under development partners fund to support a number of water system expansion projects. Officials from the Ministry informed the Committee that the allocation will be expended to expand water supply system in Damango, Tamale and Yendi and emergency water supply systems for 10 districts in the Central Region. The Committee noted that the allocation is hugely insignificant in view of the fact that, an amount of US\$1.7 billion is required to achieve universal access to water, sanitation and hygiene in Ghana.

The Ministry while admitting the need for additional investment in the water sector explained that, the allocation will be complimented by ongoing investments by the Ghana Water Company and the Community Water and Sanitation Agency as well as capital investment programmes of the Ghana Water Company.

The Committee recommended that the Ministry scale up support to rural water systems through the CWSA,

focusing on underserved communities to accelerate universal access to water, sanitation and hygiene services.

Conclusion and Recommendation

In view of the critical role of the Ministry in protecting the countries coastlines, drainage management, improving access to potable water and providing decent housing for Ghanaians, the Committee by unanimous decision recommends to the House to adopt its report and approve the sum of one billion, four hundred and sixty million, nine hundred and six thousand, three hundred and fifty-four Ghana Cedis (GH¢1,460,906,354.00) for the programmes and activities of the Ministry of Works, Housing, and Water Resources for the 2026 financial year.

Question proposed.

3:40 p.m.

Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah (NPP — Ofoase Ayirebi): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity. I would like to associate myself with the sentiments already expressed and to commend the Ministry for the work that they are doing. In particular, it is heartwarming to see that progress is being made in the housing sector. A number of major housing projects were commenced by the Ministry, but because of financial constraints, progress was not as was expected. So, we are happy to see that some allocations are being made. My prayer to the Ministry of Finance will be

that they release, not just what is on paper, but they actually release the allocation so that the Ministry can go forward to implement this. When housing projects are being executed, it has a way of transforming communities, giving beneficiaries access to wealth creation, among others, and so we would like to support and encourage that the money be released.

Except, Mr Speaker, to speak to two specific things. The Report on page 5, under paragraph 7.1, item number 2, as it purports to list the achievements of the Ministry says, and I quote:

“As at the end of October 2025, the Ministry, among others, achieved the following:

2. Completed the redesign and completion of the Saglemi Affordable Housing Project through a public-private partnership model”

Mr Speaker, I do not think that is accurate because that project has not been completed. Maybe the redesign has been completed, but the actual project itself has not been completed. This is a House of records, and it is important that the records reflect.

Mr Speaker, you would recall, and as the House would recall, I was Minister for Works and Housing at the time. It was during that period that we worked out a public-private partnership to complete the project. Because, as will be recalled, there was a requirement for

about US\$100 million to finish that project, because it lacked electricity, water, and a sewage system. And the weight on the treasury to fund it was delaying it. And so, we put together this public-private partnership, which was to ensure that the private entity would get funding on his own books and be able to complete it. So, they may have proceeded to complete the redesign and made progress on it, but it has not been completed, and the House should not record that it has been completed. Especially, on page 9, where it records among the outlook for 2026 the fact that they expect to now complete the first phase of the Saglemi Affordable Housing Project by delivering a total of 8,000 units by the end of 2026. It will be recalled that the private developer, at the time we signed the Public-Private Partnership (PPP) agreement, mentioned some 400-plus days to be used in completion. So, it is important that that is corrected.

A second matter I would like to speak to, Mr Speaker, is the District Housing Scheme. The District Housing Scheme, again, was launched in 2024, during the period when I happened to be Minister for Works and Housing. It is a very important intervention in the housing ecosystem, because what it does is that it ensures that affordable housing of a certain level, is made available in the districts. It creates jobs, it helps technology transfer, and it also ensures that even people who want to acquire assets in these districts can find these assets to acquire. It also will contribute to a reduction in the rural-urban

migration as more development takes place there. So, it is a very important project. I am happy to see that allocations have been made to continue it. My prayer will be that it is not just, like they say in Nigeria, “audio money”, money on paper, but money will actually be released so that work will be done.

Mr Speaker, since I have the floor, if you permit me, I will not engage in any mischief. This is a House of record. A comment was made earlier that US\$29 million was paid to a contractor for no work done in the previous debate. We do not intend to stop that approval from taking place, but it is very important that that record is corrected. An amount of US\$29 million was paid as part of the broader contract sum. The banks funding the Savelugu to Walewale project, because of the entire debt restructuring programme, suspended any further disbursements until such a time that the debt restructuring was complete. When it was completed, the contractor is back on site. So, it is not correct that US\$29 million was paid, no work was done.

Mr Speaker, again, I beg of you, since I have the floor, the Minister for Roads and Highways mentioned that arrears were GH¢60 billion.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, that issue has been addressed by Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama.

Mr Nkrumah: No, Mr Speaker, it has not been addressed. Because if we go into the Budget that was submitted by the Minister for Finance—Mr Speaker, I

crave your indulgence. This is a House of record.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Nkrumah, I allowed you to just correct the other issue. This one, Hon Kabiru Mahama addressed it while the Minister was here.

Mr Nkrumah: But he should have corrected it, Mr Speaker, because people are carrying it home that there were arrears of GH¢60 billion.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: He addressed it and he himself took it on board. So let us move on.

Mr Daniel Dung Mahama (NDC — Talensi): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity.

I want to contribute on three areas the Ministry will work on District Housing Scheme, to decentralising housing development and address national housing deficit by building affordable homes across the district.

This is a major thing that the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources is going to take on. Most often when we hear about building of houses, it is always in the urban areas, but with this project, it is going to be decentralised and ensure that people within the rural areas also get a feel of it. For instance, when you go to Bolgatanga, getting to Pusu-Namogo, a piece of land was acquired for a district housing project. I think this project will

make sure that all those rural areas and districts within the country can get some affordable homes.

3:50 p.m.

When we go to the item numbered 4, work on the Akosombo Dam spillage resettlement programme aimed at constructing 2,250 decent housing units. This is something that the nation has been calling for a long time. With the Akosombo Dam spillage, I think a lot of people know what happened to this nation, where a lot of people were left homeless. So, with this being captured in the Budget, that over 2,000 houses will be built within those communities, it is a laudable thing that we are bringing on today's development.

I, therefore, encourage that we take it seriously and approve it so that the Ministry can carry on with its development projects. Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: I will now come to Leadership.

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): Mr Speaker, let me make a few comments to the Motion moved.

First of all, I think for a long time, we have lost out as a nation in paying needed attention. Correct me if I am wrong. The Water Resources Commission is supposed to be an agency under the Ministry, and we all know the relevance

and importance of this Commission; their interplay and relevance in the maintenance of our water bodies with their turbidity, and the—I am not impressed so far with governments that have come and gone. I am not limiting myself to this new Administration. I see they are taking copious notes. What is the vision of their outfits in resourcing the Water Resources Commission?

I recall this House put together an ad hoc committee to visit sites at the Volta River because of sand winning activities in the Volta River. I do not want to talk about *galamsey* because there is a relevance. Availability of raw water to be treated and distributed is a question that we need to start looking at. Water systems, and I see from the report, Damongo and Yendi are going to be beneficiaries; 10 districts in the Central Region are going to be beneficiaries. I do not know what informed these choices they have made, but the Eastern Region is obviously missing.

We are pleading with the Government to pay attention to Nsawam/Adoagyiri. We have the Densu River going through Nsawam/Adoagyiri. There is a good source of raw water that can be treated. It is an indictment, forgive me if it is a strong expression to use, that the whole of Eastern Region, not even one water system is coming from their outfit, is not good enough. They are only focusing — is it because the Minister comes from the Central Region? The Hon Minister should think about it; I know she is a patriotic citizen. It is just by the way. So

they should pay attention to easterners too, it is important.

She has been driving through the Eastern Region, Nsawam, before she gets to the Central Region, so the Ministry should pay attention to us. The Eastern Region is important; Akim Swedru, Ofoase Ayirebi and all the places. Then with the bridges, this House has passed a number of facilities—I think there was a facility that came from the Czech Republic or so. There were a number of them. So, the Ministry may have to relate to the Minister for Roads and Highways, Hon Governor Agbodza and let us see how both of them can exchange.

Again, in Nsawam/Adoagyiri, between Sikafuo Ammatem, Sabon Zongo and Adoagyiri Zongo—I know my constituents are listening. There is a huge drain. They have to come up with a plan for how we can deal with these drains across the country, not just in Nsawam/Adoagyiri. And for some of them, it does not need so much. There is a department under the Ministry, the Hydro Department; it should be doing some analysis or taking some inventory of the kind of bridges, probably, they can prioritise and programme it by way of attention. Some need urgent attention, and a number of these bridges connect to highways. And when it is done, it will help in developing alley roads that can lead to highways.

I know the Minister is a professional when it comes to the built environment. So please, exert that professionalism and

let us feel the impact at the Ministry. I am not too impressed with what she has done so far. She is very good in the built environment, and we invite her to bring her experience to bear. Let us feel the reset. I cannot feel the reset agenda.

Mr Speaker, having said that, I urge Members to support the passage of the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House approves the sum of GH¢1,460,906,354.00 for the services of the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may we again turn to Order Paper *Addendum*, the Motion numbered 2. We have already taken the Motions numbered one and three.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, kindly do us the honour by taking the Motion numbered 2.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: When the Ministers show up, we would not have a problem with them. Mr Speaker, the Minister can go ahead and take the item.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Anyway, he has done well; he has been

coming to this House, and today he has been here throughout the day.

MINISTRY OF TRANSPORT

Minister for Transport (Mr Joseph Nikpe Bukari) (MP): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That this honourable House approves the sum of GH¢1,500,040,589.00 for the services of the Ministry of Transport for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Isaac Adjei Mensah): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion, and in doing so, present your Committee's Report. The Committee met and deliberated on the Report in respect of the Budget Statement and Estimates, and there are a couple of issues that came to the fore.

Mr Speaker, I will respectfully request that *Hansard* captures the entirety of the report, while I concentrate on some key areas going forward.

Introduction

The Hon Minister for Finance, Mr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, presented the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of Government for the 2025 Financial Year to Parliament on Thursday, November 13, 2025, in accordance with Article 179 of the 1992 Constitution and Orders 193 and 195 of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

The estimates of the Ministry of Transport were subsequently laid before Parliament and referred to the Committee on Roads and Transportation for consideration and reporting, in accordance with Order 195(4) of the Standing Orders of the House.

To examine the referral, the Committee met with the Minister for Transport, Mr Joseph Bukari Nikpe, and officials from the Ministry of Transport and the Ministry of Finance, and hereby submits this report.

The Committee expresses its heartfelt gratitude to the Minister and the other officials for their assistance.

Reference Documents

The Committee was guided by the following legal documents, reports, and other relevant materials in its deliberations:

- a. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;
- b. The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana;
- c. Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921);
- d. Medium Term Expenditure Frame-work (MTEF) for 2025–2028 of the Ministry of Transport;
- e. 2025-2028 Budget Guidelines issued by the Ministry of Finance;

- f. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 financial year; and
- g. The Report of the Committee on Roads and Transportation on the Annual Estimates of the Ministry of Transport for the 2025 financial year.

Background of the Ministry of Transport

The goal of the Ministry of Transport is to create an integrated, modally complementary, cost-effective, safe, secure, sustainable, and seamless transportation system responsive to the needs of society, supporting growth and poverty reduction, and capable of establishing Ghana as a transport hub of West Africa.

The Ministry of Transport is the government agency responsible for overseeing and regulating the country's transportation infrastructure and services. Its mandate includes the development, maintenance, and modernisation of road networks, railways, aviation, maritime transport, and public transit systems. The Ministry plays a crucial role in ensuring safe, efficient, and sustainable transportation to support economic growth, trade, and public mobility.

Following the reorganisation of the ministries under the Civil Service (Ministries) Instrument, 2025 (E.I. 1), aimed at streamlining government operations and enhancing efficiency, the

Ministry of Railways Development has been merged with the Ministry of Transport. The functions of the Ministry of Railways Development now fall under the Ministry of Transport.

The Budget for 2026, therefore, covers the headquarters of the Ministry of Transport and its agencies across the maritime, road transport services, aviation, and railway sub-sectors. These are:

Maritime and Inland Water Transport

- a. Ghana Ports and Harbours Authority (GPHA).
- b. Ghana Shippers' Authority (GSA).
- c. Ghana Maritime Authority (GMA).
- d. Regional Maritime Education (RMU).
- e. Tema Shipyard & Drydock (TSD).
- f. Volta Lake Transport Company Ltd (VLTC).

Road Transport Services

- Driver Vehicle Licensing Authority (DVLA).
- National Road Safety Authority (NRSA).
- Metro Mass Transit Limited (MMTL).
- Intercity State Transport Company Limited (ISTC).

Aviation

- Ghana Civil Aviation Authority (GCAA).
- Ghana Airports Company Limited (GACL).
- Aircraft Accident and Incident Investigation and Preventive Bureau (AIB).

Railway

- Ghana Railways Development Authority (GRDA)

Policy Objectives

The underlisted constitute the policy objectives of the Ministry of Transport as captured in the National Medium-Term Development Framework 2022-2025:

- i. Improve efficiency and effectiveness of road transport infrastructure and services;
- ii. Enhance safety and security for all categories of road users;
- iii. Improve capacity and efficiency of sea port operations;
- iv. Develop and promote an inland water transport system;
- v. Position Ghana as the aviation hub for the West African sub-region;
- vi. Modernise and extend the railway network.

Performance Review of the 2025 Budget

Financial Status of 2025 Budget Implementation of the Ministry of Transport

The Ministry of Transport and its Agencies were appropriated a total budgetary allocation of one billion, ninety-one million, eight hundred and seventy-two thousand, seven hundred and fifty-seven Ghana Cedis (GH¢1,091,872,757.00) for the implementation of programmes and activities in the 2025 financial year. The approved amount was distributed among the three main economic classifications as follows:

Compensation	-	GH¢433,164,357.19
Goods and Services	-	GH¢330,584,171.01
Capital Expenditure	-	GH¢328,124,229.08
Total	-	GH¢1,091,872,757.28

As at the end of September 2025, a total of GH¢649,205,630.47, representing 59.45 per cent of the approved Appropriation, had been released to the Ministry for the execution of its

operations. The actual expenditure for the same period amounted to GH¢605,111,901.51, representing 55.45 per cent of the total approved budget.

The 2025 budget performance of the Ministry is presented in Table 1 below:

Table 1: Budget Performance of the Ministry of Transport for the Year 2025

Economic Classification	2025 Appropriation (A) (GH¢)	2025 Releases as (B) (GH¢)	Actual Expenditure (C) (GH¢)	Variance (A-B) (GH¢)	% released
Compensation of employees	433,164,357.19	298,934,051.48	298,934,051.48	134,230,305.71	68.99%
Goods and Services	330,584,171.01	214,669,513.75	213,575,784.79	115,914,657.26	64.95%
Capital Expenditure	328,124,229.08	135,602,065.24	92,602,065.24	192,522,163.84	41.33%
Total	1,091,872,757.28	649,205,630.47	605,111,901.51	442,667,126.81	59.45%

Source: MTEF for 2025-2028 of the Ministry of Transport

The GoG allocation of GH¢192,591,407.00 was disbursed in furtherance of the objectives of the Ministry. Details of the release of GoG allocation is as follows:

Table 2: 2025 GoG Budget performance as at 30/09/2025

Economic Classification	2025 Appropriation (A) (GH¢)	2025 Releases (B) (GH¢)	Actual Expenditure (GH¢)	Variance (A-B) (GH¢)	% released
Compensation of employees	26,018,448.00	15,535,389.70	15,535,389.70	10,483,058.30	59.72%
Goods and Services	3,059,135.00	2,240,386.97	1,146,658.01	818,748.03	73.27%
Capital Expenditure	163,513,824.00	43,000,000.00	—	120,513,824.00	26.31%
Total	192,591,407.00	60,775,776.67	16,682,047.71	131,815,630.33	31.57%

Sources: Ministry of Transport 2025 Budget Estimates Performance Report

The IGF allocation of GH¢801,481,350.28 was disbursed in furtherance of the objectives of the Ministry. Details of the release of the IGF allocation are as follows:

Table 3: 2025 Internally Generated Fund Budget performance as at the end of September 2025

Economic Classification	2025 Appropriation (A) (GH¢)	2025 Releases (B) (GH¢)	Actual Expenditure (GH¢)	Variance (A-B) (GH¢)	% released
Compensation of employees	407,145,909.19	283,398,661.78	283,398,661.78	123,747,247.41	69.60
Goods and Services	311,225,036.01	212,429,126.78	212,429,126.78	98,795,909.23	68.27
Capital Expenditure	83,110,405.08	92,602,065.24	92,602,065.24	(9,491,660.16)	111.42
Total	801,481,350.28	588,429,853.80	588,429,853.80	213,051,496.48	73.42

Source: Ministry of Transport 2025 Budget Estimates Performance Report

The Development Partner Budget performance is as follows:

Table 4: 2025 Development Partners Fund Budget performance as at the end of September 2025

Economic Classification	2025 Appropriation (A) (GH¢)	2025 Releases (B) (GH¢)	Actual Expenditure (GH¢)	Variance (A-B) (GH¢)	% released
Capital Expenditure	97,800,000.00	—	—	97,800,000.00	0%
Total	97,800,000.00	—	—	97,800,000.00	0%

Non-financial Management and Administration

The Ministry in 2025:

- a) Extended its office building to provide additional office space and a conducive working environment for staff (on-going and about 98 per cent complete).
- b) Developed a business model and operational framework to guide the government's engagement with a strategic investor for the re-establishment of the National Airline.
- c) Completed the Evaluation of Expression of Interest (EOL) for the development of Coastal Water Transport and RFP issued.
- d) Received Cabinet approval for the proposed amendments of the Road Traffic Act, 2004 (Act 683), and drafting of regulations currently ongoing by the Attorney General (AG) to allow for the commercialisation of motorcycle (Okada) and tricycle and other related matters is ongoing.
- e) Successfully negotiated for a 15 per cent reduction in public transport fares, which took effect on 24th May, 2025.

Maritime Services

- a) Completed the construction of the GMA Head office (98 per cent complete), and the Takoradi office (96 per cent complete)
- b) Launched full 24-hour operations at the Tema and Takoradi Ports in line with the 24-hour Economy Policy.
- c) Undertook a comprehensive upgrade of the Vessel Traffic Management Information System (VTMIS) (40 per cent).
- d) Developed a database and mobile application to capture wooden cargo and passenger wooden boats.
- e) Engaged in the development and review of the Collective Bargaining Agreement (CBA) for Ghanaian Seafarers underway.

- f) Developed the Boankra Integrated Logistics Terminal Phase 1 (85 per cent complete).
- g) Commenced the development of the Akatakyiwa Freight Park to provide a freight park, accommodation and other ancillary services for the Transit Truck Drivers.
- h) Submitted to Cabinet for approval the Maritime and Related Offences Bill 2025 to prevent and punish maritime offences such as piracy, armed robbery at sea and other unlawful acts.
- i) Completed the revised feasibility study, and submitted loan request to MoF for the Modernisation of the Regional Maritime University.
- j) Constructed the Takoradi Oil and Gas Services Terminal (100 per cent complete)
- k) Constructed the Takoradi Integrated Container Terminal-Phase 1 (fully completed).
- l) Rehabilitation of Breakwater at the Tema Port is 60 per cent complete.
- m) Submitted feasibility and ESIA report for the development of the Keta Port and constructed the Administration Block (50 per cent complete).
- b) Commissioned new offices at Akwatia and Bole, while a 24-hour operational office was commissioned at Adentan for use by the DVLA.
- c) Undertook an engagement of Metropolitan, Municipal, and District Assemblies (MMDAs) in Greater Accra on the implication of the National Road Safety Regulations, 2022; L.I 2468 for local governance and transport regulation.
- d) Successfully migrated the Road Accident Data Management System (RADMS) unto the local server at the National Information Technology Agency (NITA).
- e) Commenced Regulatory & Compliance Enforcement of the National Road Safety Regulations, 2022 (L.I 2468) across the country.
- f) Commenced registration of earth moving Vehicles to minimise "Galamsey".
- g) Constructed new DVLA Offices at Weija, Dunkwa-on-Offin and Wenchi to replace outdated spaces and meet growing demands.
- h) Commenced the registration of Earth Moving Equipment which includes (excavators, bulldozers etc and as at August 2025 a total number of 8,967 of this equipment have been registered.

Road Transport Management

- a) Commenced the introduction of DP stickers to replace aluminum plates.
- i) Initiated processes to introduce new vehicle license plate with enhanced

security features such as Radio-Frequency Identification (RFID).

- j) Printed all the back log of driver license cards (386,050) and dispatched to the various DVLA offices for collection.

Aviation

- a) Launched the implementation of an Advanced Passenger Information (API), and Passenger Name Record (PNR) System at KIA.
- b) Constructed an Ultra-Modern Air Traffic Control Tower (ATC) to ensure safe and secure Air Navigation Services.
- c) Commissioned a Modern Air Navigation Service Centre (ANS) to enhance air traffic operations in the Accra Flight Information Region (FIR).
- d) Replaced the traditional boom-bar equipment with a digital access control system equipped with number plate recognition technology at T3 Car Park.
- e) Commenced procurement process for the construction of a multi-storey car park facility at KIA.
- f) Constructed the ultra-modern Hajj Village to provide one-stop-shop for pilgrims (about 20 per cent complete).

- g) Completed the extension of existing runway at the Prempeh I International Airport from 1981m to 2,320m to accommodate medium-bodied aircrafts (97.52 per cent complete).

- h) Repurposed the Terminal 2 to decongest Terminal 3 at the KIA to respond to increasing passenger traffic. Works at the arrival hall completed whiles works at the departure hall is on-going.

Railway Transport

- a) Resumed work on sections of the Western Railway Line from the Manso to Huni Valley, which had been halted since December 2024.
- b) Completed a test run on the newly constructed Tema-Mpakadan railway line and operationalised passenger services from Tema to Adomi.
- c) Put in efforts to secure funding for the development of the remaining sections of the Western Railway line to link the various mineral deposits along the corridor.
- d) Collaborated with the Lands Commission and security agencies to remove encroachers from the railway right-of-way to enable the contractors to have unimpeded access to land and facilitate early completion of railway projects across the country.

Outlook for 2026**Financial****Budget for the Ministry**

In the 2026 financial year, the Ministry has been allocated a total amount of one billion, five hundred

million, forty thousand, five hundred and eighty-nine Ghana Cedis (GH¢1,500,040,589.00) for the implementation of its activities. Table 5 provides the allocation by economic classification. Compensation constitutes about 38. per cent of the total budgetary allocation.

Table 5: 2026 Budgetary allocation by economic classification

Economic Classification	GoG	IGF	Donor	Total
Compensation	27,194,594.00	546,889,881.00	-	574,084,475.00
Goods and Services	11,059,135.00	557,965,497.00	-	569,024,632.00
Capital Expenditure	113,513,824.00	243,417,658.00	-	356,931,482.00
Total	151,767,553.00	1,348,273,036.00	-	1,500,040,589.00

Source: Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year.

Table 6: Summary of 2026 Budget Ceiling by Programmes

Programme	GoG	IGF	Total
P1 Management and Administration	64,583,000.00	5,011,200.00	69,594,200.00
P2 Maritime Services		838,875,430.00	838,875,430.00
GMA		729,751,860.00	729,751,860.00
GSA		109,123,570.00	109,123,570.00
P3 Road Transport Management	87,184,553.00	504,386,405.00	591,570,958.00
SP 3.1 DVLA		449,229,355.00	449,229,355.00
SP 3.2 NRSA	10,280,314.00	49,824,395.00	60,104,709.00
P5 Rail Transport	76,904,239.00	5,332,655.00	82,236,894.00
Total	151,767,553.00	1,348,273,036.00	1,500,040,589.00

Non-Financial

In the 2026 fiscal year, the Ministry of Transport intends to undertake the following projects:

- a) Establishment of the National Airline.
- b) Establishment of an Aviation Training and MRO at the Ho Airport.
- c) Repurposing of Terminal 2 of the Kotoka International Airport.
- d) Development of Coastal shore passenger services.
- e) Completion of the construction of the Regional Maritime University (RMU) Auditorium.
- f) Development of Boankra Integrated Logistics Terminal (BILT).
- g) Operationalisation of Motorcycles/Tricycles for Fare-paying Passenger Services (Okada).
- h) Procurement of EV buses for Metro Mass transit Limited (MMTL) and Intercity STC Coaches Limited (ISTC).
- i) Construction of a new MMTL Terminal at Tamale.
- j) Digitisation of Road Safety Services (Transport Ghana).

- k) Redevelopment and modernisation of Terminals at various locations for ISTC.
- l) Construction/ Reconstruction and Renovation of DVLA Office.
- m) Continuation of the revamp of the Western and Eastern Railway line.
- n) Introduction of New Vehicle Registration Number Plate

Observations and Recommendations

The Committee, having carefully examined the estimates of the Ministry of Transport, made the following observations and recommendations:

2025 Budget performance of the Ministry of Transport

The Committee observed that releases to the Ministry of Transport for the 2025 financial year fell significantly below the approved budget across all the major economic classifications as at September 2025. Under Compensation of Employees, an approved ceiling of GH¢26,018,448.00 recorded an actual release of GH¢15,535,389.70, representing a shortfall of GH¢10,483,058.30 or 40.27 per cent, with only 59.73 per cent of the approved amount disbursed. For Goods and Services, the Ministry received GH¢2,240,386.97 out of the approved GH¢3,059,135.00, resulting in a funding gap of GH¢818,748.03, equivalent to a 26.77 per cent shortfall and a release rate

of 73.23 per cent. The most significant variance was recorded under Capital Expenditure (Capex) where, against an approved amount of GH¢165,513,824.00, only GH¢43,000,000.00 had been released, creating a substantial shortfall of GH¢122,513,824.00 or 74.03 per cent, representing a release performance of just 25.97 per cent. The Committee noted with concern that the deep under performance in Capex threatens the timely execution of key transport infrastructure projects, while the shortfalls in Goods and Services have implications for administrative efficiency and effective service delivery.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance ensures more predictable and timely releases to the Ministry of Transport to enhance budget execution, particularly in respect of Capital Expenditure which experienced the most severe underfunding. The Ministry should also prioritise critical infrastructure projects for early disbursement to avert project delays and cost overruns. Additionally, the Committee urges the Ministry of Finance to address the shortfalls recorded in Goods and Services to safeguard administrative stability and operational effectiveness. The Committee further recommends that future budget allocations be aligned more closely with realistic revenue projections to minimise persistent deviations between Parliamentary appropriation and actual releases.

DVLA Expansion and 24-hour Service Delivery

The Committee observed that the Ministry of Transport, as part of a government flagship programme under the 24-hour economy, intends to enhance public service delivery through the introduction of a 24-hour operational service at the Adenta DVLA office. The Authority is also and simultaneously undertaking infrastructure expansion across the country to roll out similar services nationwide.

According to the Minister, the initiative is aimed at reducing congestion, improving accessibility, and ensuring the timely delivery of licensing and vehicle registration services to meet the increasing needs of motorists.

Whereas the Committee recognises the potential benefits of this expanded service model, the Committee highlights the need for adequate staffing, security arrangements, technological readiness, and facility maintenance to sustain continuous operations.

The Committee therefore recommends that the Ministry develop a comprehensive implementation plan with clear timelines and ensure sufficient resource allocation for the nationwide rollout, as well as conduct regular performance evaluations to guarantee that the 24-hour service model delivers the expected improvements in efficiency and customer satisfaction.

Non-Performance on Capex Allocation 2025

The Committee noted that by September 2025, the Ministry of Transport had received GH¢43,000,000 out of its approved CAPEX allocation of GH¢163,513,824.00, representing a release rate of approximately 26 per cent. The Ministry earmarked this amount for several key capital projects, including the development of water transport (GH¢15,000,000.00), procurement of office furniture and fittings (GH¢6,500,000.00), office equipment (GH¢1,000,000.00), EV vehicles (GH¢10,000,000.00), installation of a solar system (GH¢1,000,000.00), and construction of a bus terminal (GH¢6,713,000.00). However, despite the release, no expenditure had been incurred on any of these planned activities as at the reporting date, indicating delays in project initiation and procurement processes and raising concerns about the Ministry's ability to effectively execute its 2025 capital programme.

Officials informed the Committee that the delay in expenditure on capex is as a result of the new requirement and the Public Financial Management directive issued by the Minister for Finance on 3 April 2025, that no government contract may be approved or commence without prior "commitment authorisation" from the Ministry of Finance. The minister reiterated that the requirement is applicable to all Ministries, Departments and Agencies (MDAs) as it seeks to beef up

commitment controls and prevent unauthorised spending or contract awards outside the approved budget

The Ministry of Finance has accordingly granted authorisation to enable the Ministry to fully expend on the earmarked capital projects.

The Committee urges the Ministry to expedite the required procurement and implementation processes and develop a clear action plan with timelines to ensure the timely utilisation of the released funds and prevent further delays in CAPEX execution.

Introduction and Rollout of New Vehicle No Plates

The Committee observed that the Driver and Vehicle Licensing Authority (DVLA) has introduced new stickers as part of measures to curb the widespread misuse of DP plates on vehicles, including the unauthorised sharing of stickers, evasion of road regulations, and difficulties in tracking vehicles under test or in transit.

According to the Ministry, the new sticker system is intended to enhance identification, improve compliance, and strengthen enforcement by ensuring that each DP sticker is uniquely linked to a specific motor vehicle, thereby preventing multiple vehicles from using the same number. The Committee further noted that the DVLA has commenced the rollout of these stickers across its regional offices.

Additionally, the committee noted that DVLA intends to introduce a new number plate system effective January 2026 to improve security features. This new number plate system will provide tracking and identification of vehicles and make the numbering system a personal property owned by the individual. The committee was informed that the system would reduce number plate fraud and increase revenue generation for the Authority.

In view of this, the Committee recommends that the DVLA intensify public education on the purpose and benefits of the new stickers, enhance collaboration with the police for stricter enforcement, and monitor the implementation closely to ensure the expected improvements in compliance and reduction in plate misuse are fully realised.

Salary Arrears Owed Railways Staff

The Committee noted that the Ghana Railway Company Limited has accumulated salary arrears amounting to GH¢34,590,541.95 for staff and continues to accumulate arrears in excess of GH¢2.5 million monthly.

Officials of the Ministry of Finance informed the committee that an amount of GH¢10 million has been released for the settlement of four (4) months' salary arrears for staff.

The committee urged the Ministry of Transport to speed up the processes for

the payment of the arrears to lessen the financial burden on the staff.

The Minister of Transport assured the committee that the Ministry intends to dispose of the absolute assets of Ghana Railway Company Limited to pay the salary arrears.

The committee expressed concerns that the Ghana Railway Company Limited continues to keep staff and accumulate monthly arrears when the Company is not in operation.

In view of this, the Committee recommends that, the Ministry should endeavor to clearing the outstanding arrears, and undertake a structured workforce rationalisation by reassigning staff to critical operations and implementing targeted layoffs where necessary, ensuring that the process is conducted transparently, in consultation with staff and unions guided by fair labour practices to safeguard welfare and bring to closure the long-standing problem of the salary arrears of railway workers.

Airport Passenger Service Charge (APSC)

The Committee noted the introduction of a revised Airport Passenger Service Charge (APSC) of GH¢100 in the 2026 Annual Estimates of the Ministry. This adjustment represents a significant change from the long-standing charge of GH¢5.00, which the Committee had previously

considered inadequate to support the financing, operation, and maintenance of the country's airport infrastructure.

The Committee observed that the previous APSC level was insufficient to meet the rising costs associated with airport development and upkeep, particularly in light of substantial capital investments made in major aviation projects such as the Kotoka International Airport (KIA) Terminal 3, and ongoing expansion works in Kumasi and Tamale. Many of these projects have been financed through loans, requiring predictable and sustainable revenue streams to ensure timely repayment and continued infrastructure upkeep.

The Committee therefore acknowledged the rationale for revising the APSC to GH¢100 and considers the adjustment a positive step toward improving revenue adequacy and strengthening the financial sustainability of airport operations. The Committee further recommends that the Ministry undertake a periodic review of the APSC and other airport revenue streams to ensure alignment with industry standards and to provide reliable funding for maintenance, debt servicing, and future aviation infrastructure development.

Conclusion

The Ministry of Transport is central to the nation's economic development and public well-being, as it is responsible for providing a safe, efficient, and reliable transportation system. Sufficient financing is therefore crucial to expand

and maintain infrastructure, modernise public transport services, strengthen regulatory enforcement, and advance sustainable transport initiatives.

The Committee hereby recommends to the House to adopt its Report and approve the sum of one billion, five hundred million, forty thousand, five hundred and eighty-nine Ghana Cedis (GH¢1,500,040,589.00) for the activities of the Ministry of Transport for the financial year ending 31st December, 2025.

Mr Speaker, in addition to the many staff and many details that were discussed, the Committee on the airport passenger service charge came to our attention. The airport section needs enough funds for other projects. And therefore, the existing charges were considered to be minimal. So there is a need to have a review of it to be able to get them enough funds to operationalise the activities.

We also took notice of one critical section; the arrears of salaries owed to the railway staff. This has been on the drawing board for a very long time. It is quite demoralising.

4:00 p.m.

Therefore, the Committee recommended and because these are labour issues, and the fact that unrest can result, which is not too good at this time, the Committee recommended to the Ministry to take appropriate steps to

ensure that they find enough funds to make sure that these arrears are cleared to allow the families of workers who find themselves in these challenges be in good shape.

Mr Speaker, we also noticed the introduction and rollout of new vehicle number plates under the Driver and Vehicle Licensing Authority (DVLA). The DVLA is one of the emerging agencies that is performing very well. New ways of doing things are things that the Committee accepts and recommends. Therefore, the introduction of these new plates is in line with the best standards internationally. We assure the Ministry that the Committee supports the action, and recommends that we accept their proposal.

Mr Speaker, the Ministry of Transport remains one of the critical Ministries in the economy and in the country, and we recommend that their allocation of GH¢1.5 billion be approved. I so move, thank you.

Ranking Member of the Committee (Mr Kennedy Nyarko Osei): Mr Speaker, I beg to support the Motion. I just want to make a few comments on the Reports under the observation column. When the Committee met the Ministry, after looking at their Budget performance, we realised that under CAPEX, an amount of GH¢165 million was budgeted for the Ministry. By the end of September, 2025, only GH¢43 million has been released to the Ministry for its activities, which represents 26 per

cent. A Ministry like the Ministry of Transport is a very important and critical Ministry. For the Ministry not to have releases of their budgets to run their activities, we thought it was a very worrying situation. We encourage the Minister for Finance to ensure timely release of funds to the Ministry in the ensuing year so that they can have funds to run the activities of the Ministry.

We were informed that the DVLA intends to introduce a new number plate, which has more security features. We drew the Ministry's attention that there was a law governing the introduction of licence plates. Therefore, if they want to come out with such a new licence plate, they have to make sure that the law is amended. The Hon Minister has taken a cue, and he will be forwarding the necessary documents to the House, for the House to also look at it and do the necessary amendments so that it will pave way for them to be able to introduce the new number plates in January, 2026.

Mr Speaker, we also observed that the railway sector is under distress. I am saying so because even the railway staff have not been paid for some time now. The Government is owing the workers about GH¢34 million, and Government has made an attempt to pay GH¢10 million out of it. We advised the Minister that it would be better for the Government to find all the money to settle them. If Government wants to reassign the workers to other units or other departments at the Ministry, they can do it. Currently, it seems the workers

are redundant. Most of them are not doing anything, and Government keeps paying them. Each month, Government is adding GHC2.5 million to the cost. We advised the Minister to ensure that Government rather looks for the resources to pay them so that they can reassign them to other units.

Mr Speaker, the last observation was that if you look at the amount of money that have been assigned to the railway sector, it is inadequate. If you look at the investment that the railway sector needs and the amount of money that has been earmarked in the Budget for 2026, it is something that we think the Government has to look at. The Railway sector is a very critical sector, which if we are able to build, will come and complement the roads that we are building. We want to encourage the Government through the Ministry for Finance to consider allocating more funds for the Ministry so that they can pay proper attention to the development of the railway sector. Mr Speaker, these were few observations that were made at the Committee level. With these observations and assurances given by the Minister, I think I have no objection than to support the approval of the Budgets of GHC1.5 billion which has been allocated to the Ministry for them to execute their activities in 2026. Mr Speaker, with these few words, I thank you.

Second Deputy Majority Whip (Mr Richard Acheampong): Mr Speaker, I rise to support the Motion on the Floor that the House approves an

amount of GHC1,500,040,589.00 for the Ministry of Transport to undertake their activities in 2026. Let me commend DVLA for the innovation that they have come out with. Just this morning, I received a message from DVLA, and the message is, “Dear client, your drivers’ licence is due for renewal on February 2026. Visit any DVLA office for renewal. Thank you. Your safety, our concern.”

Mr Speaker, indeed, this is the reset we are talking about. Sometimes, we hold our driver’s licence, without knowing the expiring date. There is a sticker on it. So, even though we see the expiry dates, we do not know that we have to renew it in every two years. We then meet the Police on the road and they harass us. If you have an agency who is using technology to give information to their clients that they have two months or three months to renew their drivers’ licence, I think we need to commend the agency for helping their customers to do what is right, to avoid a clash with the police on the road. So, we commend the Hon Minister for a yeoman’s work and urge him to keep it up.

Mr Speaker, concerning the Ghana Airports Company, if we take Sunyani, Kumasi, and Tamale, all of them are running at a loss. It is only the Kotoka International Airport that is breaking even to take care of all the airports that we have in the country. I ask myself, is it a social service that we are providing for them, or is it a commercial entity? When I read through the Budget that they are

increasing their fees from GH¢5 to GH¢100, I got to understand that this will give them more resources so that the expansion that they want to do in Sunyani and Kumasi—the Kumasi one is ongoing, their passenger throughput will increase and their revenue levels will also increase. So, by the end of the day, they will generate more revenue to deal with their overhead expenditures. I think we need to support this suggestion by the Minister so that by the end of the day, they will get more resources. Even if they are not making profit, they should break even so that the investment we made so far, we can see that there is value for money. We need to support the Ministry to achieve their target in 2026. So next year, I think the story will be different. I encourage Hon Colleagues to support the Report before us. Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Mr Patrick Boamah?

Mr Patrick Boamah (NPP — Okaikwei Central): Mr Speaker, I will turn our attention to page 15 of the Report. While the Ministry is seeking to increase the airport passenger service charge from GH¢5 to GH¢100 per passenger.

4:10 p.m.

The Government is hiding this in the Report. A 1,000 per cent increase from GH¢5 to GH¢100 per passenger on both domestic and international flights. This

is a very serious charge that the country must be made aware of.

Mr Speaker, airport tax—Is this the resetting that now, we cannot even drive on our roads? Flying too has become too expensive. Is that what they promised this country? From GH¢5 to GH¢100?

Mr Speaker, I chair the Committee on Subsidiary Legislation—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister for Transport, have they started charging the fee?

Minister for Transport (Mr Joseph Nikpe Bukari): Mr Speaker, I was just waiting to have my turn and ask for a correction to be made on the Report. What we have is that the domestic flight charge is GH¢5, International economy fee charge is GH¢100 and the international business fee charge is GH¢150. That is what we have now—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Then it means there is the need for corrections. So, let Mr Patrick Boamah conclude.

Mr Boamah: Mr Speaker, the Minister has confirmed what I just said—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: But he said it is only in reference to the international flight. The domestic flight, the amount—

Mr Boamah: That cannot be referred to as “it is only”.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: He just said the GH¢5 remains same.

Mr Boamah: Mr Speaker, GH¢5 to GH¢100; is the Minister referring to this by using the word as “only”? Is that what the Minister is telling us?

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: The Minister said that is a—

Mr Boamah: Within a year under the Reset Agenda, an increment from GH¢5 to GH¢100 is being referred to by the Minister by using the word “only”. A thousand per cent—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Mr Patrick Boamah, what the Minister said was that, the domestic flight charge is still GH¢5. They have not made any changes. It is only the international flight fee charge that is GH¢100. Is that not what he said?

Mr Bukari: Mr Speaker, I want to repeat for all of us to hear. Since 2014, the airport passenger service charge has remained the same. The Committee is making recommendations to this House, that we should consider to make some increases to the charges, that since 2014, have remained the same. The charge for the domestic flights is GH¢5 and that of the charge of the international economy flights is GH¢100 and that of international business flights, GH¢150.

Mr Speaker, those are the charges we are taking. Since 2014, we have not increased the amounts.

Mr Boamah: Mr Speaker, I still stand by my point. The value is the same. That they are increasing airport passenger service charge. Whether domestic, international or business flights and others, from GH¢5 to GH¢100; a thousand percent?

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Mr Patrick Boamah, did the Minister say that?

Mr Boamah: Yes. He said in some cases, GH¢150—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Mr Patrick Boamah, what I heard which I believe is also what you heard is that the domestic flight service fee charge is still GH¢5.

Mr Boamah: Mr Speaker, how many people fly domestic? *[Interruption]*

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: I fly domestic.

Mr Boamah: How many? Even if the charge is GH¢5 to GH¢150, it is a lot of money for international passengers to pay. Because he is a Minister, the State caters for him so he does not care about that? Is that what he is telling Ghanaians? This is very sad for a resetting agenda. It is very insensitive on the part of Government.

Mr Speaker, on a more serious note, I chair the Subsidiary Legislation Committee and this falls within the Fees and Charges (Miscellaneous Provisions)

Act, 2022 Bill, that was brought to our Committee. Unfortunately, this has been smuggled through the Budget. It is supposed to have been part of the Bill that came to us, which matured on 13th November. This is news to me, and to the Committee.

So, I want us to ask the Minister whether it was part of the Bill that was brought to us, which matured on the 13th November and why it has been smuggled through this Budget at this 11th hour, as a new service charge. It is very important. We have to step this Report down for further explanation from the Minister.

The second point is on the 24-Hour Economy, Driver and Vehicle Licensing Authority (DVLA) expansion. One year down the line, I am just seeing Adenta as the only service or delivery point. One year; 12 months into the administration of the second coming of the President, John Dramani Mahama— The 24-Hour Economy, where t-shirts were printed across the country—That people were going to work from 6 am to 12 noon and then from 12 noon to 6 pm and so on. Now they have just one service centre at Adenta. They are even asking for more service centres across the country. That is serious.

Mr Speaker, look at page 13—Non-performance on CAPEX allocation in 2025. Let me read it to you, “That the Committee noted that, by September 2025, the Ministry of Transport had received GHC43 million out of its

approved CAPEX allocation of GHC165 million.”

With this, they sit here and say “Ato is forcing”. Forcing what? *[Interruption]* I would read further. Representing a release rate of approximately 26 per cent and they sit here and say, “*ɔde asem papa na aba*”. Is it “*asem papa na aba*”? Mr Joseph Nikpe Bukari, are you happy with the 26 per cent release?

Mr Speaker, despite the release, no expenditure has been incurred on these planned activities and his Ministry is asking for more funds. Mr Joseph Nikpe Bukari, “*agorɔ b3sɔ a 3firi anɔpa*”. If within the whole year they got only 26 per cent—that is why Mr Yussif Jajah does not even come to the House. Mr Yussif Jajah Issaka has stopped coming to the House. Mr Joseph Nikpe Bukari, how were you able to survive in 2025 with a 26 per cent release? How? This is very sad and unfortunate and they think “Ato is forcing”? He is collapsing your Ministry.

We know the Hon Ministers are not happy with releases. Mr Bukari, Mrs Akushika Tetteh-Agbotui, Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem and the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry are all not happy. The Minister just walked in. The whole day, we are debating his Report, he just walked in and he is shouting. Mr Richard Acheampong, are you happy with the 26 per cent?

Mr Speaker, I do not think we must support this Report.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: I would give the Minister an opportunity to explain.

Mr Boamah: It is very important. From GH¢5 to GH¢100.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: But Mr Patrick Boamah, what he said is different from what you are telling me.

Mr Boamah: Mr Speaker, the Report is before you.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Anyway, I would ask him to repeat because he said the domestic flight service charge is still GH¢5.

Mr Boamah: Mr Speaker, you are more interested in the domestic flight service charge.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: This morning, I used a domestic flight.

Mr Boamah: We want to promote tourism. We want to promote our siblings' interest in coming to Ghana. Christmas is fast approaching. We are approving this Budget. People want to come for the Blackstar experience and what have you. Ticket costs are going to increase. Did he factor all those into his calculations?

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Let me give him the opportunity.

4:20 p.m.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, conclude and give us the explanation.

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, before the Minister comes in, the Chairman must do the correction to reflect what we are talking about so that the Minister will conclude.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Chairperson, let us hear you.

Mr Isaac Adjei Mensah: Mr Speaker, there is actually no increase in the scheme of things. We have maintained the position that domestic rates remain the same and therefore the increase affects the external travels, if there is so, there is no increase. We request to amend the Report to reflect the position as expatiated by the Minister going forward.

Thank you.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: So, it means the amendment you are seeking is to the effect that the domestic will remain at GH¢5.00. Is that not the case?

Mr I. A. Mensah: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: And the external will be increased to GH¢100.00?

Mr I. A. Mensah: It is the same thing.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well, now the explanation is clear. It is the external that has been affected but the internal still remains GH¢5.00.

Mr Gideon Boako (NPP— Tano North): Mr Speaker, thank you. I think we need some clarity here, especially with regard to the external because my understanding is that for economy class passengers, the charge is going to be US\$100 and for business US\$150. This is what I know. I want the Minister to clarify. For business class, US\$150 and for ECOWAS passengers, US\$50. So, the Minister should clarify. Are we talking about GH¢100, US\$150, US\$100 or US\$50? We need that clarity.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Minister, just explain to us, is it in dollars or in Ghana cedis?

Mr Bukari: Mr Speaker, the Committee was recommending to this House for us to consider an increase in the airport passenger service charge and that it had been the same rate from 2014 to date. Now those rates are quoted in dollars. Since 2014, they have not been increased and the Committee was rather recommending to this House that the House should consider with the work of the Ghana Airport Company and increase it from GH¢ 500 and 150, to a new level. So, it is a consideration for the House. But if we will increase, we have to come through the fees and charges. Let me inform the House, that since 2014, this airport passenger service charge has not been increased. It has

remained the same and that is what we have been operating with.

Mr Speaker, having said this, I want to take this opportunity to thank the Committee and Members of the —
[Interruption]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Minister, just hold on, I would give you the opportunity to thank the Committee after the approval.

But Minister, I think the Minister for Finance has been advocating that dollarisation should cease. So, if even the existing —

Mr Bukari: Mr Speaker, I am reporting on something that has been there since 2014. It is not a new thing. This is a charge we inherited.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: I am just bringing to your attention whether you discussed this with the Minister. No, Hon Dafeamekpor, I want him to get this clearly —

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the Report is very clear. It is quoted there as Ghana cedis. Is it in the Report that it is quoted in dollars? So, if he says that at the Committee level, the Report — So, all these matters will be subject to the Fees and Charges Act. So, this attempt to get the Minister to say that it is Pound Sterling or Euros, when the Report says clearly— We cannot compel him to say that. There is nothing ambiguous about what is in the report. So, we should not

attempt to get the Minister to contradict what is in the Report. It will be subjected to the Fees and Charges Act. That is what will bring clarity.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: All right, so do we put the question?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, page 16 of the Report is very clear. And what are they saying that the Minister did? The content of the Report is what we are working with. In any case, there will be a Fees and Charges Act. All this will be contained in the Fees and Charges Act. *[Interruption]*— No, for purposes of recommendation, if it is clear, why are they trying to get the Minister to say a different thing? If the Minister says it is in Pound Sterling, would they amend the Report. I am saying that there is nothing ambiguous with the Report.

Mr Annnoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I will advise the Minister.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Minister, you hold on, I would come to you.

Mr Annnoh-Dompreh: Our good Friend should wait. When we are done, he can clarify or put in context the figures and the issues our Colleagues are speaking to.

Mr Speaker, let me speak to the Motion and make some observations. Conspicuously missing is Electronic Vehicles (EVs). I have read through the Report. If the Minister has any pages of

his Report speaking to electronic vehicles, he should draw my attention. Allocation to EVs is zero. I know how passionate he is in terms of EVs. This cannot pass. The previous Government has set the tone. He is aware of all the initiatives and the undertakings in terms of electronic vehicles. We do not need to — they would use the mid-year. We hope so. Now, all of us are aware about emissions in this country. And science has proven that transport alone contributes to more than 20 per cent of emissions, especially in urban and peri-urban areas, it is the reason for which the previous Government set the tone and put out the necessary framework for us to expand. What I expect from them is expansion. Now, zero allocation, that cannot be.

Mr Speaker, to expand on electronic vehicles, provision, and the template that needs to expand on it— Where are they piloting it at? We are talking about reduction of carbon footprint and I have already told them that the transport sector alone contributes more than 20 per cent. The previous Government has set the tone and the least they can do is to continue. Hon Minister, look at me and pay attention to this part.

On public transport, electronic vehicles have the potential of reducing emissions, carbon footprints and has other health benefits and his Government is not visionary enough to continue what we started. They are providing nothing and they want us to applaud them. We cannot applaud this. The Hon Minister must speak to this.

4:30 p.m.

Mr Speaker, the last time Mr Bede Ziedeng had come to make a formal Statement lamenting on the number of accidents occurring on our water bodies across the country, these include: the White Volta, the Black Volta, and the Volta River, and there is not even a line budget on the provision of safety measures on these transport facilities, on these water bodies; this cannot be acceptable. The Hon Minister for Finance should have been here.

Mr Speaker, you would recall that you even had a reason to make an appropriate referral on this same subject matter. We cannot approve this Budget. They have to go back and do their homework well. The Hon Minister should go back and amend the Electric Vehicles (EVs) and facilities on our water bodies. We know the number of people who move along these water bodies; we cannot accept this Budget. The Hon Minister knows what to do right.

Mr Speaker, in the Report, page 8, the item numbered 5.2.2, subheading “Road Transport Management”, the item numbered 5.2.2(b) says:

“Commission new offices at Akwatia and Bole, while a 24-hour operations office was commissioned at Adenta for use by the DVLA”

The least they could do was at least acknowledge the good work that their predecessor had started. We are aware of what we did in terms of the Akwatia

office that they commissioned; they should have acknowledged our efforts.

Proceeding further, on page 10, the item numbered 5.2.5, it also says:

“Completed a test run of the newly constructed Tema-Mpakadan railway line and operationalised passenger services from Tema to Adomi.

Mr Speaker, the Hon Minister did not acknowledge the effort of the previous government; that is not good enough. What he should be speaking to is what to do to enhance because he came to meet it. The Tema-Mpakadan railway line was built by the previous New Patriotic Party (NPP) administration, and the test run, I am told, had all been done. They should acknowledge our good works.

Mr Speaker, without adding more, the Hon Minister should pay attention to what Mr Patrick Boamah had raised on the fees and charges. We need to clarify it once and for all. Let us get it explained, or it should be taken out of the report.

Mr Speaker, for EVs, I am an environmentalist, and I have engaged him privately, and I know how passionate he is. If it is the case that they have a problem speaking to the exchequer, they can tell us. We are going to approve the Budget, we can say no, and say they should go back and make the necessary amendment. If they need more money, they should tell us. Today, across the world, the narrative in terms of environmental conservation is about

how we can deal with emissions. At the last Conference of the Parties (COP), concerns about emissions have been strongly raised, including some of its damages and how we can do to deal with it, yet in 21st Century Ghana, they bring a Budget for the Ministry of Transport, and there is nothing on EVs. Are they proud of this? They should not be proud. I insist that they go back and do their homework well. Twenty per cent contribution on emissions by the transport sector, and it cannot be ordinary.

Mr Speaker, to conclude, I want to rehash the accidents on the White Volta, the Black Volta, and the Hon Minister is from the northern part of our country. Clearly, their Budget is not enough. They should go back and input these considerations and come back, and then we will consider whether we will approve it or not. As it stands, we are opposed; we would not pass this Budget. Besides, Ghana has entered into a number of bilateral cooperation agreements that are raking in billions of dollars, especially on environmental conservation and emissions. Last time, Switzerland, Korea, and now the United Arab Emirates (UAE) are all ready to rake in these moneys.

Mr Speaker, I beg the Hon Minister, but we cannot accept this Budget. They should go back and do something about the emissions, because it has the potential to bring a lot of Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation in Developing Countries (REDD+) benefits in terms of dollars.

Ghana last year raked in over US\$2 billion from Switzerland, free money, low-hanging fruit.

Mr Speaker, the Minority is helping them. We are helping them to blaze a trail. They can check by googling the benefits from REDD+ between Ghana and Switzerland. Currently, UAE is outstanding, and it will bring in a lot of money. Let us pay attention to this.

I thank you for the opportunity, but for the Budget, we will not approve. We would not pass this Motion; it should go back.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, this Side of the House keeps reminding the Majority that this Budget is a cut-and-paste Budget.

Mr Speaker, with the 2026 Budget, when we compare the content to the very Budget they criticised, the 2024 budget, we would realise that some phrases, some paragraphs were just lifted. We pointed it out to them, and they will not even take their time to read the entire Budget to correct it. On pages 75 and 76, they are there.

Mr Speaker, the money that has been allocated to the Presidency, compensation alone, is more than what is being given to a whole Ministry, what a reset government. This is a reset government that is talking about due process. They say that, as for them, their governance will be *pepepepe*. Ghana *akee* NPP.

Mr Speaker, on page 6, table three, there is a huge scandal. I do not know whether they themselves have reported this to the Office of the Special Prosecutor (OSP). From table three, “Capital Expenditure” —

Mr Speaker, does Ms Doyoe have the Report?

Ms Doyoe: Yes.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: If she has the Report, then she should go with me to page 6, table 3. I want the Chief Whip for the Majority Side to finish reading the page mentioned.

Mr Speaker, on Capital Expenditure, 2025 appropriation, what we approved in this House was GHC83 million, and releases were GHC92 million. Somebody must go to jail. Then, when we come and see the Actual Expenditure, GHC92 million, the Variance was a negative GHC9.4 million. Somebody must account for this GHC9.4 million. This is not my Report. They said that releases are in excess of 111 per cent. How can they spend what has not been approved by Parliament?

4:40 p.m.

Mr Speaker, they cannot tell us that we approved expenditure item — there is expenditure line, they should look at the line item. It is the reason we have compensation of employees, Goods and Services, and Capital Expenditure (CAPEX). They should not tell me that

they are putting all the figures together to confuse me. In the least, I understand these numbers as I have been here for four terms.

Mr Speaker, what Parliament approved as a line-item expenditure, Capital Expenditure is GHC83 million. If we look at the actual releases, they have spent beyond the amount that this House approved. We are not interested in total envelope. The auditor is interested in the line item — *ye ye no line by line*. Has anybody been sent to the Office of the Special Prosecutor (OSP)? They came here to talk about the Public Financial Management Act (PFM) Act, 2016. It is clear that many of them are likely to go to jail. From what I am seeing, in just their first year — only yesterday, they were on us. The slightest mistake, they would be inviting New Patriotic Party (NPP) appointees to go to OSP and the National Intelligence Bureau (NIB).

Mr Speaker, look at the line item. Who authorised the excess of GHC9.4 million to be released? It was never brought to Parliament for variation. If it were to be the NPP administration, we know what our Friends would do. We know in this country how on the slightest error, our Friends have reacted to same. In just their first year, in one-line item, there is what Parliament has not approved. This is their own records. I do not want any of them to say “Afenyo-Markin said something”; this is not me saying it, this is them. This is a report signed by Hon Isaac Adjei Mensah, Chairperson of the Committee. He is a

member of the National Democratic Congress (NDC) caucus in Parliament. He is not a member of the NPP. He admits, by signing this Report, that there is some “chop-chop” that has gone on.

Mr Speaker, let me read the PFM Act, 2016, for the avoidance of doubt—*[Interruption]*—I will say mine, when it is his turn, he should say his. Section 96(2), Mr Speaker, I read:

“A person, acting in an office or employment connected with the procurement or control of Government stores, or the collection, management or disbursement of amounts in respect of a public fund or a public trust who authorises an expenditure exceeding the approved appropriation in the relevant budget commits an offence and is liable on summary conviction to a term of imprisonment of not less than six months and not more than twelve months or to a fine of not more than the value of the assessed impact of the commitment or to both.”

So, Mr Speaker, clearly, somebody must be punished for this. We should be careful what we wish for. The way they judged the NPP, they will be measured by the same standard. Mr Speaker, this is what the PFM Act, 2016 says, that we approved a line item for them, and they decided to spend in excess. They have decided to spend almost GH¢10 million. Who spent this? Who authorised this? It was not Parliament that approved this, and their own report is saying that releases are in excess. What the PFM

Act, 2016 is saying is that this is an offence. Somebody must be liable for this. We have already started seeing the scandals. Mr Speaker, this is scandal number one, right here in the Report. Mr Speaker, we have seen it in the Report signed by the Chairman of the Committee and not the Minority saying something. It is the Majority itself admitting to this.

Mr Speaker, I am concluding. Just as Hon Annoh-Dompreh said, this Side of the House would want to put across this point that the consideration of this Estimate be placed on ice until we receive sufficient explanation as to why more than what was approved was released under this expenditure item. Mr Speaker, this is a Government that claims that it is resetting and therefore believes in accountability, probity and transparency in governance. We cannot approve this until sufficient explanation is put forth. We know that in this House, we never varied this expenditure item; there is no evidence of that. If so, they themselves should prove it. They have admitted and they have been caught pants down.

Fortunately, this is not the Minority’s report. These are figures that are coming from official circles. It is not a Minority Member who has gone for this figure somewhere. Mr Speaker, I want to look towards the Minority side so that I can make my point comfortably. They themselves produced these documents. These data and figures have become part of the records of this House.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Who produced these documents?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, the Ministry. The Report is coming from the Committee.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: The Report is coming from the Committee.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Yes, Mr Speaker. The Committee relied on the returns from the Ministry, and the Chairman who is from the Minority Side and the Clerk have signed. We are saying that they should withdraw this Report and do the needful. There must be a full enquiry into how they spent in excess of almost GHC10 million. We will not support this Estimate to be approved. A full enquiry must be instituted to deal with this matter.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity to add my voice to the call for the approval of the sum of the sum of GHC1,500,040,589 for purposes of programmes approved for the Ministry of Transport.

Mr Speaker, I listened to the Minority Leader in silence. He should be able to take the pain from this Side in dignity. What did the Minority Leader say? That because within the approved quantum for the Ministry, in terms of IGF, they cannot vire it.

4:50 p.m.

Let me advert his mind to section 32 of the Public Financial Management (PFM) Act, 2016 (Act 921), the Minister has the power to vire expenditure lines approved for entities from, for instance,

Goods and Services to Capital Expenditure. Let me read the provision. Mr Speaker, section 32(1) states:

“(1) The Minister may, on the request of a Principal Spending Officer, execute a virement in respect of an amount of money allocated to the covered entity of that Principal Spending Officer.

(2) A virement executed under subsection (1) shall not result in a future liability for that covered entity or the Government.

(3) A virement executed under subsection (1) is subject to the following conditions:

(a) a virement of funds allocated for wages and salaries in an expenditure vote shall not be made unless the virement is in respect of wages and salaries within that expenditure vote...”

Mr Speaker, what we speak of is not about wages and salaries; it is about CAPEX. So, let me take him to CAPEX. Section 32(3) (c) states:

“A virement may be made from a recurrent expenditure to capital expenditure as well as from one capital expenditure to another capital expenditure...”

Mr Speaker, if we take table 3, the global total for 2025 for Appropriation (A), is GHC801,481,350.28. The actual release was GHC588,429,853.80. The actual expenditure, the expenditure as a

result of which the Minority Leader has gone haywire and is conjuring an offence that is non-existent, and is calling for an enquiry that has no basis, is GH¢588,429,853.80. Mr Speaker, if we deduct GH¢588 million from GH¢801 million, we have in excess of GH¢280 million. That has not been touched. Yet, the Minority Leader in some esoteric fashion is conjuring an offence that does not exist. He is demanding that this Side go to jail and that there must be an enquiry, all based on a non-existent fact.

Now, the attempt is that he must use the word scandal to ensure that there is a scandal. Mr Speaker, they have actually under-expended, and this virement occurred within the remit of section 32(1) (3) of the PFM Act, 2016 (Act 921). So, this attempt to say that somebody at the Ministry has committed some offence is untenable.

Mr Speaker, let me therefore urge the House to join me to ask for the adoption of the Report of the Committee on Roads and Transportation so that the Ministry can effectively carry out its mandates in 2026. With these words, I urge the media to ignore the earlier submissions regarding the allegation of over-expenditure outside of appropriation as incorrect, untruthful, and that the appropriate thing was done, and they expended within Appropriation. They are actually under-expended.

Mr Speaker, on this note, I invite you to put the Question.

Mr Nkrumah: Thank you, Mr Speaker. This is a House of records; we should not mislead the House at any point in time. The argument that is being made by the Majority Chief Whip cannot be sustained. The point that has been made by the Minority Leader is well-founded.

Mr Speaker, let me just give you and the entire House the information. This particular provision that was read was not read in full by the Majority Chief Whip. The law in the PFM Act, 2016, section 32 says: “the Minister”, here it is the Minister for Finance, is the one who may vire, and that virement is upon a request of a Principal Spending Officer.

Mr Speaker, in the absence of that, section 96, as we read, holds that when appropriation is done, and you exceed it, you are in contravention of the law. The very Report signed by the Chairman of the Committee, the Report with the *imprimatur* on it, page 6, row 2, starts with the 2025 Appropriation. The Appropriation is done line by line. Why do we not just vote GH¢200 billion at a go for the Government, but we go line by line? This is because every line is appropriated. Mr Speaker, the amount appropriated was GH¢83 billion. The expenditure was GH¢92 million. If indeed there was virement, the onus is on the person reporting to state that there was virement. In the absence of that, on the face of the document, there has been over-expenditure. That is why it is requested that it should be stepped down and addressed.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you. I will now invite the Minister to conclude.

Mr Bukari: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

To respond to the Minority Leader, I would want to state that we, the Ministry of Transport, respect this august House, and we operate directly as the Parliament approves our Budget to us. Mr Speaker, in May this year, I wrote to the Minister for Finance requesting a virement of the CAPEX for the Ghana Maritime Authority (GMA) to service the loan that they acquired over four years ago. They are servicing their loan, and as a Minister, I will not allow them to default. So, I had written, and we had spent within our Budget. We did not exceed the Budget that was approved for us. I want to state that we respect this House, and we will work on the dictates of this House. We wrote, and the Minister allowed us to do some virement, and that is exactly what we did.

5:00 p.m.

Again, other concerns were raised. One of them had to do with the Driver and Vehicle Licensing Agency (DVLA) offices, and that I should give praise to the previous government. I did not inherit, any DVLA structure anywhere. We had to work ourselves as a Government to create the opportunity for the people of Akwatia to have a DVLA office. There was no existing office for us to inherit. We are working to open up to 40 new offices and serve our people so

that they will be able to have services at their doorsteps. So, I would have made some recommendations or commended the former Minister if we had inherited any such projects.

On the other hand, it is not only Adenta that is running 24-hour under the Ministry of Transport. If you go to the Tema Ship Yard, we have up to four shifts. We are running 24-Hour Economy—*[Interruption]*—Yes, I am responding to the Hon Member. I need to respond to him. We have a lot of offices operating the 24 hours within the Ministry of Transport alone, but Adenta was picked up for them to know that we as Members of Parliament who close very late here, and if your licence is expired, you just dash there and then they will renew it for you.

We would want to state that as a Ministry, regarding the safety measures that we need to put in place at the Volta River Authority, we have started by recruiting safety guards who have started doing some education along the Volta Lake and educating boat owners and passengers as to how to pick up passengers and operate within safety measures. So, I would want to report to this House that we are not joking when it comes to safety and we are working with the locals to ensure that we have a smooth travel.

Again, on the issue of the electric vehicles (EVs), we inherited a contract that was signed to supply 100 EV buses. Only 10 were supplied, and as we speak,

we are negotiating with the contractor to see how we can look at the terms for him to continue to deliver the buses. So, it is not a new creature that we have to put in the Budget for 2026. It is already something that was taken and we are working to ensure that we improve upon the contract sums and ensure that we get some buses to augment our fleet.

Mr Speaker, the Tema-Mpakadan Railway, was the vision of H. E. President John Dramani Mahama. In 2016, he brought a loan facility here that was approved to construct the Tema-Mpakadan Railway. It has only been delayed for eight years and after the eight years, we have come to complete it. And I am happy to report to this House that it is operating and we are happy picking our passengers on a daily basis from Tema through to Mpakadan.

I would want to thank the Committee and by extension, the Leadership and Members of this House and Mr Speaker, your good self, and to assure you that the Ministry of Transport will work hard to ensure that we promote EV usage in the country. We will work to ensure that we have a safe, secure and an efficient transport system that will serve the people of Ghana, and also position Ghana as a transport hub in West Africa. On this note, I want to urge this House to approve our Budget Estimates for the Ministry of Transport to continue with the good works of this Government led by H. E. John Dramani Mahama.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House approved the sum of GHC1,500,040,589.00 for the services of the Ministry of Transport for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, ordinarily, we should move to *Order Paper Addendum 2*. But I pray that we go back to the original *Order Paper* and take the item numbered 9(j). So that we lay that, then we come back to *Order Paper Addendum 2*, then we can subsequently take it.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Hon Members, the First Deputy Speaker to take the Chair.

5:08 p.m. — [HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER, MR BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE CHAIR]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Chief Whip, let me hear you.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, my prayer is that we go back to the original *Order Paper* and take the item numbered 9(j), and that will be the reports of the Committee on Gender, Children and Social Welfare. Then we can go back to the *Order Paper Addendum 2*.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, at the Commencement of Public Business, Presentation of Papers, item numbered 9(j).

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the Chairperson of Committee is not here, so may I pray you that the Hon First Deputy Majority Whip who is a member of the Committee takes the report.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon First Deputy Minority Whip, you heard the prayers.

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: Mr Speaker, we are not opposed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Yes, Hon First Deputy Majority Whip?

PAPER

By the First Deputy Majority Whip (Ms Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee—

Report of the Committee on Gender, Children and Social Welfare on the Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the report has been duly presented and it is for distribution to the Hon Members.

Yes, Hon Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I pray that we take the Motion numbered 2 on *Order Paper Addendum 2*.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Motion numbered 2 on the *Order Paper Addendum 2* is for the Minister for Health.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the substantive Minister is unavoidably absent, so his Deputy is here to represent him, to listen to the key issues and respond accordingly. So may I pray for your leave so that that will be done.

Mr Shaib: In the natural scheme of events, we would not be opposed to that, but we just do not see the ministers, we do not see Chairpersons of the Committee, we do not even see the invitation of any doctors and nurses just to come and understand the reason for all of this debate. I would have prayed that that would have been the right thing to do. Where is the Minister?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, may you move the Motion on behalf of the Minister for Health.

ANNUAL ESTIMATES, 2026

MINISTRY OF HEALTH

Deputy Minister for Health (Dr Grace Ayensu-Danquah) (MP) on behalf of Minister for Health: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That this honourable House approves the sum of GH¢22,804,901,056.00 for the services of the Ministry of Health for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Motion moved; any seconder?

5:10 p.m.

Chairperson of the Committee (Dr Mark Kurt Nawaane): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion, and in so doing, present your Committee's Report.

Introduction

On Thursday, 13th November, 2025, the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the 2026 Financial Year was presented by the Hon. Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, in accordance with Article 179 of the 1992 Constitution.

Pursuant to Article 179 of the 1992 Constitution and Orders 195(4) and 241 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, the Rt. Hon Speaker referred the Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Health for the 2026 Financial Year to the Committee on Health for consideration and report.

Deliberations

The Committee subsequently met on Friday, 28th and Saturday, 29th November, 2025 and considered the

2026 Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Health. Present at the Committee's sittings were the Hon. Minister for Health, Mr Kwabena Mintah Akandoh, the Chief Director of the Ministry, Mr Desmond Boateng, as well as officials of the Ministry of Health, Ministry of Finance, representatives from Civil Society Organisations (Social Entreprises Development Fund (SEND) Ghana, African Foundation for Premature Babies and Neonatal Care (AFPNC) and the under-listed Agencies of the Ministry:

The Ministry

- a. Headquarters
- b. Ghana Health Service (Health Facilities)

Teaching Hospitals

- a. Korle-Bu Teaching Hospital-Main
 - i. Ghana Radiotherapy
 - ii. National Cardiothoracic Centre
 - iii. Plastic and Burns Unit
 - iv. Ghana Institute of Clinical Genetics.
- b. National Blood Service
- c. Komfo Anokye Teaching Hospital
- d. Cape Coast Teaching Hospital
- e. Ho Teaching Hospital
- f. Tamale Teaching Hospital
- g. Sunyani Teaching Hospital
- h. University of Ghana Medical Centre.

Regulatory Bodies

- a. Food and Drugs Authority
- b. Ghana Psychology Council
- c. Health Facilities Regulatory Agency.
- d. Medical and Dental Council
- e. Nursing and Midwifery Council for Ghana.
- f. Pharmacy Council
- g. Allied Health Professionals Council.
- h. Traditional Medicine Practice Council.
- i. Mental Health Authority

Subvented Agencies

- a. Centre for Scientific Research into Plant Medicine.
- b. Ghana College of Nurses and Midwives.
- c. Ghana College of Physicians and Surgeons.
- d. Mortuaries and Funeral Facilities Agency.
- e. St. John's Ambulance
- f. Ghana College of Pharmacists
- g. Ghana Institute of Clinical Genetics.
- h. National Ambulance Service

Psychiatric Hospitals

- a. Pantang Hospital
- b. Accra Psychiatric Hospital
- c. Ankaful Hospital

Other Establishments under the Ministry

- a. National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA).
- b. Health Training Institutions.
- c. Christian Health Association of Ghana.

- d. Ahmadiyya Muslim Health Service Ghana.

The Committee is grateful to the Hon. Minister and the Chief Director of the Ministry of Health, Heads of the Agencies, as well as Officials of the Ministry of Health, and Officials of the Ministry of Finance, SEND Ghana and AFPNC for attending upon the Committee.

Reference Documents

The Committee made reference to the following documents during the consideration of the Estimates:

- i. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana.
- ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament.
- iii. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year.
- iv. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 Financial Year.
- v. The Programme-Based Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Health for the 2026 Financial Year.
- vi. The Programme-Based Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Health for the 2025 Financial Year.
- vii. The Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921).

Mission of the Ministry of Health

The mission of the Ministry is to continue socio-economic development by promoting health and vitality through access to quality healthcare for all people living in Ghana using well-motivated personnel.

Goal of the Ministry of Health

The goal of the Ministry is to increase access to quality healthcare and population-based services for all by 2030.

Core Functions of the Ministry

The core functions of the Ministry include the following:

- i. Formulate, coordinate and monitor the implementation of sector policies and programmes;
- ii. Provide public health and clinical services at primary, secondary and tertiary levels;
- iii. Regulate registration and accreditation of health service delivery facilities as well as the training and practice of various health professions regarding standards and professional conduct;
- iv. Regulate the manufacture, implementation, exportation, distribution, use and advertisement of all food, medicines, cosmetics, medical devices and household chemical substances as well as the

marketing and utilisation of traditional medicinal products in the Country;

- v. Conduct and promote scientific research into plant/herbal medicine, and
- vi. Provide pre-hospital care during accidents, emergencies and disasters.

Performance for 2025

Non-Financial Performance Management and Administration Programme Uncapping of the National Health Insurance Levy (NHIL)

The Ministry of Finance freed up a total amount of GH¢10.10 billion for the National Health Insurance Fund to support payment of claims, bridge the USAID funding gap and support the Ghana Medical Care Trust Fund. The Ministry also fully paid for the GAVI co-financing requirement for vaccine support.

Recruitment of Health Professionals

As part of efforts to augment human resource requirements at various health facilities and hospitals nationwide (13,500), nurses were integrated into the Government payroll.

Launch of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund and passage of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Act, 2025

The Ghana Medical Trust Fund was established through the promulgation of

the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Act, 2025, to support the treatment of non-communicable diseases, including cancers, advanced diabetes, cardiovascular and kidney diseases, which were not adequately covered by the National Health Insurance Scheme.

The Ghana Medical Trust Fund Secretariat has been established, and a needs assessment across the country has been finalised to inform resource needs.

Finalisation of Free Primary Health Care (FPHC) Policy for phased implementation

The Ministry of Health has convened high-level policy dialogues and technical working group sessions to define the service package, delivery model, and financing approach for the implementation of the Free Primary Health Care Policy. The costing of preventive and promotive packages is currently being validated for adoption into the Essential Health Service Package (ESHP) under NHIA.

Strengthen PFM Systems

The Ministry took steps to update operations of the Ministry on the Ghana Integrated Financial Management Information System Hyperion Module to include the Reproductive, Maternal, Newborn and Child Health (RMNCH) emergency preparedness system to strengthen reporting and accountability.

Vaccine Manufacturing and Access

The National Vaccine Forum was convened to discuss measures to scale up the manufacturing and financing of vaccines in Ghana. A team of experts have been duly constituted to develop a Cabinet Memorandum to ensure the widespread adoption of locally manufactured vaccines.

Climate Change

A Vulnerability and Adaptation Assessment was conducted to assess the health sector's exposure to climate risks and to guide targeted responses. An exercise has been undertaken to arrive at projections for the burden of climate-sensitive diseases (2025-2050). Additionally, climate resilience measures have been incorporated into health infrastructure to strengthen adaptation to environmental pressures.

Gender

A National Health Sector Gender Policy & Action Plan has been developed to mainstream gender in the delivery of health services.

Infrastructure and Equipment

The Kpone Municipal Hospital and the Korea Foundation for International Health (KOFIH) Centre in Ho West, Volta Region, have been commissioned. The Ministry has also equipped the Ga North Municipal Hospital and the

Tamale Teaching Hospital with essential medical equipment.

Health Policy Dialogues

The Africa Health Sovereignty Summit – Accra Initiative, which is focused on advancing African sovereignty and leadership in a re-imagined global health governance, was organised.

Policy and System Reforms

The National Surgical, Obstetric and Anaesthesia Plan (NSOAP) to expand essential and emergency surgical care was launched. The focus of the Plan is to facilitate Health sector reforms anchored on equity, access and system performance to achieve Universal Health Coverage (UHC).

Infection Prevention and Control and Disease Prevention

The National IPC Strategy was launched to strengthen patient safety and health security. There was also a nationwide rollout of “Ghana Says ‘No’ to Cervical Cancer” through free HPV vaccination for girls.

Strengthened Governance and Leadership

A number of new boards for the Ghana Health Service (GHS), the Ho Teaching Hospital (HTH) and the Health Service Operations Support were constituted. The Allied Health Professions Council Board was also constituted and

charged to enhance workforce regulation and responsiveness.

International and Domestic Engagements

The Ministry also strengthened international partnerships to mobilise technology, finance and technical capacities for the sector through engagements with the United Kingdom Trade Envoy, Pfizer, GAVI, the World Health Organisation Regional Director, Africa CDC and the United States Ambassador.

Stakeholder collaboration was deepened through engagement with principals/directors of Health Training Institutions, the Ghana Medical Association and facility heads to address systemic bottlenecks in service delivery. The Ministry also paid all 2025 nursing training allowances outstanding for 7 months. Moreover, a total of 36,110 students have been successfully recruited into all Health Training Institutions across the country.

Financial Performance for the Year 2025

The Ministry’s approved budget was seventeen billion, eight hundred and sixteen million, eight hundred and nineteen thousand, six hundred and thirty-eight Ghana cedis (GH¢17,816,819,638.00). Out of this amount, thirteen billion, one hundred and one million, four hundred and fifty-seven thousand, four hundred and eighty-six Ghana cedis

(GH¢13,101,457,486.00) was allocated for Compensation, three billion, five hundred and ninety-six million, five hundred and twenty-eight thousand, eighteen Ghana cedis (GH¢3,596,528,018.00) was allocated for Goods and Services, and one billion, one hundred and eighteen million, eight hundred and thirty-four thousand, one hundred and thirty-four Ghana cedis (GH¢1,118,834,134.00) was allocated for the Ministry's Capital Expenditure (Capex).

The Ministry's major source of funding for 2025 was the Government of

Ghana (GoG) with an allocation of twelve billion, six hundred and seventy-five million, four hundred and fifty-one thousand, one hundred and eighty-seven Ghana cedis (GH¢12,675,451,187.00). An amount of four billion, four hundred and fifty-two million, three hundred and seven thousand, one hundred and forty-one Ghana cedis (GH¢4,452,307,141.00) was allocated from the Ministry's Internally Generated Funds (IGF), and Donor Support accumulated to six hundred and eighty-nine million, sixty-one thousand, three hundred and ten Ghana cedis (GH¢689,061,310.00) respectively.

The breakdown of the Ministry's 2025 Approved Budget is shown in Table 1 below:

Table 1: Ministry's Approved Budget for 2025

Economic Classification	GOG (GH¢)	ABFA (GH¢)	IGF (GH¢)	DONOR (GH¢)	TOTAL (GH¢)	%
Compensation	12,207,545,744	-	893,911,742	-	13,101,457,486	73.53
Goods and Services	157,632,543	-	2,961,734,165	477,161,310	3,596,528,018	20.19
Capex	310,272,900	-	596,661,234	211,900,000	1,118,834,134	6.28
Total	12,675,451,187	-	4,452,307,141	689,061,310	17,816,819,638	100
%	71.0	0.0	25.0	4.0	100.0	

Source: The Ministry's 2025 Budget Performance Presentation

Table 2: 2025 Budget Execution by Economic Classification

Classification	Approved Budget (GHC) A	Released Budget (GHC) B	Actual Payment (GHC) C	(%) Percentage Execution (C/A)
Compensation of Employees	13,101,457,486	8,439,324,603	8,439,324,603	64.42
GoG	12,207,545,744	8,070,875,859	8,070,875,859	66.11
IGF	893,911,742	368,448,744	368,448,744	41.22
Goods & Services	3,596,528,018	3,284,380,417	3,284,380,417	91.32
GoG	157,632,543	78,657,591	78,657,591	49.90
IGF	2,961,734,165	2,834,722,826	2,834,722,826	95.71
DP	477,161,310	371,000,000	371,000,000	77.75
CAPEX	1,118,834,134	450,881,765	450,881,765	40.30
GoG	310,272,900	35,000,000	35,000,000	11.28
IGF	596,661,234	415,881,765	415,881,765	69.70
DP	211,900,000	-	-	0.00
Total	17,816,819,638	12,174,586,785	12,174,586,785	68.33

Source: The Ministry's 2025 Budget Performance Presentation

Outlook for the Year 2026

Non-Financial

Main Priorities for the Year 2026 include:

v. Strengthen the regulation of Health Professionals, Facilities, Food and Non-food products.

vi. Promote medical tourism in the country.

i. Operationalise the Ghana Medical Trust Fund to support the management of NCDs.

vii. Retooling of Hospitals (equipment & logistics).

ii. Strengthen the implementation of Free Primary Healthcare at the lower levels of care.

viii. Construction of Regional Hospitals.

iii. Training and recruitment of the health workforce.

ix. Oversight of local manufacturing of vaccines.

iv. Procurement of essential health commodities and vaccines.

x. Continue the scale-up of the implementation of Health Information Systems (e.g., E-HEALTH, GHiLMIS, etc) to lower levels to improve patient management.

Capex Outlook for Medium-Term

The Ministry intends to focus on the following:

Bilateral Projects

- i. Medical Equipment Provision Project with funding from Korea Eximbank (EDCF).
- ii. Supply and Installation of Medical Equipment for 8 District hospitals project with funding from Korea Eximbank (EDCF) – Hohoe, Sefwi Wiaso, Goaso, Nkoranza, Agogo, Berekum, Agona Swedru Municipal and Agona Swedru Ahmadiyya.
- iii. Maternal and Child Health Services and Obstetric Emergencies Improvement Project.
- iv. Accelerating TB Case Detection Project Phase 2.
- v. Retooling of selected Public Health Facilities Nationwide.

The Ministry intends to focus on progressing and completing ongoing projects to attain 100% completion, as indicated below:

- i. Construction & Equipping of CHPS compounds/Health Centres at selected locations in the country.
- ii. Reconstruction of La General Hospital.

- iii. Agenda 111 Projects.
- iv. Rehabilitation of Juaboso Hospital.
- v. Konfo Anokye Teaching Hospital Maternity Block.

The underlisted projects will receive the required approvals for Project Commencement activities:

- i. Construction of 12 CHPS compounds at selected locations in the country.
- ii. Psychiatric Hospital Projects.
- iii. Construction of three (3) Regional Hospitals (Western North, Savanna, Oti).
- iv. Construction of Specialist Hospital at Ajumako Bisease.
- v. Ho Teaching Hospital Re-development.
- vi. Construction of a 500-bed paediatric hospital in Accra.
- vii. Construction of Central Medical Stores.
- viii. Construction & Completion of District Hospitals (Shama, Bole, Bawku, Akatsi and Sandema).

Economic Classification and Departmental Allocation for 2026 Annual Budget Estimates

2026 Sector Budget

For the 2026 fiscal year, the Ministry has been allocated twenty-two billion, eight hundred and four million, nine hundred and one thousand, fifty-six Ghana cedis (GH¢22,804,901,056.00) to execute its mandate. Out of the total allocation, sixteen billion, two hundred and forty-seven million, eight hundred and fifty-two thousand, one hundred and

sixty-four Ghana cedis (GH¢16,247,852,164.00) was allocated for Compensation of Employees, four billion, five hundred and thirteen million, nine hundred and seventy thousand, five hundred and eighty-two Ghana Cedis (GH¢4,513,970,582.00) was allocated for Goods and Services, and two billion, forty-three million, seventy-eight thousand, three hundred and ten Ghana cedis (GH¢2,043,078,310.00) was allocated for Capital Expenditure (Capex).

The table below shows a breakdown of the Ministry's budget.

Table 3: Ministry's financial projections for 2026

SOURCE OF FUNDS	COMPENSATION OF EMPLOYEES (GH¢)	GOODS & SERVICES (GH¢)	CAPEX (GH¢)	TOTAL (GH¢)	%
GOG	15,015,241,123	177,632,543	1,090,272,900	16,283,146,566	71.40%
IGF	1,232,611,041	4,030,174,917	747,077,962	6,009,863,920	26.35%
FOREIGN LOANS	-	51,005,902	205,727,448	256,733,350	1.13%
FOREIGN GRANTS	-	255,157,220	-	255,157,220	1.12%
TOTAL	16,247,852,164	4,513,970,582	2,043,078,310	22,804,901,056	100%
% SHARE OF ECONOMIC ITEM	71.25%	19.79%	8.96%	100%	

Source: 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy of Government

Sources of Funding

In terms of funding sources, the Government of Ghana (GoG) remains the Ministry's major source of funding, contributing 71.40 per cent of the total

allocation. This is followed by the Ministry's Internally Generated Funds (IGF), which constitute 26.35, while Donor Support (Loans and Grants combined) accounts for 2.25 per cent of the Ministry's total budget for 2026.

Economic Classification

By economic items, Compensation of Employees remains the largest expenditure item, representing 71.25 per

cent of the Ministry's total budget. Goods and Services constitute 19.79 per cent, while Capital Expenditure (Capex) accounts for 8.96 per cent of the overall allocation.

Table 4: Allocation to Sub-Programmes (2026)

Sub-1	Source of Fund				Total (GHC)	%
	GOG (GHC)	IGF (GHC)	DONOR (GHC)	ABFA (GHC)		
Management & Administration	2,307,361,146.16	18,693,000.00	32,483,382.00	-	2,358,537,528.16	10.34%
Health Service Delivery	13,592,351,717.35	4,650,264,492.00	479,407,188.00	-	18,722,023,397.35	82.10%
Human Resource for Development	213,522,805.98	839,566,660.00	-	-	1,053,089,465.98	4.62%
Health Sector Regulation	169,910,896.51	501,339,768.00	-	-	671,250,664.51	2.94%
Total	16,283,146,566.00	6,009,863,920.00	511,890,570.00	-	22,804,901,056.00	100%

Source: 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy of Government

- i. By sub-programme allocation, the largest share of the Ministry's 2026 budget is allocated to health service delivery, representing 82.10 per cent of the total budget.
- ii. Management and Administration receives 10.34 per cent of the allocation, while 4.62 per cent is allocated to Human Resource for Development, and 2.94 per cent is allocated to Health Sector Regulation.

Observations and Recommendations

The Committee, after thoroughly scrutinising the 2026 Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Health and

engaging with key stakeholders, presents the following observations and recommendations.

Engagement with Civil Society Organisations and Advocacy

Submission from the African Foundation for Premature Babies & Neonatal Care (AFPNC), Ghana

In its consultations, the Committee invited both SEND Ghana and AFPNC Ghana to provide targeted inputs on critical gaps in the health sector that require urgent budgetary attention. AFPNC Ghana highlighted the worrying rate of neonatal deaths and noted that the

high cost of neonatal care remains a major barrier to survival, as essential NICU medicines and services are still not covered by the National Health Insurance Scheme.

A significant concern raised by the organisation was the unavailability of NICU hostels for mothers and caregivers, hindering essential interventions like breastfeeding, kangaroo mother care, and parental bonding, all of which are crucial interventions essential for improving neonatal outcomes.

AFPNC Ghana also pointed to inadequate neonatal equipment and the limited number of specialised staff across many regional and district facilities. The Committee recognised that these concerns are crucial in safeguarding national efforts toward reducing neonatal and under-five mortality.

Submission from SEND Ghana

SEND Ghana highlighted the alarming maternal mortality rate, citing the high cost of maternal healthcare and gaps in NHIS coverage as major obstacles. Key concerns include limited access to comprehensive emergency services, out-of-pocket payments for critical procedures, and unavailable or unaffordable lifesaving medicines for many women, particularly those in deprived and remote communities.

The organisation also pointed out that inconsistent primary healthcare

funding, inadequate maternity staffing, and delays in critical supplies contribute to preventable maternal complications.

SEND Ghana emphasised the need for improved referral systems, better-equipped hospitals, and investment in antenatal and postnatal care to strengthen maternal health services.

The organisation stressed the need for predictable funding for health programmes, robust accountability mechanisms for maternal health initiatives for donor and Government-funded maternal health initiatives, and deliberate efforts to ensure that vulnerable and marginalised women benefit equitably from national health spending.

The Committee recognised these concerns as crucial to improving maternal health outcomes, reducing mortality, and promoting health equity while ensuring that all women have access to quality care without financial or systemic barriers.

Uncapping of IGF for Regulatory Agencies

The Committee expressed concern about the continued capping of Internally Generated Funds (IGF) for key regulatory agencies in the health sector, which includes the Medical and Dental Council (MDC), Nursing and Midwifery Council (NMC), Pharmacy Council, and the Health Facilities Regulatory Agency (HeFRA), among others.

The Committee observed that the capping significantly impedes the ability of these agencies in the effective performance of their regulatory oversight, conduct of inspections, compliance and the enforcement of standards of practice nationwide.

Given the essential role of the regulatory agencies in protecting public health, the Committee recommends that the Government prioritise the uncapping of IGF for these institutions to enhance their operational capacity and regulatory effectiveness.

Status of Releases to the National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA)

The Committee is pleased to note that the Ministry has made significant strides in ensuring timely releases of funds to the National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA). This development is a relief for healthcare service providers across the country.

The Committee recognises that timely releases will have a ripple effect on the healthcare system and will enable service providers to maintain uninterrupted services, reduce debt burdens, and boost confidence in the NHIS. This, in turn, will reinforce the NHIS as a vital safety net for vulnerable populations.

The Committee commends the Ministry's efforts in clearing arrears and encourages continued commitment to securing stable and predictable financing

for the health sector. This is crucial in sustaining progress and achieving universal health coverage goals.

Non-Insurance of Agency Assets

The Committee observed with concern that most agencies and institutions under the Ministry have not adequately insured their assets, including office buildings, vehicles, high-value equipment, and critical installations such as the Central Medical Stores. This exposes the Government to significant financial risks in the event of fires, accidents, natural disasters, or other emergencies, which could disrupt healthcare services and incur substantial costs.

The Committee noted that despite earlier recommendations, compliance with insurance requirements remains low, posing major risks to service continuity and asset protection.

While acknowledging financial constraints, the Committee recommends strict enforcement of an asset-insurance policy across all departments and agencies to mitigate these risks. The Committee urges the Ministry to treat this as a priority, ensuring compliance and protecting public health infrastructure.

Non-Payment of 13th Month Salary Arrears

The Committee noted with concern that arrears related to the 13th Month

Salary for some health workers remain outstanding and have persisted for several years. This situation negatively affects morale, motivation, and staff retention, especially among frontline workers who operate under difficult and high-risk conditions.

The Committee underscores that maintaining labour satisfaction is vital for quality service delivery and therefore urges the Government to expedite the payment of all outstanding arrears to these health workers and take measures to prevent future delays.

Roll-Out of the Ghana Health Information Management Systems (GHIMS)

The Committee was informed about the transition from the Lightwave Health Information Management System (LHIMS) to the Ghana Health Information Management System (GHIMS), which aims to strengthen national ownership, interoperability, and system security.

The Committee, however, noted some challenges arising from the legacy LHIMS arrangement, specifically the vendor's non-cooperation with the Ministry of Health, which limits government access and authority over national health data.

The Committee also noted that only 7 districts were fully covered under LHIMS, historical health data remained inaccessible, and the Ministry of Health

lacked full control over the central server, posing significant data security risks, including potential breaches, data loss, or unauthorised access.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry should accelerate nationwide rollout of GHIMS, ensure full Government ownership and control of health data, review legacy contracts to protect the national interest, and embed strong value-for-money, performance, and safeguard clauses in future digital health agreements. These measures aim to strengthen Ghana's health information management system, ensure data security and sovereignty, and promote sustainable and resilient healthcare services.

Ghana National Blood Service

The Committee observed that the Ghana National Blood Service continues to face major logistical and operational challenges, including inadequate storage capacity, limited regional laboratories, outdated blood-collection equipment, and insufficient funding for donor mobilisation. These constraints undermine the availability of safe, sufficient, and timely blood for transfusion services across the country.

Recognising the critical role of the Blood Service in trauma response, maternal care, surgical services, and emergency health interventions, the Committee urges the Ministry to prioritise upgrading regional blood centres, strengthening cold-chain infrastructure

and transport systems, supporting regular donor-recruitment campaigns, and enhancing funding for quality control and safety screening to ensure availability of safe blood.

Strengthening these systems will improve and enhance the national blood service.

High Attrition Rate of Health Workers

The Committee observed with concern the high attrition rate of health workers attributed to factors including difficulty for health workers to obtain study leave for further studies, poor working conditions and lack of a recruitment plan for qualified personnel in the ensuing year.

In view of the persistent service delivery gaps, the Committee urges the Ministry to prioritise recruiting health personnel, especially midwives, to support maternal and child health services nationwide.

The Committee reiterates that addressing staffing gaps will improve service delivery, reduce workloads, and strengthen health outcomes.

Commitment Authorisation

The Committee observed a critical issue affecting the Ministry of Health's operations. The Ministry submitted 9 requests to the Ministry of Finance for commitment authorisation, and only 2 of the requests have been approved. The

Committee considers this approval rate (2 out of 9) to be woefully inadequate, particularly because the Ministry of Health plays a central role in delivering essential social services.

The Committee therefore urges the Ministry of Finance to expedite all pending commitment authorisation requests from the Ministry of Health, recognising the critical role in providing essential healthcare services.

Upward Adjustment of IGF Budgeting

The Committee advocates strongly for the upward adjustment of the annual IGF collection targets, particularly for teaching hospitals and key agencies.

The current arrangement whereby utilisation ceilings for IGF are based on reduced collection targets adversely affects expenditure and provision of critical medical supplies, even when health institutions exceed budgeted IGF collection. Such expenditure of unapproved funds is a breach of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921).

The Committee was informed that the matter had been brought to the attention of the Ministry of Finance, but the situation is yet to be rectified.

The Committee therefore appeals to the Ministry of Finance to review the approved IGF of teaching hospitals and key agencies upwards to ensure effective and efficient health service delivery, and

also exonerate them from committing illegalities based upon the Public Financial Management Act.

Conclusion

Having regard to the critical role of the health sector in the development of human capital and advancement of all aspects of sectors of the country, the Committee requests that the Ministry of Finance release funds regularly and honour all its commitments to the Ministry of Health to ensure effective performance of its mandate.

After carefully examining the 2026 Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry, the Committee hereby recommends that this House adopt its Report and approve the total sum of twenty-two billion, eight hundred and four million, nine hundred and one thousand, fifty-six Ghana Cedis (GH¢22,804,901,056.00) for the operations of the Ministry of Health for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Respectfully submitted.

Question proposed.

Dr Patrick Boakye-Yiadom (NPP — Obuasi East): Thank you, Mr Speaker. I rise to make a comment on your Committee's Report, and to urge the House to approve the sum of GH¢22,804,901,056 for the use of the Health Sector.

Mr Speaker, I, however, have my reservations, and I want to take this opportunity to highlight a few of the concerns we noticed. The Committee did a good job by engaging all the agencies under the Sector, but the common concerns across were inadequate staff and also the delayed or non-release of allocations. It baffles me that we have a Minister for Finance who says the economy is doing well, and he is being touted as “forcing”, but cannot employ in the health sector. Mr Speaker, an economy that is really doing well should be able to employ. So, if for the whole of 2025, no nurse was employed in the Health Sector, then it is a cause for concern. When we go to page 6 of the Report, paragraph 711(ii), the figure there is 13,500 nurses, and honestly, these nurses were employed in 2024 under the Nana Akufo-Addo/Bawumia-led government and the sad aspect of it is that the majority of these nurses have not been paid, as I speak.

Mr Speaker, the much-touted one job, three people, three shifts “1-3-3” job mantra is a failed promise. Because if the Government cannot employ nurses in the Health Sector, it is a serious concern for all of us. To add salt to injury, there are no plans to recruit nurses for the year 2026. To make matters worse, when we go to the Report, this challenge is compounded by the high attrition rate for nurses. When we engaged the officials from the Nurses and Midwifery Council, they said that every month, about 500 nurses in the Service apply to leave the country. So, we are not recruiting, and

those in the Service are also leaving the shores of this country. This is putting our health sector in danger.

Mr Speaker, let me come to the shutdown of the Zipline drone delivery distribution centres. We all know the benefits of the Zipline drone delivery service. It helps our communities, especially the rural ones, by delivering essential medicines, vaccines, anti-snake serum and emergency supplies. It saves mothers during childbirth. It stabilises accident victims and even improves the services of the Community-based Health Planning and Services (CHPS) compound. Mr Speaker, we woke up on 25th November, only last week, and to our surprise, we heard that the Zipline has closed down three of its distribution centres; I am afraid the remaining three may follow soon.

And to show concern, Mr Speaker, the Kete Krachi distribution centre, which I am sure supplies essential medicines to the residents of your Constituency, has been shut down because of non-payment and neglect. If I were the Minister, I would engage the vendor and see a possibility of renegotiating. We did it in 2017 and 2018, when the Akufo-Addo Government renegotiated the various Public Procurement Authorities (PPAs) that went against the nation. We were able to make some gains. Why can the Minister not do that for the Zipline? And Mr Speaker, the shock of it is that while we are shutting our distribution centres down, the Trump Administration is

committing US\$150 million to support Zipline operations in Africa, including Ghana. So, the Trump administration, far away from Ghana, is even thinking about us than our own Government.

The majority of Ghanaians gave them their mandate not to put their lives in danger, but I am telling them that this is exactly what they are doing. Mr Speaker, to make matters worse, the National Ambulance Service is suffering. It is suffering because out of the 307 ambulance fleets that were bequeathed to the people of Ghana in 2017, we only have 211 on wheels, as I speak and, in their Budget, there is no provision to replace them. Even those that are broken down, we cannot get money to fix them. Where is the money? Ato, where is the money? A party that claims that they are socialist. The ambulance Service is essential and life-saving. Why are ambulances breaking down, and we cannot replace them? We do not have money to replace them, but we have money to do other things.

Mr Speaker, let me add my voice to the call for the uncapping of the IGF for the Regulatory Agencies under the Ministry. I am saying this because we have seen the benefits accrued by the agencies that have already had the uncapping. For example, the National Health Insurance is enhancing its operations; it is helping. So, let us agree that the remaining operations are uncapped so that so we can get money to improve their operations.

5:20 p.m.

Mr Speaker, before I conclude, let me tell Members one interesting thing. The 2026 Budget, out of the nine commitment authorisations requested or submitted to Ministry of Finance, approval has been granted for only two. I am talking about new projects. Only two out of the nine that were submitted to Ministry of Finance. Ato where is the money? — *[Expunged by order of Mr Speaker]* The shock of it is that the two projects are going to one region, and that is Western North Region. To our surprise again, it is going to one constituency, which is Juaboso. The construction a nursing training school at Juaboso and rehabilitation of Juaboso Hospital. Hon Deputy Minister, I am sure you are not happy all the two projects are going to one constituency. I can see from your face. You are not happy that all the two projects are going to one constituency. Mr Speaker — *[Expunged by order of Mr Speaker]*. I will conclude by urging the House to approve the Budget and the said amount for use by the health sector.

I thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you so much. Before giving the floor to another person, the rules in Standing Order 63 has been violated. So, whatever you said in Twi is ordered to be expunged from the record.

Yes? Hon Member, you have the floor. No, let me come to the Majority Side first.

Mr Alexander Roosevelt Hottordze (NDC — Central Tongu): Mr Speaker, I beg to support the Motion. In the Committee sitting, there were some observations that were made. One of which is what he mentioned about the status of releases to the National Health Insurance Scheme. Mr Speaker, I can tell you on authority that this is the first time Government adhered to the provision of Section 52 (1) of the National Health Insurance Act, 2012 (Act 852), which states that within a matter of 30 days, the Minister for Finance, after taking the National Health Insurance Levy, should lodge it in the account of the Ministry of Health and notify the Minister for Health accordingly. This is the first time. You will be surprised that, even at our sitting, the Minister indicated to us that the last bit of the claims was supposed to be cleared that very day. So, any hospital that does not receive its claim should ask whoever is concerned. My Brother who sat there listening to all these things, today, he is saying a different thing altogether. Is that the way we behave?

Mr Speaker, about the uncapping of Internally Generated Funds (IGF) for regulatory agencies, we all agree that it was their Government which brought the capping and realigning policy, and we are trying to remove it. As we speak, we made an effort as a Committee to make sure that most of these agencies were decapped to a level that could make them survive. We are only left with the regulatory bodies, and we have decided to put it before the Minister of Finance that those regulatory bodies should also

be made to breath. So, if my Brother is saying a different thing altogether, I am just surprised.

We also observed that there were a lot of facilities that could not insure their fleet of cars, buildings, and a whole lot, and the Committee was very much concerned about it. We advised them strongly that they must make sure that they insure their facilities, and the Minister assured us that in 2026, he will make sure that all the facilities under his Ministry get insured to avoid any danger in the future.

The Committee also complained bitterly about the non-payment of the 13th month salary areas, which was accumulating from month to month. They could not pay it. They left it and ran away, and today, it has become a case for them to mention. Ghanaians are watching who they are. The 13th month salary, who introduced it? They introduced it, and they left a lot of areas behind and ran away. Now that we are planning to solve it, they are coming to make noise for Ghanaians to believe that they are angels coming from wherever it is.

Mr Speaker, the surprising thing that we learned was the Lightwave Health Information Management Systems. This was another means by which people made a lot of resources. The Minister made us understand that the company was supposed to extend this facility to 900 health facilities in this country. They ended up extending it to only 450, and it is left with 500. And they were overpaid.

They were paid US\$77 million. As we speak, at the end of it all, what the guy could do to Ghanaians was to hold the entire health system to ransom. He was monopolising the facility to the detriment of our poor patients. How can such people stand here and say all kinds of things that they are not aware of? It is surprising.

Mr Speaker, by the effort of our able Minister for Health, as we speak, they have rolled out something that we call Ghana Health Information Management System (GHIMS) that has taken over the system to protect our data. Now, everything is smooth in the health sector. Very soon, it will be rolled out in the entire country. I request that we must also support this Budget. We must make sure that they grant this amount of money to the Ministry of Health to continue with its good work. If you look at the Ministry's outlook for 2026, you will be impressed. Mr Speaker, let us approve the budget for them so that they will continue their good work. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Nana Agyei Baffour Awuah (NPP — Manhyia South): Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity. I do acknowledge that the Budget is about choices. Therefore, the President, by his Minister, has the discretion to decide on the choices to make. Of serious concern to some of us is the backlog of nurses. When you think of the backlog, what becomes more concerning is the fact that we also continue to train nurses. Therefore, the backlog also continues to

expand. I acknowledge that there might be fiscal constraints for which reason Government may have to take a position. Nevertheless, it is also very important that we give hope to our teeming nurses, over 78,000 who are still at home waiting to be employed. I have, in fact, also been informed that there are also trained doctors who are also waiting for clearance to be employed. There are pharmacists who are also waiting for clearance to be employed. I urge the Minister for Health to work with the Minister for Finance to provide a clear plan as to how our teeming health workers who remain unemployed or who continue to remain at home with the hope of getting onto the Government payroll are going to be absorbed.

It may not be in the Budget today, but if we do not show concern, it is increasingly becoming a hopeless situation for them. In fact, we cannot close our eyes to the fact that now they are heavily reliant on politicians as to how they are going to be employed when historically it was not the case.

5:30 p.m.

So, Mr Speaker, going forward, there should be a clear plan by the Minister for Finance and the Minister for Health, to show us the way forward as to how these health workers are going to be absorbed. In fact, I may want to suggest to the Ministers for Finance and Health to consider how they may rope in the private sector, private hospitals and

health facilities, to assist in reducing the amount of unemployment in that regard.

Mr Speaker, these are my humble suggestions on the matter before us. Thank you.

Prof Ayensu-Danquah: Thank you, Mr Speaker. My Hon Colleague across the aisle was talking about the Zipline Delivery Service. The Zipline Delivery Service contract was signed in 2018 by the former Minister, but the programme was started in 2019. We were paying US\$88,000 a month per station. Six stations at US\$88,000 each, that makes US\$520,000 a month that the Ghanaian taxpayers were paying to this company. The contract was signed for emergency and hard-to-reach areas, meaning that the drones were going to send emergency medicines and services to areas that were hard to reach. On record, only 12 per cent of the work they did was to hard-to-reach areas. Only 4 per cent of the deliveries were emergencies. They were delivering paracetamol, condoms, mosquito nets and stationery.

For the cost-benefit analysis, the Ghanaian taxpayers were suffering under this programme. I wanted to use this opportunity to clarify the Zipline issue so that there is no ambiguity and there is absolutely no confusion as to why this Zipline programme is not good for the Ghanaian and the Ghanaian taxpayer. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon available Leader. You have the floor.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, my Chief Whip is here, so I am not the available Leader. I do not want any *coup d'état* matters.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You have to change position, because in your Frontbench, you sit in seniority. Is that not so?

Mr Shaib: That is so.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is what makes you the available Leader.

Mr Shaib: All right. Mr Speaker, thank you for this opportunity. There are a few observations. About three weeks ago, I made an observation and I came to this Floor to make a request to the Leader of Government Business in respect of the Lightwave Health Information Management System (LHIMS).

Mr Speaker, last week I was at the Korle-Bu Teaching Hospital for a medical review. While I was sitting before the doctor who I can say knows me very well, he told me in plain terms that he does not know me and does not have any record of me, so he did not even know what I was there for. We know what it means. The LHMS have not been effective; there is no structure within the respective hospitals and there is no record whatsoever. So, what is happening now is the cash and carry. In fact, one would even have to have a new identification card before one can be attended to by a physician or a doctor.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Which part of the Report are you speaking to?

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, it is the health Report. When she was talking about mosquito nets and condoms – but this is even captured.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: She was speaking with reference to Zipline.

Mr Shaib: This is captured in this Report, and I am talking about LHMS. I am saying that there is total breakdown with reference to how patients are attended to. This is crucial and not political. Beyond that, I have been in the hospital in my constituency, and I came here to say it, and my hope was that this would be resolved.

Maternal health issues. Mothers who are pregnant pay before they are attended to. When a woman is pregnant, she pays for her caesarean section, and it is between GHC5,000 to GHC9,000. We are not social democrats, but former President John Agyekum Kufuor brought the free maternal care. There is a need for us to pursue such social interventions without issues.

Mr Speaker, now we talk about some paltry sum of money that will be used to take care of the Agenda 111 projects. I have always believed that continuity, especially in the provision of social infrastructure, is key. Let me commend President Mahama for thinking of the legacy projects. But we cannot take care of legacy projects and be thinking of

only boreholes and leave the Agenda 111 projects to rot, then they say that they are only taking care of 10.

Ambulance services are also captured. Still, let me make reference to my constituency, Weija-Gbawe. My ambulance is dysfunctional. It is grounded and has not been working for the past two or three months. It is now the responsibility of Members of Parliament to pre-finance the mobility of their ambulances, and these are genuine concerns. I will normally not do politics with issues of this nature; I will let the House understand. This is just like the Ghana Medical Trust Fund. What is happening to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund? What are we doing with it? Is it working? That is why they have lifted about GHC2 billion or so to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund, when they are taking staff from National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA) to go and fill in at Ghana Medical Trust Fund.

They have 120,000 people whose appointments were revoked; about 12,000 who could have been nurses and doctors. So even if we have the Ghana Medical Trust Fund, are we not looking at it as an opportunity to recruit people? Then they are now revoking appointments. I am not too enthused about supporting this, but if it is the view of the House to deal with it, they can bring their numbers in to come and pass it. As they sit here, they do not even form a quorum, but they are here screaming. Mr Speaker, I thank you very much for the opportunity.

Minister for Health (Mr Kwabena Mintah Akandoh) (MP): I am most grateful, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity. Let me put on record that I have taken note of all the concerns that have been raised on the floor of the House. Except to make a few remarks and corrections.

Mr Speaker, the amount in the Motion moved, excluded the allocation to the National Health Insurance Authority and the Ghana Medical Trust Fund. So, Mr Speaker, if you would permit me, if we add the allocation from the National Health Insurance Authority which is around GHC9.04 billion, and the Ghana Medical Trust Fund, which is about GHC2.259 billion, the total amount of money we are talking about here is around GHC34.22 billion.

5:40 p.m.

Mr Speaker, let me put it on record, when the Deputy Ranking was speaking— This is a House of record; he made a categorical statement that the nurses who were recruited in 2024, and we say we have paid them, most of them have not been paid. Mr Speaker, this is what has gone into the *Hansard*. It must be expunged immediately. As I speak to you, all the 13,500 nurses have been paid, and so it is not accurate to say on the floor of the House that most of them have not been paid.

Mr Speaker, it is clear that we do not recruit for the sake of it. Anytime there is recruitment, there must be a financial provision for the recruitment. Mr

Speaker, if there is recruitment in 2024 for the sake of elections, and no financial provision has been made, it is as good as if there is no recruitment. What we have said is that we have put 13,500 nurses and midwives on the payroll in 2025, and this is a fact. I do not know why they are struggling to counter this claim.

Mr Speaker, again, we are not leaving the Agenda 111 to rot. His Excellency the President has indicated on several occasions that any ongoing project he has inherited will be continued and it will never be abandoned. Mr Speaker, on the issue of LHIMS, I have had the opportunity on the floor to clarify that we are rolling out another software that is called the Ghana Health Information Management System (GHIMS). And so, we have started with the teaching hospitals, and they are rolling out from department to department. Mr Speaker, it is never the case that we have left the records missing, and therefore records of patients cannot be traced. This is not true.

Mr Speaker, we are rolling out the software, we have created the exchanges; therefore, whenever they get to any facility, and they plug in, all the data will be reconstructed, and no patient will lose his or her data. This is a matter of fact.

Mr Speaker, it is true that they left behind about 74,000 health professionals unemployed. For their information, there is a clear plan to make sure all these health professionals get jobs, not excluding what we call managed migration. Mr Speaker, now the Government is taking

charge. About 13 countries have requested health professionals from Ghana, and we are taking steps to train more specialists so that they can meet the global market and fill the gaps they have left behind.

Mr Speaker, let me also make the point that the health sector has been given priority in this Government. The Ghana Medical Trust Fund, as I speak to you, if they care to know, is in full motion. They have started disbursing funds for the care of patients. Mr Speaker, GH¢1.5 billion has also been allocated for Free Primary Health Care. The Primary Health Care accounts for about 80 per cent of our health needs. So, when we get that right, we would have a very strong health sector.

Mr Speaker, a lot is being done in the health sector, and so, without speaking much, I wish, and I encourage my Colleagues on the other Side — I heard the Minority Chief Whip say he will support us. In order for us to complete their projects and get a strong health sector, please, let us approve this money so that the good work H. E. John Dramani Mahama is doing will continue.

Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, if you may bear me out, we have just one Motion; Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection. Mr Speaker, we have navigated and cooperated well. I just have a word.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you know me; we have navigated well. I indicated clearly that I am giving the last lot to the Minister responsible, and after the Minister responsible, I intend not to take anyone.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House approved the sum of GH¢22,804,901,056.00 for the services of the Ministry of Health for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

Hon Minority Chief Whip, you are not in charge of Government business; that is why I am calling the Majority Leader.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, but he struggled to catch your eye. I think he felt strongly about something that was said. So, if you may indulge him just to hear what it is.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: After putting the Question, I have no reverse gear.

Mr Ayariga: I do not think it is against the approval.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, I have no reverse gear. We are moving

forward. So, Majority Leader, what is the next item?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may we take the Motion numbered 1 on *Order Paper Addendum 2*, the Report from the Committee on Gender, Children and Social Welfare.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minister for Gender, Children, and Social Protection?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may I pray that the Minister for Gender, Children and Social Protection is unavoidably absent. And so, I pray that the Minister for Health and his Deputy are here, and they can note the issues. Gender issues are also health-connected, so the Minister can note the issues and respond to the matters arising.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Leadership?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we do not have copies of the Report. We do not have a problem. There are other beautiful women who can stand in his stead; why do they want to go and worry the Minister? His application to you is that we should allow Mr Akandoh, who just struggled to pass his Motion, to stand in the stead of the Minister for Gender, Children and Social Protection.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, what is your application?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, it is not appealing to us. Mrs Tetteh-Agbotui is here.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What meaning are you placing on gender?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: No, we want to hear a feminine voice at least. Mr Akandoh has a harsh voice. I do not want that harsh voice; get us a beautiful feminine voice.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, the Motion numbered 1 on the *Order Paper Addendum 2*.

Deputy Minister for Health?

5:50 p.m.

ANNUAL ESTIMATES, 2026

MINISTRY OF GENDER, CHILDREN AND SOCIAL PROTECTION

Deputy Minister for Health (Prof Grace Ayensu-Danquah) on behalf of the Minister for Gender Children and Social Protection: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That this honourable House approves the sum of GHC3,261,523,666.00 for the services of the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Motion has been moved, any seconder?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I agree with the Hon Minority Chief Whip. The Chairperson of the Committee was here in the morning, but has an emergency. So, I want to seek your leave to enable the First Deputy Majority Whip who is a member to second the Motion and in doing so present the Report of the Committee for the attention of the House.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, unwillingly, I have to support. I am not willing, but what can I do? We support.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But few minutes ago, you said you want to hear a female voice. Now that more females are about to speak, why are you giving them permission unwillingly?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I want the appropriate female voice.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon First Deputy Majority Whip?

First Deputy Majority Whip (Ms Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee: Thank you, Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion, and in doing so, I present the Report of the Committee and ask that the *Hansard* captures everything that is in the Report.

Introduction

In accordance with Article 179 of the 1992 Constitution, the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson on

Thursday, 13th November, 2025, presented the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year to Parliament.

The Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection (MoGCSP) was subsequently referred to the Committee on Gender, Children and Social Welfare for consideration and report, pursuant to Order 237 of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

Deliberations

The Committee met with the Hon Minister for Gender, Children and Social Protection, Dr Agnes Naa Momo Lartey, officials from the Ministry, Heads of Department and Agencies under the Ministry as well as Officials from the Ministry of Finance on Wednesday, 26th November, 2025 to consider the referral.

The Committee is grateful to the Hon Minister and her team and Officials from the Ministry of Finance for attending upon the Committee to assist in considering the 2026 Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection.

Reference Documents

The Committee made reference to the following documents during its deliberations:

- i. The 1992 Constitution;

- ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament;
- iii. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 Financial Year;
- iv. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year; and
- v. The Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection for the 2026 Financial Year.
- vi. The Budget presentation of the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection.

Mandate of the Ministry

The Ministry is mandated to formulate, coordinate and ensure gender equality and equity. The Ministry is also mandated to promote the survival, social protection and development of children, the vulnerable and the excluded, persons with disability, and integrate the fulfillment of their rights, empowerment and full participation into national development.

Core Functions

The core functions of the Ministry are to:

- a. Formulate gender, child development and social protection policies.

- b. Co-ordinate gender, child and social protection related programmes and activities at all levels of development.
- c. Develop guidelines and advocacy strategies for use by all MDAs and for collaboration with Development Partners and Civil Society Organisations (CSOs).
- d. Ensure compliance with international protocols, conventions and treaties in relation to children, gender and social protection.
- e. Conduct research into gender, children and social protection issues.
- f. Monitor and evaluate programmes and projects on gender, children, the vulnerable, excluded and persons with disabilities.
- g. Facilitate the integration of gender, children and social protection policy issues into the National Development Agenda.
- h. Ensure the availability of appropriate administrative and financial management systems and support services for the effective and efficient running of the Ministry/ Sector for enhanced service delivery.
- i. Coordinate the development and implementation of human resource management policies, systems and programmes consistent with the requirements of the sector to enhance service delivery.
- j. Exercise oversight activities of the following Departments and Agencies:
 - i. Department of Gender (DOG)
 - ii. Department of Children (DOC)
 - iii. Department of Social Welfare (DSW)
 - iv. Child Marriage Unit (CMU)
 - v. Livelihood Empowerment Against Poverty (LEAP) Secretariat.
 - vi. Domestic Violence Secretariat (DVS)
 - vii. Human Trafficking Secretariat (HTS)
 - viii. National Council for Persons with Disability (NCPD)
 - ix. Ghana School Feeding Programme (GSFP)
 - x. Ghana National Household Registry (GNHR)
 - xi. Adoption Regulation Unit (ARU)

Performance of 2025 Approved Budget of the Ministry

In the year under review, the Ministry was allocated an amount of two billion, eight hundred and ninety-one million, four hundred and thirty-three thousand, three hundred and seven Ghana edis (GH¢2,891,433,307.00.00) for the implementation of its programmes and activities.

The Committee noted that as of August 2025, an amount of one billion, four hundred and forty-six million, seven hundred and ninety-six thousand, three hundred and three Ghana cedis and thirty pesewas (GH¢1,446,796,303.30)

representing 50.04 per cent of the approved budget was released to the Ministry as indicated in Table 2. Below is the breakdown of allocation and expenditure provided in Tables 1 and 2.

Table 1. Approved Budget for the 2025 Financial Year

ITEM	APPROVED BUDGET	ACTUAL RECEIPTS
COMPENSATION OF EMPLOYEES		
GoG	111,788,273.00	71,306,813.27
GOODS AND SERVICES		
GoG	2,745,889,337.00	1,371,680,542.20
IGF	1,185,697.00	613,792.83
DONOR FUNDING	30,970,000.00	2,855,335.00
CAPEX		
GoG	1,600,000.00	-
TOTAL	2,891,433,307.00	1,446,456,483.30

Table 2. Budget Execution as at August 2025

SOURCE OF FUNDING & EXPENDITURE ITEM	APPROVED BUDGET (¢)	RELEASES AS AT AUGUST 2025	ACTUAL EXPENDITURES	ACTUAL RECEIPT
Compensation				
GoG	111,788,273.00	71,306,813.27	71,306,813.27	71,306,813.27
Goods and Services				
GoG	2,745,889,337.00	1,372,954,605.74	1,372,954,605.74	1,371,680,542.20
IGF	1,185,697.00	797,485.00	613,792.83	613,792.83
Donor	30,970,000.00	3,195,155.00	3,195,155.00	2,855,335.00
CAPEX				
GoG	1,600,000.00	-		
TOTAL	2,891,433,307.00	1,448,254,059.01	1,445,194,366.84	1,446,456,483.30

Performance of the Ministry for the 2025 Financial Year

Key performance achievements of the Ministry for the 2025 financial year are indicated as follows:

Management and Administration

In 2025, the Ministry organised Four (4) statutory meetings namely; Audit Committee, Entity Tender Committee, Ministerial Advisory and Fix Asset Management Committee Meetings.

It also prepared Annual and Quarterly Performance Reports as well as Monitoring Reports to the Ministry of

Finance, National Development Planning Commission, Office of the President, Parliament and other relevant bodies.

The Ministry also commemorated Twelve (12) International Calendar Day events to create awareness among 2.4 million stakeholders and the public about the importance of protecting and promoting the welfare and rights of women, children and vulnerable individuals.

Gender Equality and Equity (Women's Development)

- i. The Ministry launched the Affirmative Action Act, 2024 Act 1121. This presented the opportunity to officially introduce the Act to the public.
- ii. Participants (in-person) and 3,800,000 (online) stakeholders were sensitised on the Act.

iii. The Ministry has also successfully inaugurated the Gender Equity Committee to ensure smooth implementation of the Act. Subsequently, a meeting was held to draft the implementation

iv. The draft Legislative Instrument for the Affirmative Action is being finalised in collaboration with the Office of the Attorney General's Department and key stakeholders to operationalise the Act.

Children's Rights Promotion, Protection and Development

The Ministry continues to advance efforts in protecting and promoting the rights of children across the country. In the year under review, the Ministry conducted an extensive child protection awareness campaign, successfully reaching a total of over 1,023,526 individuals.

A total of 1,123,273 and 328,586 individuals were also engaged through the Ghanaian Against Child Abuse Social Drive Campaign and the Community Child Protection Tool Kit respectively to raise awareness among the Ghanaian populace regarding the promotion and safeguarding of children's rights across the country.

The Ministry has also provided care and counselling to 22 children in correctional and remand centers, 491 children comprising 357 children in the four government Residential Homes for Children (RHCs), 44 juveniles at the correctional centres, and 23 probationers under supervision received care and

protection. Sixty-seven (67) Social Enquiry Reports (SERs) for the Family Tribunal and juvenile courts were prepared to ensure juvenile access to a child-friendly and age-appropriate justice system.

In addition, a post adoption in-country monitoring on 40 families in 7 regions (Greater Accra, Bono East, Bono, Ashanti, Eastern, Volta and Oti Regions) was conducted to ascertain how adopted children are adjusting to their new families. Furthermore, 237 children were provided with care and protection through follow-ups on reported cases, emergency child rescue operations, temporary shelter arrangements, and continuous monitoring to ensure their safety and reintegration where appropriate.

These steps are to ensure that child related issues are adequately addressed. The Ministry has improved the management of cases related to child protection through the introduction of the Social Welfare Information Management System. This web-based case management system allows frontline staff to manage cases related to children and their families in real time and refer them for redress.

Through this system, the Ministry has received and addressed a total of 8,349 cases in 2025.

The Ministry celebrated various International Days on the Welfare of Children and their families, namely, International Day of Families, International Day of the African Child, Children's Summit, International day of

the Girl Child, International Day of Street Children, Menstrual Hygiene Day, among others.

These platforms served as avenues to create awareness on protection and promotion of the physical, mental and social wellbeing of children in general.

As part of efforts to regulate and streamline the operations of Day-Care Centres in the country, the Ministry has issued licenses to 281 newly registered Day Care Centres and renewed 785 licenses of existing Day-Care Centres across the country.

Social Development

The social development programme has three sub programmes namely; Social Service, Securing Inclusion for Disability and Social Protection.

Social Services

The Ministry has issued licenses for a total of 1066 Day Care Centres, which includes 281 new licenses and 785 renewals. Additionally, 45 destitute and elderly individuals are receiving care at the Central Destitute Infirmary (CDI) in Bekwai. Hospital welfare services were extended to 3037 patients across various health centres throughout the country.

Securing Inclusion for Disability

The Ministry continues to work towards the re-enactment of the Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016. A draft Persons with Disabilities Bill, 2025 and a coordination framework have been

developed to ensure the full participation of Persons with Disabilities in National Development.

The Ministry has secured 20 office space as part of efforts to establish district offices for the council. Efforts to secure seconded staff to serve as District Officers of the Council are ongoing.

To ensure the upgrade and retooling of the special schools for persons with disabilities, the Ministry procured 338 Desktops, 154 laptops, 220 accessible software (JAWS), 6 (Adobe software), 54 printers, 12 Braille Displays, Braille Embossers and 6 Graphic Tablets, 80 tables with Chairs. Furthermore, processes are ongoing to install the IT items at the 7 special schools for Persons with Disabilities to enhance the knowledge and digital skills of students in the special schools.

Persons with Disabilities continue to receive and benefit from the 3 per cent DACF for persons with disabilities to support their livelihood and ensure their participation in national development. To ensure this, the Ministry monitored the management and disbursement of the District Assembly Common Fund (DACF) allocated for individuals with disabilities in 77 Metropolitan, Municipal, and District Assemblies (MMDAs). As a result of these efforts, approximately 1,027 individuals with various disabilities have benefited from the 3 per cent Common Fund across these MMDAs.

The Ministry provided the following institutions with disaggregated data on Persons with Disabilities (PWDs) to ensure their full integration and participation in national development initiatives:

- i. The World Food Programme received data on 25,275 farmers with disabilities to support the development of AgriTech projects for farmers with disabilities.
- ii. Ghana Health Service received data on 52 children with disabilities to inform the creation of an intervention aimed at providing prostheses and orthoses to children with physical disabilities in Ghana.

Social Protection (SP)

As the Ministry responsible for the overall coordination of social protection in Ghana, the Ministry developed a Coordination Framework on Social Protection as part of the roadmap for integrating Social Protection programming and delivery at the sub national level.

The Ministry continues to enhance its grievance redress mechanism for the Social Protection sector and beyond. In 2025, a total of 924 cases related to the government's flagship programmes were received, of which 450 were resolved, representing a resolution rate of 48.7 per cent.

Additionally, as a means of deepening the awareness of Social Welfare Case Enquiry System (SWCES) in 100 selected districts, 8 regional and 50 district Information Services Department (ISD) officers have been trained.

To effectively monitor social protection programs in the country, the Ministry has developed a Social Protection Monitoring and Evaluation Management Information System (MEMIS) Dashboard, which is interoperable with the management information systems of other Social Protection Agencies in the country.

The Ministry has paid the 94th, 95th, 96th and 97th LEAP cycles to LEAP Beneficiary households successfully to about 1.5 million people.

The Ministry successfully monitored all the payment cycles to ensure that beneficiaries received the grant amount due them. Monitoring teams paid home visits to the beneficiaries to ascertain their conditions and well-being.

The Ministry's monitoring indicates that the beneficiaries continue to use the LEAP grant to support their basic needs and daily consumption. 92 per cent of Children of school-going age from the LEAP households were also found to be enrolled and attending schools while some were in apprenticeship.

In terms of reassessment of LEAP beneficiaries, the Ghana National Household Registry (GNHR) has completed data collection in 262,120

LEAP beneficiary households representing 1,182,958 individuals. Mob up exercise is on-going to complete the remaining households.

The LEAP programme has begun the process of validating the data received from the GNHR to complete the reassessment process by January 2026.

The reassessment programme will take out beneficiaries who are above the poverty line, retain those who are still considered extreme poor and enrol new beneficiaries who are extremely poor. This would expand the programme to cover 400,000 households identified as extremely poor by the Ghana National Household Registry.

Ghana School Feeding Programme

The Ghana School Feeding Programme is currently feeding 4,231,059 Kindergarten to Primary Six (6) pupils on every school going day in 12,045 schools in deprived communities across the country at a cost of GH¢2.00 per child per day.

The programme also provides employment for over 34,000 caterers and cooks mostly women to enable them economically to support their families.

The Ministry has successfully paid caterers for first term, second term and third term of the 2024/25 academic year. Orientation programme has also been organised for all caterers and school health promotion coordinators to ensure

adherence to programme protocols and standards.

The Ministry has also monitored 4,419 selected schools across the country to ascertain the effectiveness of the programme. The monitoring exercise revealed that food quality has seen some improvement with more caterers using the regional menu which in turn has improved the use of local foodstuff.

Domestic Violence

The Ministry continues to support victims of Domestic Violence and their families; and has provided maintenance, custody, counselling, and other complimentary services to 45 victims.

Additionally, the Ministry provides case management services to victims of Sexual and Gender-Based Violence (SGBV) through the Orange Support Centre.

It is worth mentioning that the Domestic Violence policy has been revised for submission to Cabinet for consideration and approval. The purpose of the revision is to ensure that it is in line with National and international laws and standards, and response to the current needs of Ghanaians.

The Ministry has trained thirty paralegals in Gender Concepts, Domestic Violence, Sexual and Gender-Based Violence, the Domestic Violence Act, the Children's Act, Women's Rights, Child Marriage Toolkit, Guidelines for Paralegals, and the utilisation of the *Boame* Application/

Orange Support Center. The Ministry has trained 30 Market Executives as Paralegals on SGBV, child protection and other important related topics.

The Help Line of Hope (Boame App) received forty-five cases and referred them to the appropriate institutions for redress.

Human Trafficking (HT)

The Ministry has extended comprehensive trauma-informed care to a total of 135 victims of human trafficking. Additionally, twenty law enforcement officers and 10 civil society officers have been trained to report issues related to human trafficking.

The Ministry has compiled and submitted the Trafficking-in-Persons (TIP) report to the United States Department of Labour (US DoL) and ECOWAS.

Again, the Ministry inaugurated the Human Trafficking Management Board and organised an orientation trainin for Board Members and trained 150 law enforcement officers from Police, Immigration, EOCO and Customs officers. A Media Launch was organised towards the commemoration of the world day against human trafficking (Blue Day) for 120 stakeholders and 40 media houses to raise awareness on the issues of human trafficking. The World Day Against Trafficking in Persons was commemorated with a sensitisation Health Walk also to raise awareness on the dangers of human trafficking, irregular migration, child labour and forced labour. This programme took place on 31st July, 2025 in Accra, where

about 650 stakeholders participated in the event.

Outlook for 2026

The Ministry seeks to, among others, implement the following programmes:

- i. Pay 6 bi-monthly LEAP Grant;
- ii. Pay 1st, 2nd and 3rd term 2025/2026 School feeding Grant payment;
- iii. Advocate for the passage of Persons with Disabilities Bill, Children’s Bill, Aged Persons Bill et cetera in Parliament;
- iv. Provide care and support for survivors of Domestic Violence and Human Trafficking;

- v. Create awareness on child and social protection, social welfare, gender, PWD and vulnerability issues;
- vi. Implement the Affirmative Action (Gender Equity) Act, 2024;
- vii. Facilitate a continuous Administration of the Ministry, its Departments and Agencies;
- viii. Conduct extensive advocacy for social welfare and protection services to children and families;
- ix. Facilitate the drafting of new Legislations and review of outdated Policies and laws.

Budgetary Allocation of the Ministry for the 2026 Financial Year

An amount of three billion, two hundred and sixty-one million, two hundred and fifty-three thousand, six hundred and sixty-six Ghana cedis (GH¢3,261,253,666.00) has been allocated

to the Ministry for the implementation of its programmes and activities for the 2026 financial year. The breakdown of the allocation by source of funding, programme and expenditure items are indicated in Tables 3 and 4.

Table 3. Budget Ceilings for the Ministry for the 2026 Financial Year

SOURCE OF FUNDS	COMPENSATION OF EMPLOYEES (¢)	GOODS AND SERVICES (¢)	CAPEX (¢)	TOTAL (¢)	%
GOG	120,291,352.00	3,050,875,455.00	11,600,000.00	3,182,766,807	97.59%
IGF Retention	-	1,062,859.00	-	1,062,859.00	0.03%
Donor	-	77,694,000.00	-	77694000	2.38%
TOTAL	120,291,352.00	3,261,523,666.00	11,600,000.00	3,261,523,666	100%
%	3.69%	95.96%	0.35%	100%	

Table 4. Detailed Breakdown of the 2026 Budget

BUDGET CLASSIFICATION	EXPENDITURE CEILING GH¢
COMPENSATION OF EMPLOYEES	120,291,352.00
GoG-GOODS & SERVICES (with the exception of LEAP AND GSFP)	8,574,302.00
IGF	1,062,859.00
DONOR	77,694,000.00
GoG-CAPEX	11,600,000.00
GSFP	1,982,902,513.00
SPD/LEAP	1,057,398,640.00
DV FUND	1,000,000.00
HT FUND	1,000,000.00
TOTAL	3,261,523,666.00

Observations and Recommendations

The Committee after carefully examining the 2026 Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection (MoGCSP) makes the following observations and recommendations:

Budgetary Allocation for the 2026 Financial Year

The Committee applauds the 12.79 per cent increase in the budget allocation for the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection from GH¢2,891,433,307.00 in the year 2025 to GH¢3,261,523,666.00 for the 2026 financial year. While the upward adjustment is commendable, the Committee is concerned that the Ministry's expanding mandate, especially in gender equality, protection of vulnerable groups, disability inclusion and social welfare requires even more substantial and sustainable financial

support. The Committee, therefore, stresses the need for continued prioritisation of social protection financing to ensure national development goals are effectively achieved.

Status of Payments for Ghana School Feeding Programme (GSFP) Caterers

The Committee observed, with satisfaction, that the Ghana School Feeding Programme does not owe any arrears to caterers as at the time of reporting. All outstanding payments have been settled. This development has brought significant relief to caterers nationwide, many of whom are women and household breadwinners. The Committee commends the Ministry for its commitment towards the programme.

Allocation to Flagship Programmes

A key observation by the Committee is that the Ministry's budget continues to be heavily skewed towards two flagship

programmes, namely: the Ghana School Feeding Programme (GSFP) and the Livelihood Empowerment Against Poverty (LEAP) Programme.

These two interventions alone consume a significant portion of the Ministry's total budget, leaving limited resources for other equally critical sectors such as child protection, domestic violence response, disability support services, human trafficking interventions and social welfare operations.

While the Committee acknowledges the importance and impact of both GSFP and LEAP, it is concerned that this imbalance has constrained the Ministry's ability to deliver on its broader mandate.

Delays in the release of funds for key non-flagship programmes were also noted to have adversely affected service delivery, monitoring, and case management across several departments. The Committee noted further that while approximately warrants had been issued for the release of 76 per cent of the funds allotted for flagship programmes for the 2025 fiscal year, only 50 per cent of the funds had been released as of September, 2025.

The Committee therefore urges the Ministry of Finance to consider increasing allocations for the Ministry beyond its flagship interventions to ensure a more holistic approach to gender equality, child welfare and social protection. The Ministry is also encouraged to improve internal efficiencies to ensure the optimal use of funds.

Upsurge in Human Trafficking Syndicates

The Committee expressed grave concern about the increasing activities of human trafficking syndicates operating within Ghana and across the sub-region. Reports presented to the Committee confirmed that rescue teams continue to record rising incidents involving trafficked individuals from neighbouring countries who were lured into Ghana under false pretences and subsequently subjected to exploitation and degrading conditions. Unfortunately, the Ministry faces significant challenges in responding to these cases due to inadequate funding, insufficient shelter capacity and limited rehabilitation resources for rescued victims. The Committee strongly recommends increased funding for the Human Trafficking Secretariat, expansion of safe shelters nationwide, enhanced cross-border coordination, and improved logistical support to law enforcement and rescue teams.

Days of Activism Against Gender-Based Violence

The Committee observed that the annual commemoration of the 16 Days of Activism Against Gender-Based Violence remains a critical national platform for highlighting the persistent challenge of gender-based violence in Ghana.

The Committee emphasises that gender-based violence, whether occurring in communities, institutions, digital spaces or homes, continues to undermine national development, security, and the

well-being of women and girls. It therefore encourages the Ministry to intensify public sensitisation, scale up partnerships with civil society and community leaders, and strengthen enforcement mechanisms within the Domestic Violence Act and related legal frameworks.

Conclusion

The Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection plays a pivotal role in advancing national development through its support to vulnerable groups, including children, the elderly, and Persons Living with Disabilities. Its contribution to social welfare and protection remains indispensable. It is, therefore, essential that the Ministry is adequately resourced to effectively deliver on its mandate.

The Committee accordingly recommends to the House to adopt its Report and approve the amount of three billion, two hundred and sixty-one million, two hundred and fifty-three thousand, six hundred and sixty-six Ghana cedis (GHC3,261,253,666.00) for the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Question proposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House approves the sum of GHC3,261,523,666.00 for the services of the Ministry of

Gender, Children and Social Protection for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think we are done for the day. We have sat for more than five hours, so we are in your hands.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, the Leader of the House did not move a Motion for adjournment. He was just drawing attention to the fact that we have done more than five hours.

Just to urge my Colleagues, today has been good. It is the first day we started taking the Motions. Today, we have done five, which is quite impressive. So, I will urge my Colleague that he should impress upon the Chairpersons of the Committees so that we can get as many of the reports as possible. Tomorrow, we should be able to do more than ten. If we do that, we will be making good progress towards the passage of the Appropriation.

Unfortunately, we did not have the Reports for a number of the Motions that were considered, but we had to compromise for our Colleagues. Again, we had to do a few things with my Colleague on some of the Papers. They saw how we helped, but when it is time for him to praise us, the Hon Majority Leader will not praise us. He will use the Despatch box to attack us. But today, we have cooperated. It has been beautiful. Mr Speaker, you saw the beautiful cooperation from this Side of the House.

So, we will urge our Colleagues that tomorrow, we try and get as many of the reports as possible so that we can do a critical job. But I urge Colleagues to support. The Hon Majority Leader has been good. The Hon Majority Chief Whip has been very good. Tomorrow will be better, I am sure. I see the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources is here.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, let me, on behalf of my Leader and the entire Majority Caucus, commend the Leadership of the Minority and the Minority for the cooperation. Today, like he said, it has been exceptional, and we believe that it will remain so until we pass the Appropriation.

Mr Speaker, like he said, we want to urge the Leadership of the Committees, not just the Chairpersons alone, but the Ranking Members as well, that they should cooperate after the consideration of the Estimates so that the reports can quickly be prepared and given to the Table Office so they can be loaded. I am sure today, about 10 Committees sat. Those were even just the advertised ones. Those that have not been advertised, they are also sitting. I am sure once we get the reports for today's sittings, as well as

those that are outstanding, tomorrow, our plates will be full.

So, Mr Speaker, on this note, we have not done five hours, and so, we are entirely in your hands in this matter.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: If the indication is that you have not done five hours, then you cannot be in my hands based on Standing Order 56(2).

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, in the absence of any further Business, I move that the House adjourns till tomorrow at midday. Mr Speaker, I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Motion for adjournment has been moved. Any seconder?

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, I second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was accordingly adjourned at 6:03 p.m. till Wednesday, 3rd December, 2025 at 12:00 noon.

Editor's Note

This Official Report was corrected by the House on 12th December, 2025.